



INTERNATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY



Olympic Education and AI: Process of Transformation



18th

INTERNATIONAL SESSION
FOR NATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMIES'
AND NATIONAL OLYMPIC COMMITTEES' DELEGATES

ANCIENT OLYMPIA



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Published by the International Olympic Academy

Athens, 2026

International Olympic Academy
52, Dimitrios Vikelas Avenue
152 33 Halandri, Athens
GREECE
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Editor: Konstantinos Georgiadis
Editorial Coordination: Roula Vathi
Photographs: IOA Photographic Archives

ISBN: 978-960-9454-75-9
ISSN: 2732-6284

Printed by:
PRINTFAIR
3, Violettas st. & Andrianou, Acharnes
T.: 210 2469799, 210 2401695
www.printfair.gr | e-mail: offers@printfair.gr

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9–15 MAY 2025

Editor
KONSTANTINOS GEORGIADIS
Professor, University of the Peloponnese
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FOREWORD

Olympism continues to constitute a powerful educational, cultural and ethical force that exerts a substantial influence on contemporary societies. The 18th International Session of the National Olympic Academies and the Education Commissions of the National Olympic Committees clearly highlighted the decisive role of Olympic education in disseminating the values of Olympism and in shaping responsible citizens at a global level.

As every year, the National Olympic Academies and the Education Commissions of the National Olympic Committees presented short videos through which the high standard of the educational work they implement became evident. Many of these programmes, distinguished by their quality and innovation, are funded by Olympic Solidarity in cooperation with the National Olympic Committees and the International Olympic Committee. These programmes are implemented worldwide, achieving remarkable results and forming a unique network of educational activities that deserves to be further evaluated and utilised by the Olympic Movement.

The activities implemented are not limited to a specific category of participants, but address athletes, officials, students, children, parents, sponsors and, in general, all those associated with the Olympic Movement. Cooperation with Olympic Solidarity and the IOC Olympic Studies Centre has proven particularly constructive and effective, contributing to the implementation of the common objectives of the Olympic Movement through organised educational activities.

The International Olympic Academy expresses its satisfaction with the work carried out by the National Olympic Academies, as well as with the close cooperation that has been developed among them. Within the framework of this cooperation, a representative of Olympic Solidarity was invited to inform the staff of the National Olympic Academies and the Education Commissions about the possibilities for submitting and funding new programmes. The primary goal

of these actions is the implementation of the vision of the Olympic Movement and the dissemination of the universal principles of Olympism.

At the same time, particular emphasis is placed on the continuous training of staff on contemporary issues concerning the Olympic Movement. Topics such as sustainability, Olympic legacy, human rights, good governance, athletes' mental health, the creation of a safe environment for children and athletes, ethics and integrity in sport, gender equality and environmental protection constitute key pillars of this educational process. Through the programmes and presentations that take place, it becomes evident that the NOAs implement important initiatives that do not focus exclusively on Olympic education but approach, in an interdisciplinary manner, a wide range of contemporary issues.

The lectures delivered and the discussions developed during the Session focused on key issues shaping the future of sport and Olympic education. Emphasis was placed on the role of Olympic education as a transformative force capable of shaping active citizens who combine the philosophy of Olympism with knowledge and technological competence. At the same time, the opportunities offered by digital technologies and modern forms of learning, such as online platforms and interactive communities, were analysed, as these enhance youth participation and contribute to the evolution of the NOAs into centres of pedagogical innovation and intercultural dialogue.

Equally important was the analysis of the relationship between artificial intelligence, leadership and ethics in sport. The lecturers highlighted the potential of artificial intelligence to improve data analysis, accessibility and communication with the public, while also pointing out the possible risks related to the loss of authenticity and the reinforcement of social inequalities. Furthermore, the need for modern models of leadership and good governance based on transparency, accountability and respect for athletes' rights was underlined, while particular importance was attributed to the ethical dimension of sport as a foundation of the credibility and social mission of Olympic institutions.

However, the need for further education and training of staff remains particularly high. For this reason, it is necessary to seek new programmes in cooperation with the NOCs and Olympic Solidarity that will cover a significant portion of training costs. Training may take place either at the facilities of the NOAs or at the premises of the IOA, thereby also contributing to the sustainability of educational structures.

An important element is the fact that a large proportion of Olympic

Solidarity's educational activities worldwide is implemented in cooperation with the NOAs. According to available data, numerous NOAs, in cooperation with their respective NOCs, have submitted programmes for implementation, demonstrating their dynamic development. At the same time, several NOAs implement programmes without financial support from Olympic Solidarity, which highlights their increased commitment and initiative.

According to research findings and submitted requests, it is estimated that approximately 100 to 105 NOAs are currently active. Strengthening cooperation both with Olympic Solidarity and among the Academies themselves, as well as with the IOA, constitutes a key objective for the further development of joint programmes and initiatives.

Furthermore, the establishment of IOA Awards for the NOAs and the Education Commissions has been announced, with the aim of encouraging the development of educational programmes and extending their outreach to additional target groups. Within this educational framework, particular emphasis may also be placed on athletes to enhance their professional skills and prepare them for their future careers after the completion of their athletic paths.

This volume is fully aligned with this philosophy: to record, highlight and strengthen the initiatives that contribute to the dissemination of the values of Olympism and to the strengthening of Olympic education worldwide. Through systematic cooperation, continuous training and the exchange of experiences, the Olympic Movement can continue to evolve while remaining faithful to its fundamental principles and responding effectively to the challenges of the contemporary era.

Professor Konstantinos GEORGIADIS
University of the Peloponnese
IOA Dean



Opening Ceremony

ANCIENT OLYMPIA, 10 MAY 2025

Solidarity

Joy of Effort



ADDRESS
by the President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee
Isidoros KOUVELO

Your Royal Highness,
Dear Minister of Sports,
Dear Esteemed Lecturers and Guests,
Dear Members of the Olympic Family
and Friends from Around the World,

Standing here today, in this place where the Olympic spirit was born, where the heart of the global Olympic Movement lies, is for me more than an honour – it is a deeply moving moment. Ancient Olympia is not only a sacred place for our shared heritage; it is a place that stirs the soul. Every stone, every path here speaks of ideals that have shaped humanity for centuries – excellence, respect, and peace.

But above all, what moves me today is the presence of each and every one of you – gathered from every corner of the world, united by a shared passion: to educate, to inspire, and to serve through the power of the Olympic values.

My journey with the International Olympic Academy began many years ago – not only as a President, but as a believer. A believer in the quiet power of education to transform lives, a believer in the idea that values matter, and above all, a believer in the extraordinary potential of people – like all of you – who choose to lead with purpose.



During my years as President of the IOA, I have seen, firsthand, how dreams take shape through dialogue, how bridges are built through understanding, and how education can be the most enduring legacy of sport.

Today, I speak to you not only as the newly elected President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee, but as someone who still carries the heartbeat of the IOA – who will continue to walk alongside its mission and vision, with the same passion and dedication as ever before!

During my presidency at the IOA, we embarked on an ambitious journey: to redefine and enhance the role of the National Olympic Academies worldwide. We recognised a fundamental truth – that Olympic education must be a living, dynamic force in our societies, not a symbolic aspiration but a practical reality. And this reality must be shaped, led, and implemented through the committed and coordinated efforts of our NOAs and the NOCs.

Let me briefly outline the strategic initiatives that we pursue, which, I am proud to say, are now shaping a new roadmap for the Olympic education landscape globally.

Under the guidance of the IOA Director, Makis Asimakopoulos, and the work of the IOA team, we have set out to give NOAs a stronger institutional and operational identity. Through new guidelines and policy recommendations, we are making efforts to support the establishment of clear, transparent structures within each Academy. We emphasise the need for legal recognition, strategic planning, and a stronger relationship with each respective NOC. These efforts are now helping NOAs to better define their mission, secure funding, and develop impactful educational programmes.

We have focused on synergies and cross-border educational collaborations. The IOA has successfully initiated and implemented tailored educational projects with various NOAs – notably with Saudi Arabia and Bahrain in the Gulf region, and with Chinese Taipei and Thailand in Asia. We have designed and implemented educational programmes targeting different groups of people (NOC executives, National Federations, Ministry of Sports and Education experts), covering a broad range of topics by distinguished university professors.

We believe these examples can serve as models for others to adapt.

We have taken concrete steps to encourage and assist NOCs that do not yet have a National Olympic Academy to establish one. We approached this not as a directive, but as a shared responsibility. Olympic education should not be a privilege of a few countries – it must be a global standard.

Now, standing before you, as the President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee, I reaffirm my personal and institutional commitment to continue this mission. The Hellenic Olympic Committee will stand by the IOA and its ever-growing international network. Together, we will offer more tools, build stronger platforms, and create more opportunities for cooperation. The newly elected IOA President, Harris Tsolakakis, a brilliant professor with deep academic insight and longstanding dedication to Olympic education, brings a wealth of experience and vision to this role.

The choice of Mr Tsolakakis to take over the management of an educational, athletic, and cultural institution such as the IOA was a decision made by the Plenary Session of the Hellenic Olympic Committee and was full of symbolism and practical considerations. A former Greek fencing champion, long-time senior advisor to the HOC on Olympic preparation issues, and a highly respected university professor, he was the best choice for the future of the IOA! This decision was welcomed with satisfaction by the International Olympic Committee. I am confident that our institution, your institution, is in good hands, and I thank him for accepting this heavy responsibility!

We must now look ahead – towards broader inclusion of marginalised communities, towards the digital transformation of Olympic education, toward sustainability and peacebuilding.

This Session's topic will offer you a unique opportunity to examine how emerging technologies – particularly artificial intelligence – are reshaping educational approaches within the Olympic Movement. Moreover, the growing phenomenon of esports raises important questions for the Olympic Movement: How do we define sports in a digital context? What values are being promoted through esports, and how can we ensure they align with the Olympic ideals of excellence, respect, and fair play? Could esports serve as a bridge between tradition and innovation, helping to renew interest in physical activity, teamwork, and global community?

It is an honour for us to welcome here for the first time the President of the International Esports Federation, His Royal Highness Prince Faisal bin Bandar bin Sultan Al Saud, who will offer us his valuable insight on the phenomenon of esports.

I am certain that the discussions over the coming days will not only foster critical reflection, but will also inspire meaningful dialogue on how we can adapt to a rapidly changing world.

The NOAs should take an active and forward-thinking role in bridging tradition with innovation, in promoting human-centred values in every evolving context and in inspiring new generations of thinkers, creators, and peacemakers.

Let us use the momentum of this 18th Session to recommit ourselves. Let us network, collaborate, and share. Let us forge a future where every country has an active and effective NOA, where Olympic education becomes part of national educational systems.

In closing, I wish to express my deepest gratitude to all of you here today – for your passion, and your belief in the Olympic ideals. The International Olympic Academy has always been a home for dialogue, reflection, and inspiration. And it will continue to be so – with your participation, with your ideas, and with your friendship!

May this gathering be a turning point. May it strengthen our bonds. And may it mark the beginning of new alliances, new dreams, and new impact!

Let us walk this journey together!

Thank you!

ADDRESS AND OPENING
of the Works of the Session
by the President of the International Olympic Academy
Professor Charilaos TSOLAKIS

Your Royal Highness, Prince Faisal Bin Bandar Bin Sultan Abdulaziz Al Saud,
Mr President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee and my friend, Isidoros Kouvelos,
Mr Panagiotopoulos, Mayor of Ancient Olympia,
Esteemed delegates of National Olympic Academies and National Olympic Committees,

It is with great honour and pleasure that I welcome you to Ancient Olympia and the International Olympic Academy (IOA) premises as the new Pre-

sident of the IOA. I would like to extend my gratitude to the current President of the Hellenic Olympic Committee, Isidoros Kouvelos, for entrusting me with this important role, which has multiple administrative and educational challenges. I am committed to addressing these with a high sense of responsibility, supported by the capable staff of the Academy, whom many of you have known for years.

During his 16-year tenure, my friend Isidoros significantly enhanced the role of the IOA in Olympic education. I am confident that with the strengthened cooperation between the IOA and the HOC, the Academy will continue to succeed in its mission.

Through my extensive involvement in sports and educational activities, I am



well-acquainted with the IOA's history, spanning over more than six decades, and recognise the significance of our collaboration with National Olympic Academies.

The IOA's mission and course is inextricably linked to the support of National Olympic Academies, which, with their deep understanding of local communities, effectively convey the values of Olympism.

I recall with great emotion the late Nikos Filaretos, former President of the IOA, elaborating on the pivotal role played by the esteemed IOC President, Juan Antonio Samaranch, in advocating for the establishment of National Academies by their respective Olympic Committees.

The IOA is acknowledged nowadays as the global hub for education in and through Olympism, shaping future generations of role models, leaders, and change-makers. Committed to achieving excellence and guided by timeless and universal values, we offer a transformative experience that fosters the holistic development of individuals, both personally and professionally.

Guided by the historic legacy of Olympia and driven by rigorous academic teaching and inquiry, our global network of distinguished experts provides specialised educational programmes. As you all have experienced all these years of close collaboration, we promote the free exchange of ideas and encourage vigorous debate about the future of Olympism and its application to everyday life. We believe that education, guided by the universal and timeless values of Olympism, holds the power to unlock every individual's potential, bridge cultural differences, foster mutual understanding, and create a more compassionate and interconnected world.

Dear Friends,

In the past, Olympic education mainly centred on fundamental Olympic values such as the pursuit of excellence, respect for diversity, fair play, friendship, and peace. These concepts were primarily promoted to young people to help shape their character through sports. However, over time, Olympic education has expanded to address broader societal issues, aiming not only to improve individual character but also to positively impact society.

The IOC's Agendas for 2014–2020 and 2020–2025 have played a crucial role in this development, addressing sensitive societal issues and offering guidelines for change. These agendas, introduced by President Bach under the motto "Change or be Changed", encompass several recommendations designed to usher the Olympic Movement into a new era. Topics such as gender equality, sustainable development, inclusion, credibility, good governance, economic

OPENING CEREMONY



Presenting the delegates of the NOAs and NOCs.

resilience, athletes' rights and responsibilities, digitalisation, virtual sports, and engagement with gaming communities are some of the issues covered.

Naturally, this broadening of the Movement's goals also resulted in the expected expansion of the cognitive subjects of Olympic education. These subjects were respectively broadened in order to convey the new messages of Olympism to the interested groups, and consequently, the age range of those to whom Olympic education is addressed was also expanded! This led the National Olympic Academies to change their programmes and try to meet the needs and requests of the modern era.

The International Olympic Academy has also responded to these changes. Recent sessions and seminars have focused on the IOC's new priorities and recommendations.

Dear Delegates,

The digitalisation of the Olympic Movement, the emergence of virtual sports, and greater engagement with video gaming communities, as outlined in the 2020–2025 IOC Agenda Recommendations Numbers 8 and 9, have inspired the IOA to focus on the theme of "The Future of Sport. Olympic Education and AI: Process of Transformation" for 2025. This topic will be discussed during this year's NOAs/NOCs Delegates' Session.

How will technology influence the immediate and near future of sport? What is the future of virtual games, and how close are we to integrating them into the Olympic concept? How receptive is society to using AI in Olympic education?

We are honoured today to have His Royal Highness, Prince Faisal Bin Bandar Bin Sultan Abdulaziz, President of the International Esport Federation, with us. He is a prominent advocate of the esports movement, which has captivated millions of young people worldwide.

In closing, ladies and gentlemen, I assure you that the IOA, our Director, Makis Asimakopoulos, the head of the Olympic Academies sector, Ms Alexandra Karaïskou, and I will continue to support your activities in every possible way. We will maintain open communication with you, closely addressing your challenges, especially following the 2024 survey that clarified the status of active and inactive Academies worldwide.

Our goal is to expand the network of Academies to every continent, providing new incentives for fruitful operations. During this Session, Makis will introduce a new initiative aimed at enhancing your functionality and encouraging innovative actions.

Enjoy the tranquillity and beauty of this place over the coming days, and as you engage in idea exchanges within the peaceful environment of the IOA and Ancient Olympia, set aside what divides you and focus on what unites us all.

Our primary concern is to build bridges, converge ideas and diverse opinions, and promote and enhance Olympic education through a shared understanding driven by the Olympic spirit.

I wish you a pleasant stay and productive work.

Thank you.



The students of the Master's Degree Programme in Olympic Studies attended the Session's Opening Ceremony.



Reciting excerpts from Pierre de Coubertin writings at the Coubertin Grove.





Laying of wreaths at the Pierre de Coubertin commemorative stele and the Carl Diem and Ioannis Ketseas monument by the IOA President, Prof. Charilaos Tsolakis and HRH Prince Faisal bin Bandar bin Sultan Al Saud, and the Session participants (previous page) respectively.



Excerpt from
Pierre de Coubertin Writings

"It is not just internationalism and democracy, the foundations of the new human society now being constructed in civilized nations, but science as well that is involved in this sentiment. Through its constant progress, science has given man new ways to cultivate his body, to guide and strengthen nature, and to snatch the body from the constraints of unbridled passions to which it had become subject in the name of individual freedom."

"The philosophic foundation of modern Olympism", in *Le Sport Suisse*, vol. 31, August 7, 1935, p. 1 (*Pierre de Coubertin (1863-1937), Olympism, Selected Writings*, Norbert Müller (ed.), Lausanne, IOC, 2000, p. 580).



**Excerpt from
Pierre de Coubertin Writings**

«Ce ne sont pas seulement l'Internationalisme et la Démocratie, assises de la nouvelle société humaine en voie d'édification chez les nations civilisées, c'est aussi la Science qui est intéressée en cela. Par ses progrès continus, elle a fourni à l'homme de nouveaux moyens de cultiver son corps, de guider, de redresser la nature, et d'arracher ce corps à l'étreinte de passions déréglées auxquelles, sous prétexte de liberté individuelle, on le laissait s'abandonner.»

«Les assises philosophiques de l'Olympisme moderne», dans *Le Sport Suisse*, vol. 31,
7 août 1935, p. 1.





Proceedings

ANCIENT OLYMPIA, 10–14 MAY 2025



LECTURES



The opinions of the lecturers do not necessarily reflect those of the International Olympic Academy. Out of respect for multiculturalism and diversity of scientific research, we do not intervene in the way each lecturer chooses to present his/her bibliography and footnotes.

PANEL DISCUSSION ON THE SUBJECT:
“DRIVING GLOBAL GROWTH: ESPORTS AND SPORTS THROUGH
THE LENS OF SAUDI ARABIA’S VISION 2030”

HRH Prince Faisal bin Bandar bin Sultan AL SAUD (KSA)
*Chairman of Saudi Esports Federation & Vice Chairman
of Savvy Games Group*

Dr Makis ASIMAKOPOULOS (IOA)
IOA Director

Dr Asimakopoulos: *How can we educate and convince parents, governments, and decision-makers that esports is a real and legitimate sport, and not just sedentary video gaming?*

HRH Prince Faisal: From what we discussed yesterday, I would say it’s similar to many traditional sports. Take archery, for example. At face value, it looks like someone standing still pulling a bow. But if you look deeper, the amount of training needed to build the right muscles, to control breathing, to stay focused for hours, to hit the target consistently—all of that requires stamina and discipline. Esports is the same.

One of the common questions I get is about violence. People say, “Aren’t esports violent? Look at first-person shooters.” But if you look at boxing, that’s also violent at face value—you’re hitting someone in the face; there’s blood. Yet for years people have recognised it as a sport because beneath that, it’s about



strategy: when to attack, when to defend, when to absorb, when to move. That's what makes boxing not just violent, but a beautiful game.

The same applies to rugby. At face value it looks like people running into each other. But once you analyse the tactics—how they move, how they pass, when to place the ball—you see the beauty of the game. Football is the same. If you don't know the sport, all you see is players diving and wasting time. But if you understand it, you see the constant tactics, positioning, movement, and communication. That's what makes all sport beautiful. And once you watch esports with someone who can explain it, you see how similar it is.

I grew up playing football. I was a football player before injuries in both knees forced me to stop. That's when I moved more into esports. And I found the same passion, the same excitement, and the same language of sport. The great thing about sport is that language. If you take a football anywhere in the world, you'll find people who know instinctively how to play: I pass, you move, I defend, you attack. Esports is the same. You can log into a server anywhere in the world and play with people who speak different languages, yet you all understand the game.

One of the most powerful moments I saw was at the 2018 Asian Games when esports was first included as a non-medal event. The Saudi national team was nervous at the opening ceremony. Then the players began asking each other about their gamer tags, not their real names. Suddenly, they realised they already knew each other from online play. They remembered matches, moves, games they had played together or against each other. In minutes, people from different countries became a community. They spent the rest of the week together, even playing with athletes from other sports. Esports turned a big, intimidating stage into a small, connected world.

This is why we created Gamers Without Borders—games and servers without borders. Anyone with a device can join. More than half of all gaming is now mobile. It connects people everywhere and builds an unparalleled global community.

In Saudi Arabia, we've developed a national gaming and esports strategy, supported by the government. We have a local league, the Esports World Cup, and initiatives like Gamers Without Borders, which began during COVID when everyone was online and unable to meet physically.

My recommendation is watch a tournament, whether online or in person. Most countries now have esports federations. Talk to them, attend their

events. The community you will see is passionate, growing, and eager to engage. An interesting fact is that players of simulated sports titles like EAFC or NBA2K are 60 percent more likely to play the real sport than those who don't.

Every year, roughly 100 million people are born, and they grow up in a world where gaming is not just entertainment but their primary way of connecting. It is how they communicate, build communities, and consume media. Our role is to teach them what it means to be an athlete, how that makes them better individuals and better members of the global community. That applies to both traditional and esports athletes.

Today, between the Global Esports Federation and the International Esports Federation, there are over 160 member federations. Around 45 are recognised by Olympic Committees, and another 15 by governments. My advice is to start by reaching out locally. Every country has people building esports communities, and they can give you more relevant insights than anyone else.

At the same time, esports must also integrate into the wider sports community. They need to embrace Olympic values and understand what is required to grow as part of the industry. In Saudi Arabia, our Federation was created under the Olympic Committee so we had to adopt those values early. We were also fortunate in 2018 to have the FIFAe World Champion, which gave us a clear example of a real career path.

There is talent everywhere. What these players need is a platform. And if you give them even the smallest opportunity, they will surprise you with their dedication, their ambition, and their drive to grow not only esports, but the wider community of sport.

Dr Asimakopoulos: *In Greece, strict legislation currently limits esports to simulations of traditional sports, leaving most popular titles outside legal recognition. Given government concerns over physical inactivity and violence in games, how can we engage with our youth through esports while addressing these issues?*

HRH Prince Faisal: There are countless examples of how esports can bring communities together and change lives. One that stands out is a young man from Kenya, Brian Dianga. He had a very difficult childhood with an abusive

father and early involvement in gangs. Through gaming, he managed to escape that environment, create an income and move his mother to safety. Today, he advocates for gaming in schools, uses esports to encourage reading, and even created gaming buses so children can enjoy games on their way to school, giving them an incentive to attend. Stories like his exist all over the world.

Women's participation in esports is another area we've worked hard on. Globally, only about 5 percent of players are women. In Saudi Arabia, we've reached 20 percent, largely thanks to two individuals. One is Najd Al Fahad, who won the Collegiate FIFAE World Championship in 2022. She took the brave step of speaking publicly about her passion and success. The other is the Valorant Falcons Vega team, led by a Saudi woman whose gamer tag is *Madv*. Her team is so strong that they compete in Europe for higher-level competition. Putting them on TV, in interviews and magazines, has shown other young women that this can be a valid career path.

In every country, there are young men and women playing these games with incredible stories. They can benefit from your ecosystem, and your ecosystem will benefit from them. They can speak directly to issues of sport, health and discipline.

One example is Abdelaziz Shihri, who won the FIFAE World Championship in 2015. He was overweight, and his parents pushed him to lose weight. The year he did, he won the world championship. He is now one of our biggest advocates for healthy living as well as esports. In Saudi Arabia, our Federation is built on three pillars: physical health, mental health, and social health. These are the foundations of everything we do.

So again, I say use the community. Almost half the world's population plays games. If you find the right role models and elevate them as heroes, they will bring people to you in droves. You understand the sports ecosystem and the importance of physical health. They can learn from you, and they need it—because it will make them better esports players and athletes.

In Saudi Arabia, we also link esports with traditional sports. At every major sports event, we run an esports event alongside. At boxing, we host Street Fighter and Tekken. At football, we run EAFC. This brings young gamers to live sporting events. If even a small number transition from esports to traditional sport, we help local federations—and the reverse is also true.

One of our Tekken world champions, currently ranked top five or six globally, won a silver medal in karate at the 2018 Asian Games. He began in



The Session opened with an interesting panel discussion with HRH Prince Faisal bin Bandar bin Sultan Al Saud, the IOA Director, Dr Makis Asimakopoulou and the NOAs/NOCs Delegates.

traditional sport and transitioned to esports. With EAFC, we send players and casters to commentate on traditional football matches. They know strategies, players, and tactics just as well as veteran commentators. These overlaps are real, and we are actively promoting them.

I promise you, if you make even a small outreach to your local communities, they will respond enthusiastically. They want to be part of this, they want to grow, and they want to compete on the global stage.

Anyone who would like to attend our events in Saudi Arabia is very welcome. We would be glad to show you what we're building at both the professional and community level. Our biggest investment remains in community leagues—school, university, and open competitions. And the turnout is massive. People want to play, and they want to be part of this professional ecosystem.

Dr Asimakopoulos: *Could you briefly explain what the Esports World Cup is and how it's organised?*

HRH Prince Faisal: As you mentioned, in 2020 I was granted permission and the budget to host an international esports event in Saudi Arabia. That year was a particularly challenging one for in-person events, so we transformed it into an online event called Gamers Without Borders. We built an educational platform with webinars, bringing in industry leaders to teach and discuss the sector. More than 400,000 people from around the world participated.

We also created a community component with hundreds of daily tournaments across multiple games and servers, supported by sponsors who provided small prizes—a phone, a hundred dollars, things like that. On top of this, the Saudi government hosted a professional tournament, inviting the best teams and players globally. We put up a \$10 million prize pool, with the condition that all winnings went to one of our partner charities chosen by the players.

That ran for four years, raising \$4 million directly from us, working with UNHCR, UNICEF, International Medical Corps, Gavi, Direct Relief, and the King Salman Humanitarian Aid and Relief Center. What mattered even more was that, after the first year, charities began doing outreach to the gaming community themselves. They launched initiatives and research on how to engage gamers, and alongside the \$40 million raised from our programme, they raised another \$30 million through that outreach. It showed us that we could be part of a truly global esports and gaming community.

In 2022 and 2023 we launched Gamers8, our homegrown event. In the first year, 400 top athletes competed, and 1.3 million people visited our venue in Riyadh—in the middle of summer, when the city is usually empty because temperatures reach 52 degrees. In 2023 we doubled the participation and brought in 2.4 million attendees. Online, viewership jumped from 60 million in the first year to 80 million in the second, with 2.5 billion and then 4 billion social media impressions.

These events allowed us to professionalise. We created the Esports World Cup Foundation in 2023, with the sole mission of running the Esports World Cup. Last year, we hosted 22 tournaments with 1,500 players, and 2.6 million people attended in person—20 percent from abroad. Online, the event generated more than 500 million hours of content watched, 250

million unique users, and over 5 billion impressions. And this was just over two months, July and August.

The World Cup is also tied to our national strategy. By 2030, we aim for 1 percent of GDP to come from gaming and esports—about 50 billion Saudi riyals, or \$13 billion—creating 39,000 jobs. These are not only players, but coaches, referees, production staff, stage crews, event managers, catering, and many roles in game development, QA, legal, finance, and more. Even Goldman Sachs has now built a 200-person division dedicated to the gaming industry.

In Saudi Arabia the growth has been dramatic. In 2018, we had six professional players and one team. Today, we have 1,200 players, over 150 teams, and 3,000 players in our academy system who will graduate into the ecosystem in the next two to three years—as players, coaches, referees, production and event staff.

The impact on GDP, job creation, and community engagement is massive. Esports is a gateway into the wider gaming industry, and gaming itself is a gateway into many other industries. I've seen people move from esports into banking, into technology, into telecoms. Once young men and women learn how to be disciplined athletes and positive members of society, as well as gamers, they can change the future of your country just as they have changed ours.

ESPORTS SHAPING THE NEW DIGITAL ERA OF SPORT AND EDUCATION

Thanos KARAGROUNAS (GRE)

*Chief Impact Officer,
Global Esports Federation*



Distinguished Delegates, Esteemed Members of the Olympic Movement and the International Community, Ladies and Gentlemen,
Friends from across the Globe,

It is both an honour and a privilege to be with you today presenting a subject that is redefining the entire landscape of sport and education as we know it, in ways we could have barely imagined few years ago.

First, please allow me to thank the IOA and the HOC President for their invitation and warm hospitality.

We stand at the crossroads of a remarkable convergence—where technology, innovation, youth culture, education, and athletic competition are meeting in a digital arena.

At the heart of this convergence lies esports—not a trend, but a global movement; not a replacement for traditional sport, but an enabler that, in many ways, inspires the evolution of it.

Video games are more than gaming. They are a social, educational, and economic phenomenon that demands our attention—and more importantly, our strategic vision.

Whenever we speak about the future of work, the future of sport, the future of education, the future in general..., gaming and esports are not only part of

the discussion; they are now recognised as a strategic enabler and a vehicle for impact. A number of countries are already embracing them as a core element of their national vision for development and of their strategies for youth engagement and impact.

Today, I will be covering the following topics

- The Rise of Gaming and Esports
- Esports & Sports
- Esports & Education
- Considerations

As we also discussed yesterday, and as HRH Prince Faisal noted, more than 3 billion people globally are engaged in gaming and esports, generating, according to the latest research, close to 455 billion USD annually. Something that also came to a surprise to me and many others is that video gaming is actually bigger than the film and music industries combined.

A few key elements to highlight are it's social, accessible, fun, and it's entertaining. A large portion of the population in majority 18–34 (around 38%), 85% for example in the US, play video games, and over 40% claim to do so daily.

It is also very important because it's about relevance, appeal and engagement. Esports has the attention of the young population and the younger audience, and a lot of tournaments attract millions of viewers from around the world because of their nature of digital broadcast and engagement.

The average age of esports fans is 33 years old, so it's not just kids playing and enjoying, it's actually the entire population. You will notice also that there is a big correlation with the share of internet users (and this is a key factor that enabled the rise of gaming). In most countries, internet penetration is more than 90%, in some cases it reaches 97–98%, and part of that, close to 70–80%, play video games. So, as we enhance connectivity and more people have access to the internet, that percentage obviously increases. However, it is also very important in terms of access to services, such as education, health care, and banking. So, internet connectivity is not only important for gaming, it's also important for society.

The population of gamers worldwide is pretty much balanced when it comes to gender (55% male, 45% female); 71% of kids under 18, 65% of adults. A large majority of Gen Z (more than 80%) is engaged with esports and 70% of millennials are engaged in this activity.

In some cases, it can be alarming, and it is, I share the concern, I am also a parent, that people even spend 7–8 hours gaming a week. The average per

day is between 2–3 hours, something that we can discuss later, but the reality that we face every day is that people spend a lot of time on their screens, on their mobile devices, and a large part of their time is spent on video gaming. Of course, with challenges come many opportunities and benefits, as identified by research, when it comes to entertainment: relaxation, a sense of community, social connections and interactions and digital literacy (very important for the future of work). Notice that according to the latest report from the OECD, digital literacy is the number one factor when it comes to evolution of jobs, the skills that are created, and young people are learning these skills through gaming. Also, it is very important to note the synergies with the education industry and ecosystem, which we can discuss in more detail later, but it is very important as it drives technological innovation. A large number of countries, in the EU and elsewhere, are investing large sums of money nowadays in innovation in terms of infrastructure, entrepreneurship and tech innovations which act as a gateway for young people to harness their future.

A big part of the whole discussion is around the digital revolution. Gaming and esports are part of this digital era, and the pace of this transformation is actually unprecedented, mainly due to the rapid advancements in technology. You will notice advancements in AI, connectivity, 5G, satellite communications and cloud computing, all of which drive forward development in our world which is becoming more and more digital and more virtual as well.

The enabling factors for gaming and esports have been, of course, technology, internet connectivity and also events. The events bring the community together, not only virtually. A lot of the big events are actually attracting thousands of fans. We notice more and more young people are engaged and involved in creating digital content, not only consuming it. They play and create, and often they surprise us, as parents and educators. The cost of access has helped a lot. The reduction in terms of connectivity and equipment allow for more inclusion, and of course the modern culture which is digital and is around social media helps a lot.

Something also very important to discuss and understand is that digital is transformational. It's disruptive, technology is advancing, and it is changing commerce, finance and banking, health care, entertainment, education and sport. Every single aspect of our lives is actually changing. Technology is good. It helped us progress as a civilization over the years.

In simple words, esports is the competitive part of video gaming. It is organised video game competitions where people come together, either one-to-one or in

teams, to compete, often with prize money. Sometimes in global competitions like the ones we organise, national teams compete against national teams. For example, in our world championships we had more than 100 teams and close to 1,000 athletes competing in one event with a few thousand people attending physically and millions watching.

Big prize money is part of how the industry works. It attracts interest, but not all of them are about prize money. A lot of international events don't have any prize at all. Teams compete to represent their countries and for the glory of their flag and representing their country.

So, it's more than just gaming. It's about entertainment and social interaction. It's about learning and development, cognitive development, skills acquisition, decision making, problem solving, team work, imagination, creativity. These are all skills being developed via engagement with video gaming and esports. Sometimes players notice; sometimes they don't, but they develop, especially as we progress to more structured, organised ways. Of course, having the support of national federations and governments, with programmes that bring all that together, we can develop and enhance these skills further. So, enormous opportunity for physical skills development. I know a lot of the questions and debate are around the definition of sport and whether esports involves physical activity; the key message here is that athletes follow similar regimes to professional sport athletes. They take care of their nutrition and their relaxation, they have physiotherapists, psychologists and they have coaches – which is what top professional esports teams do – as they cannot compete without physical training. There is also, as I mentioned, a lot of mental and cognitive training in terms of concentration, focus, creativity, imagination and managing stress, but also multi-tasking and making decisions under the pressure of time.

In terms of recognition, today we are many steps ahead of where we were 5 or 10 years ago. Our organisation, the Global Esports Federation (GEF), is based in Singapore. What is critically important to note is our mission for a safe, healthy and inclusive esports ecosystem. It's not just about organising events; it's how we leverage and harness the power of gaming and esports for good in terms of personal and professional development, but also for society as a whole. We are forming international partnerships with the UN, we are a member of the UN SDG advisory group, we are member of the UNESCO Chair on Governance and Social Responsibility, we are actively engaged in UNESCO events like MINEPS and CIGEPS, we make contributions, and we convene like-minded

organisations and individuals who want to help and support. There are a number of programmes, for example, the UNESCO Fit for Life programme, promoting physical activity within schools. ITU: A lot of work is happening with ITU, mainly in terms of global connectivity. Let's not forget half the world is connected while the other half is disconnected. Half the world doesn't have access to internet, and a large part doesn't have access to electricity and drinking water. These are some of the social issues that we are trying to address as a community. The environment, of course, is another important one. So, there is a lot of work happening around social impact and, as I mentioned, we joined and are part of UN Digital and UNGA. We celebrate international days—for example standing together with the refugees; campaigns with the WHO in terms of mental health and the environment. We are doing a lot around the world in terms of education, disadvantage communities, and the rights of women and children. So, there are a lot of stories to be told; there is momentum; there is energy; there is interest, and our job as a responsible organisation is to help make that happen. We are doing that with international partnerships, especially UN system organisations and regional sport organisations like the European Olympic Committees, OCA, PanAm, the Commonwealth, UNESCO, ITU, UNICEF, WHO, UNHCR, ECOSOC and UNDP. Also, we bring together partners from around the world.

Esports are a big topic of discussion: Olympic Esports and the unanimous decision of the IOC Executive Board last July to establish the Olympic Esports Games, the cooperation with the Saudi Esports Federation and the Saudi Government, the first games announced for 2027 in Saudi Arabia, and, before that, the Olympic Esports Week in Singapore in 2023. The IOC has also established the IOC Esports Commission. Twenty-one international federations are members of GEF. There are several key elements in our collaboration: how we can harness the energy of young people and how we can connect with young people and attract new audiences and new fans when interest and participation in sport are declining. Young people are more interested in new and more immersive experiences.

Also, it can be very helpful for sport simulation and training athletes, especially with the use of new technologies such as AR and VR which are changing the landscape. Some IFs are already active in virtual sports. They are not yet mainstream when it comes to esports. Let's be honest, mobile is mainstream right now but active and virtual sports are the future and, in a way, we could build that future together: new experiences, new sports, new games, which are more



Thanos Karagrounas from the Global Esports Federation spoke about the role of Esports in shaping the digital future of Sport and Education.

captivating, more immersive and also allow for different competition formats. Virtual Taekwondo, combat sports, cycling, rowing, sailing, and also simulation sports, are very popular, especially racing.

When it comes to esports and education, a subject that is very close to our heart and also very important for young people, a number of organisations and institutions, such as colleges and academies, are developing curricula based on gaming and esports. They are using new technologies, especially in STEP subjects, but this is also more and more about digital skills and the creative economy. Platforms like Minecraft and Roblox are very popular; you learn and develop by using these platforms. Research and education are also very important. Gaming and esports are still subjects that require academic research, and the overall concept is obviously human capital development. No one is actually suggesting that kids should spend more time playing games. The objective is how we can use the time they spent for good: how they can learn, develop personally and professionally. This, of course, remains our main objective. Just to highlight two examples, Minecraft Education and Roblox bring subjects like history, culture

and science alive. There are hundreds of millions of kids playing these platforms every day; I think Minecraft has been sold more than 300 million times. These platforms are in schools all around the world. Kids spend on average 6–8 hours a day on screens, 2.5 hours on average on gaming, but the important thing is that research has indicated that personalised digital educational games can improve learning outcomes, improve satisfaction and improve the overall enjoyment of the learning process. The key point here is that gaming, gaming technologies and these types of platforms make the educational experience impactful and more entertaining. They can support teachers and learners and help kids discover and interact with subjects like STEM, but also languages, history, culture, finance, sustainability and the environment. There is a lot that young people can learn through that. It also improves concentration, memory, creativity and teamwork. So, the key point is to enable impactful education through the use of technology and through the use of gaming, to boost motivation and create opportunities to practice. Basically, games are based on challenges. You are offered a challenge and the whole point is that you have to work to overcome the challenge and you learn; you compete. It's fan-engaging entertainment. We are working together with organisations to build challenges, for example, on how to build a sustainable city and how you can make a neighbourhood eco-friendlier. Any type of challenge you can imagine, you can design and gamify and then get kids engaged in that process.

Something that I also think is very interesting for all of us is some stats around global context: 1 out of 5 people are not in schools or education, employment or training, 3 out of those 5 are female, over 340 million children between 5–19 are overweight or obese. Obesity and physical inactivity are huge problems and they are not problems introduced by gaming. They are a societal problem, and we aim to address and contribute in that direction. This is also the reason why we work with organisations like UNESCO and the WHO. Also, mental health issues: 1 out of 3 people in the EU are at risk of poverty or social exclusion. The active engagement of youth in sustainable development efforts is actually fundamental to achieving these goals. For example, physical activity is very important. There are programmes and we are making efforts with international organisations. There are also apps and platforms that inspire youth to be more active and help them to adopt a more active healthy balanced lifestyle. This is our mission. We are also trying to inspire others as to how we can enhance physical, social and mental health, inclusion and diversity and deliver programmes that

strengthen those aspects, programmes that care for employment opportunities, career development and entrepreneurship, global citizenship and sustainable development, so kids can adopt behaviours and attitudes and learn what it means to be a global citizen and, in the process, promote creativity, innovation, peace and human rights.

Final thoughts and considerations: it is a fine balancing act between challenges and opportunities. The reality is that the traditional model of sport as we know it is changing. Esports brings a new dimension: it's not only about physical activity, it's also about cognitive development, strategic decision making, and mental endurance. In a sense, esports is redefining concepts: what it means to be an athlete, what a game is, what a sport is. It is part of the discussion, it is happening, and it actually redefines concepts like athletic identity.

Professional esports players, have no doubt, follow extremely hard training regimes. You don't reach elite levels if you don't train professionally. They practice daily for hours, working on team coordination, strategy development and physical fitness, and they take care of their mental health. The reality is that technology-enabled innovations are challenging concepts, systems and ways of working; the digital era is here. We should embrace it. It is more inclusive, hyperconnected, immersive and global. Esports resonate with youth. Youth is already there and we need to reach them where they are and interact.

Technology is reshaping every industry, including sport. The lines between physical and digital are blurred. That's not necessarily a good or bad thing, but it is happening. However, with opportunity comes responsibility. Esports can be a pillar for education. Obviously we must build the appropriate governance, ethics, and infrastructure to support it. This means, for example, developing international standards for health and wellbeing and fair play, developing clear academic pathways, promoting research and digital literacy programmes – digital literacy is a huge issue around the world – promoting a safer, healthier and more inclusive digital ecosystem and encouraging public-private partnerships. Ensuring the support of the government and educational institutions is really important.

As senior leaders, academics and sport officials, we have a critical role to play. We must not only respond to the rise of esports – we must help shape its future with intention and foresight.

Let us not mistake esports for a passing phenomenon or a youth distraction. It is a cultural movement, a new educational medium, and a legitimate activity in the digital age.

Esports doesn't just coexist with traditional sports; it transforms the idea of athletic identity by proving that excellence, discipline, and competition can thrive in digital arenas.

The question is not whether we should embrace esports — but how will we do so with integrity, vision, and global cooperation?

If we can align esports with our broader goals for education, wellness, innovation, and social connection, then we are not just witnessing the future — we are building it.

Let us seize this moment. Let us champion a new era where esports and education come together to inspire the next generation of thinkers, players, and leaders.

Thank you very much for your attention.

ONE YEAR ON: ADVANCING THE OLYMPIC AI AGENDA AND ITS IMPACT

Joshua SUH (IOC)

*Artificial Intelligence Business Manager,
Digital Engagement & Marketing, IOC*



1. Welcome and Introduction

Your Excellencies, Presidents and Secretary Generals, Distinguished Guests, Ladies and Gentlemen, my name is Joshua Suh, and I am the AI Business Manager at the IOC. It's an honour to be here today to present an overview of the first year of the Olympic AI Agenda – its impact and what's to come.

2. Why Do We Need an Olympic AI Agenda?

The Olympic AI Agenda was launched in April last year. You may ask, "Why do we need an Olympic AI Agenda? We never had an Olympic Data Agenda or an Olympic Internet Agenda. So, why now, for AI?"

While AI itself is not new – its roots trace back to Dartmouth College in 1955 – recent developments, like generative AI with tools such as ChatGPT, have made AI much more accessible to the public.

AI presents many opportunities. It can accelerate progress in sport, advancing fairness, excellence, and solidarity. However, it also presents risks that must be managed with proper governance and oversight.

This is why the IOC acted quickly to launch a strategy, setting out clear ambitions and a path forward for both the Olympic Movement and the wider sports world.

3. IOC Roles

The IOC has three key roles:

- **Pioneer:** leading AI asset creation to ensure fairness and equal access
- **Catalyst:** facilitating knowledge sharing and AI initiatives across the Olympic Movement
- **Guardian:** overseeing AI initiatives to promote accessibility and AI safety in sport

As a pioneer, the IOC has launched 13 AI initiatives over the past year, many of which were activated during the Paris Olympic Games. We have 14 more initiatives planned for 2025 and early 2026. I will highlight some of these past and upcoming initiatives shortly.

As a catalyst, we've been working with our TOP partners to implement and execute AI initiatives. We've also hosted AI engagement forums to exchange ideas, best practices, and industry standards with Olympic Movement stakeholders.

Feedback from participants has been overwhelmingly positive. Many have asked for more regular sessions and discussions on various AI-related topics.

Additionally, we've conducted interviews with digital and tech staff from International Federations to understand their AI implementation journeys. Our early findings show that while teams are capable and eager, resources are limited. Many would appreciate basic AI frameworks or policies that they could apply directly to their organisations.

In response to this feedback, and in our role as a guardian, we are collaborating with our TOP partner Deloitte to develop a Trustworthy AI Framework for Olympic Movement stakeholders.

This framework will serve as a practical guide, especially for smaller organisations that may not have dedicated AI experts. It will help project teams identify risks and ensure that AI tools are trustworthy, safe, and ethical.

Additionally, we have created a series of introductory AI training modules aimed at helping people—including athletes—build a foundational understanding of AI technology, principles, and tools.

4. Five Focus Areas

Guided by our core principles and committed to benefiting all stakeholders within the Olympic Movement, the IOC has set a strategic goal to leverage AI effectively

across five key focus areas. I will now introduce each focus area, along with an example of an initiative for each.

5. Athlete Cyber Abuse Protection

The first focus area is “Supporting Athletes, Clean Competition, and Safe Sport”. Athletes are at the heart of the Olympic Movement. From talent identification to injury recovery, the IOC believes AI can transform the lives and careers of athletes worldwide.

During the Paris Olympic Games, we deployed an AI system to rapidly analyse 2.4 million posts targeting athletes, officials and their entourage on social media platforms. This included X (formerly Twitter), Meta channels, and TikTok, across more than 35 languages.

The AI tool detected 152,000 posts containing discriminatory or threatening content, which either violated platform terms of service or could breach legal provisions in relevant jurisdictions. These posts were sent for human review, and 10,200 were subsequently reported to the platforms for action.

The key idea behind this solution is real-time abuse detection, prompting platforms to act before athletes even see the harmful content.

6. Senegal Talent ID

The second focus area is “Ensuring Equal Access to the Benefits of AI”. AI has the potential to support the IOC’s goals of universality, inclusivity, and fair sport. It can create new opportunities for athletes, coaches, and countries with limited access to top facilities, while also improving fairness in competition through better judging and refereeing.

In March, the team travelled to Senegal to test young athletes as part of a talent identification initiative. Unlike traditional methods, AI was used to accelerate the process and make it more scientific, even in remote areas.

In less than a week, the team managed to:

- Test over 1,000 young athletes
- Identify 48 high performers
- Discover one exceptional 14-year-old football player, now recognised as a Category 1 Elite level talent.



Joshua Suh, AI Business Manager in IOC, focused on the Olympic AI Agenda during his lecture and the question-and-answer session.

7. Energy Data Management

The third focus area is "Optimising Olympic and Paralympic Games Operations with a Focus on Sustainability". AI can streamline operations, reduce costs, and enhance sustainability throughout the Games.

In collaboration with Alibaba, the IOC created a cloud-based Energy Data Integration Platform, the first of its kind for major events. It integrates live and historical data from multiple sources, including energy consumption during the Paris 2024 Games.

For Paris 2024, the platform showed:

- Total energy consumption of just under 15 GWh, sourced from 100% green electricity, saving 2,350 tons of carbon
- Peak electrical demand of 57 MW on 30 July at 16.00, with 1 GWh of energy consumed across all venues
- Real-time energy usage and diagnostics, supporting operational efficiency.

This data enables future Games to estimate energy needs and secure green energy sources, contributing to sustainability goals and cost savings.

Next steps include expanding the platform for MiCo and Dakar, with further enhancements under discussion.

8. Auto-highlight Generation

The fourth focus area is "Growing Engagement with People". We use AI to enhance the experience of the Olympic Games and events, offering immersive virtual experiences for fans.

Key highlights:

- OBS Automatic Highlights Generation leveraged AI to create tailored highlights from over 30 sports, improving access to broadcast footage.
- This resulted in more than 11,000 hours of content and over 100,000 videos produced.
- Fifteen national broadcasters used these automated highlights, with the Philippines producing the most.
- Swimming and track and field were the most highlighted sports.

9. Olympic Archives

The fifth focus area is "Driving Efficiency Across the Management of the IOC and Sport". AI tools are being used to enhance decision-making, knowledge sharing, task automation, and operational efficiency across the Olympic Movement.

Key achievement:

- In collaboration with Alibaba Cloud, the IOC developed the Sports AI Platform to improve the management of Olympic media archives.
- This platform enables intelligent understanding and recognition of century-old Olympic content, enhancing AI-driven search and highlight reel production.
- It significantly boosts the visibility and accessibility of Olympic materials, maximising the value and impact of historical content.

10. What's Next: Olympic AI Assistants

In terms of what's next, we are working on providing a suite of Olympic AI Assistants – which are GPT-like solutions – to some of our key stakeholders.

Our goal is to ensure that NOCs, fans, OCOGs and athletes have access to safe, secure, and tailored AI solutions which enhance access to information, operational efficiency, and engagement.

We are developing these assistants in partnership with Alibaba, ensuring that they meet the specific needs of our stakeholders and integrate seamlessly within our ecosystem.

Let's dive a bit deeper into the Olympic AI Assistant for NOCs—which we will refer to as NOC GPT for now.

11. NOC GPT – Objectives

There are 3 key objectives that we are aiming to achieve through the release of NOC GPT.

1. We recognise that we, as the IOC, provide lots of information to NOCs in the form of documents that are hundreds of pages long. On the one hand, these documents are comprehensive so all the information is in there; on the other hand, the information is difficult to track down and indigestible. So, by allowing AI to help search through the documents and provide links to the specific paragraphs that users are looking for, it should make the information easier to navigate for users.
2. By allowing users to ask questions in a conversational manner and to ask follow-up questions, we are able to understand the user intent and provide accurate, tailored responses to their queries.
3. Whilst we will not translate official documents into other languages, we are still able to help users in their queries by allowing them to ask questions in the language of their choice.

12. NOC GPT – Initial Capabilities

Examples of how the initial version of the AI tool can help:

- Intelligently searching through IOC documents, web pages, and NOCnet materials
- Providing links to official IOC documents and relevant sources
- Responding to queries in 29 languages

What the AI cannot help with at the moment:

- Answering questions on topics not available on NOCnet or IOC sites
- Performing tasks beyond search (e.g., draft emails)
- Translating IOC documents into other languages

13. NOC GPT – Core Functional Elements

As mentioned, we are working with Alibaba to develop the back-end capabilities for the suite of AI Assistants. Some of the core functional elements for the tools are the following:

- **Open Source Foundation:**
 - Built upon the Qwen model, ensuring transparency and flexibility
 - Fully deployed within IOC's secure Virtual Private Cloud (VPC)
- **Tailored for Olympic Context:**
 - Fine-tuned specifically for Olympic Games and NOCs' specific needs
 - Enhances relevance, contextual understanding, and response accuracy
- **Controlled Data Scope:**
 - Uses only authoritative sources, such as NOCnet resources and official IOC websites and databases
- **Compliant with EU AI Act:**
 - The application layer (or the front-end) is being developed by MyReach, a trusted Swiss-based technology provider, to ensure compliance with European standards and quality assurance.

14. Thank You

Thank you for your time and attention today. The Olympic AI Agenda is not just about embracing new technologies, but about enhancing fairness, accessibility, and sustainability within the Olympic Movement. As we continue to innovate and collaborate with our partners, we are confident that AI will play a transformative role in shaping the future of sport.

We look forward to the ongoing progress, and we are excited for the opportunities ahead as we work together to bring these advancements to life across the Olympic Games and beyond.

Thank you.

OLYMPIC EDUCATION 2.0: ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AS A CATALYST FOR ATHLETIC DEVELOPMENT

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Abstract

The Olympic Movement has historically emphasised both athletic excellence and educational values, an approach rooted in Pierre de Coubertin's vision of holistic development. As digital transformation reshapes global education, Olympic education faces a pivotal moment with the advent of artificial intelligence (AI). This paper introduces Olympic Education 2.0, an AI-enhanced approach that preserves Olympic pedagogical foundations while leveraging technology to overcome traditional limitations. The research explores how AI can transform Olympic education to enhance athletic development while maintaining core values. AI's potential in personalised learning, performance analysis, and values-based education is examined, proposing adaptive learning algorithms, biomechanical analysis, and scenario-based ethical training. Implementation considerations include data privacy, global accessibility, and preserving human connections. The integration of AI, extended reality, and data fusion offers new educational opportunities, though empirical research and ethical frameworks are needed. Olympic Education 2.0 aims to balance tradition and innovation, ensuring

technological advancements complement the humanistic values central to the Olympic philosophy. This paper lays the groundwork for future research and development in AI-enhanced Olympic education.

Keywords: Olympic education, artificial intelligence, personalised learning, performance analysis, values-based education, adaptive learning algorithms, biomechanical analysis, ethical training, digital transformation, extended reality, data fusion.

1. Introduction

The Olympic Movement has maintained a dual focus on athletic excellence and educational values since its modern inception. Pierre de Coubertin's original vision emphasised not just physical competition but a comprehensive educational philosophy that develops the whole person (Müller, 2000). This educational dimension has traditionally been delivered through standardised curricula, printed materials, and human-to-human coaching interactions (Binder, 2012).

However, as digital transformation reshapes educational paradigms globally, Olympic education stands at a critical juncture. The emergence of artificial intelligence presents both challenges and opportunities for reimagining how Olympic values and athletic skills are transmitted, learned, and embodied (IOC, 2024a). This paper introduces the concept of Olympic Education 2.0—a potential AI-enhanced approach that maintains the philosophical foundations of Olympic pedagogy while leveraging technological innovation to overcome traditional limitations (IOC, 2024b).

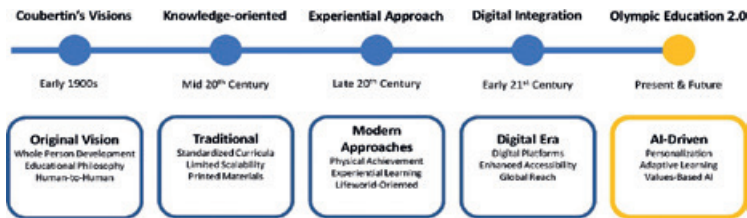
The research question guiding this investigation is “How might artificial intelligence technologies transform Olympic education to enhance athletic development while preserving Olympic values?” This paper argues that AI, when thoughtfully implemented, could serve as a catalyst for a more personalised, accessible, and effective Olympic educational experience, creating what we term Olympic Education 2.0 (IOC, 2024c).

2. Theoretical Framework

2.1 Evolution of Olympic Education

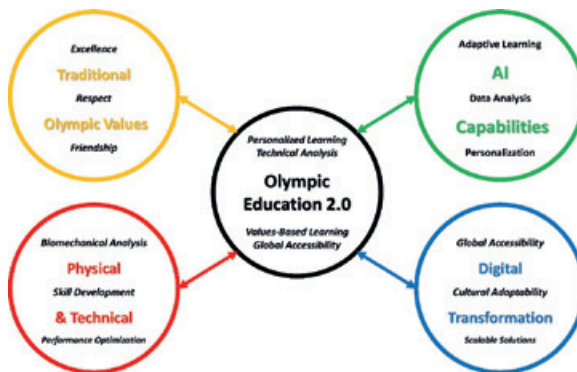
Olympic education has evolved considerably since Coubertin's initial concep-

tualisation. Naul (2008) identifies four distinct approaches that have emerged over time: the knowledge-oriented approach, the experiential approach, the physical achievement approach, and the lifeworld-oriented approach. It is noted that while these approaches differ in emphasis, they share common challenges: standardisation limitations, scalability issues, and difficulties in personalisation (Naul, 2008). Recent research highlights the need for Olympic education to adapt to contemporary global challenges, including social inclusion, gender equality, and environmental sustainability (Theodorakis et al., 2024).



Evolution of Olympic Education—A timeline showing the progression from Coubertin's original vision to Olympic Education 2.0, highlighting different approaches identified by Naul (2008).

Some argue that Olympic education must continue to evolve to remain relevant in changing social and technological contexts (Binder, 2012). They propose that digital technologies offer potential solutions to long-standing challenges in Olympic pedagogy, particularly in global reach and cultural adaptability (IOC, 2024a). The integration of digital platforms can enhance the accessibility and scalability of Olympic education programmes, making them more inclusive and adaptable to diverse cultural contexts (IOC, 2024b).



Theoretical Framework for Olympic Education 2.0—A conceptual diagram illustrating how traditional Olympic values intersect with AI capabilities, physical/technical development, and digital transformation.

2.2 AI and Educational Transformation

Artificial intelligence has demonstrated transformative potential across educational domains. Some researchers document how AI-powered adaptive learning systems have shown promise in improving learning outcomes in traditional academic contexts (Holmes et al., 2019). Others highlight the capacity of intelligent tutoring systems to provide personalised feedback and adjustable learning pathways that respond to individual needs (Luckin et al., 2016). AI's ability to analyse large datasets and provide real-time feedback can significantly enhance personalised learning experiences (Tuhin, 2025).

In sports specifically, AI applications are already being developed for performance analysis, training optimisation, and injury prevention (Musat et al., 2024). However, it is also observed that less attention has been paid to AI's potential role in value-based education and ethical development within sports contexts (IOC, 2024c). The integration of AI into Olympic education could address these gaps by providing scenario-based training that presents athletes with contextually relevant ethical dilemmas and interactive platforms for exploring Olympic values (IOC, 2024d).

This paper bridges these domains by proposing a theoretical framework for Olympic Education 2.0 that integrates AI capabilities with Olympic educational objectives. Drawing on the concept of "Sport Education" and extending it through the lens of AI-enhanced personalisation, we propose that Olympic Education 2.0 could represent a synthesis of traditional Olympic values with emerging technological affordances (IOC, 2024e).

3. Potential AI Applications in Olympic Education

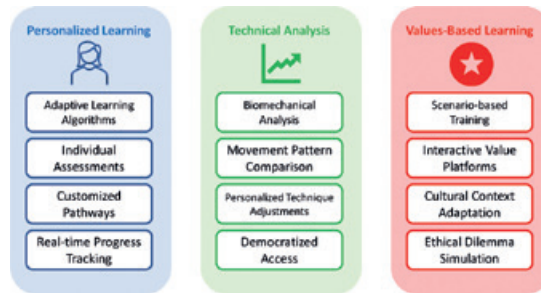
3.1 Personalised Learning Approaches

The foundation of Olympic Education 2.0 could be the implementation of adaptive learning algorithms that personalise educational experiences. Research demonstrates that effective personalisation involves continuous assessment, adaptive difficulty progression, and customised pathways (Holmes et al., 2019). Personalised learning approaches have been shown to significantly improve engagement and learning outcomes by tailoring educational content to individual needs (Bernacki et al., 2021).

Olympic Education 2.0 might leverage machine learning algorithms to:

- assess individual athlete capabilities and learning styles (Luckin et al., 2016)
- generate customised training recommendations based on physiological profiles (Musat et al., 2024)
- track progress in real-time and adjust educational interventions accordingly (Gustafsson-Write et al., 2022; Wang & Yoon, 2025)

While specific implementations in Olympic contexts are still emerging, research in educational technology suggests that personalisation approaches could increase engagement and improve skill development (Holmes et al., 2019; Bernacki et al., 2021).



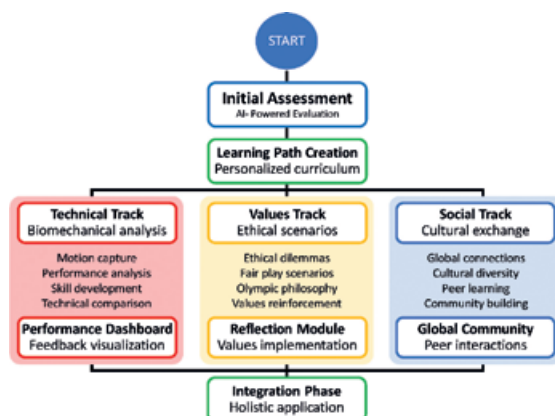
AI Applications in Olympic Education 2.0—A visual breakdown of the three key AI application areas: personalised learning, technical analysis, and values-based learning.

3.2 Technical Analysis and Performance Development

Computer vision and machine learning algorithms have shown significant potential in sports performance analysis. These technologies could enable:

- biomechanical movement analysis to identify technical elements that might be missed by human observation alone (Nicholls et al., 2022)
- comparison against reference movement patterns (IOC, 2024a)
- personalised technique adjustments based on individual characteristics (Nicholls et al., 2022)

Such tools could potentially democratise access to the sophisticated technical analysis that was previously available only in advanced training centres, creating new educational opportunities for athletes in various settings (Nicholls, 2020; IOC, 2024b).



Implementation Flowchart for Olympic Education 2.0—A practical visualisation showing how an Olympic Education 2.0 programme might be structured and implemented.

3.3 Values-Based Learning

Olympic education has always emphasised ethical development and values-based learning. AI applications in this domain could potentially include:

- scenario-based training that presents athletes with contextually relevant ethical dilemmas (Wang, 2022)
- interactive platforms for exploring Olympic values in various contexts (IOC, 2024c)
- adaptive systems that personalise values education to different cultural contexts and developmental stages (IOC, 2024d)

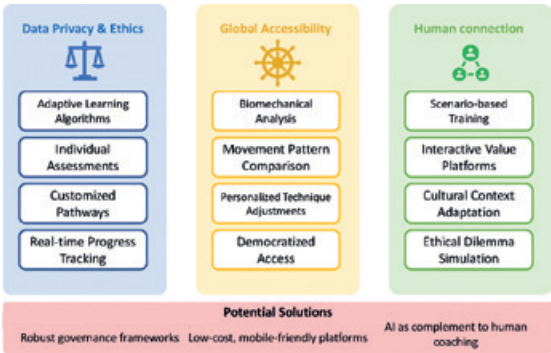
Research suggests that interactive ethical training can produce improvements in moral reasoning, though specific AI applications in Olympic contexts would require further development and evaluation (Wang, 2022; IOC, 2024e).

4. Implementation Considerations

4.1 Data Privacy and Ethical Use

The implementation of AI in Olympic education would raise significant data privacy concerns. The collection of comprehensive athlete data—including

physiological, psychological, and behavioural information – creates potential vulnerabilities that would need to be addressed through robust governance frameworks (Munck Wilson Mandala, 2024). Key considerations would include informed consent processes, particularly for minors, transparent data handling, and algorithmic decision-making (Forbes, 2024). Mitigation of algorithmic bias that could disadvantage certain populations is also crucial (Musat et al., 2024).



Challenges in Implementing Olympic Education 2.0—A visualisation of the three main challenges discussed in the paper: data privacy and ethics, global accessibility, and preserving human connection.

The Olympic Movement would need to develop specific ethical guidelines for AI applications in educational contexts, extending existing ethical frameworks to address emerging technological challenges (IOC, 2024a). These guidelines should prioritise athletes’ rights and well-being, ensuring that AI technologies are used responsibly and ethically (Munck Wilson Mandala, 2024).

4.2 Global Accessibility and Digital Divide

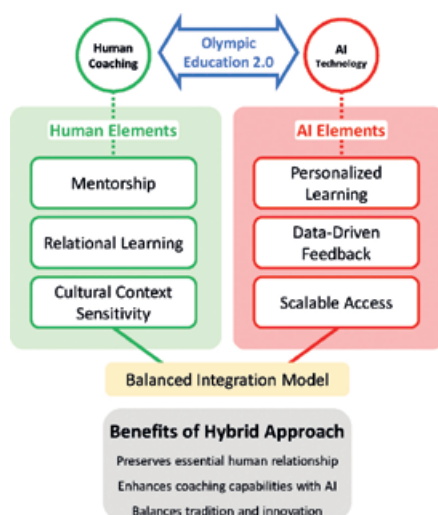
A fundamental challenge for Olympic Education 2.0 would be ensuring equitable access across geographic and economic contexts. While AI has democratising potential, it also risks exacerbating existing inequalities if not implemented thoughtfully (Miras et al., 2023). It is observed that technological innovations often benefit already-advantaged populations first, potentially widening performance gaps (Mirazchiyski, 2024).

Strategies for addressing accessibility might include the development of

low-cost, mobile-friendly platforms, open-source educational resources that can be locally adapted, and global cloud infrastructure that reduces local hardware requirements (IGI Global, 2025). The International Olympic Committee, National Olympic Committees, and International Federations would need to collaborate to address these accessibility challenges to ensure Olympic Education 2.0 fulfils the movement's universality principle (IOC, 2024b).

4.3 Preserving Human Connection

Perhaps the most significant concern in Olympic Education 2.0 would be maintaining the human relationships that have traditionally been central to Olympic pedagogy. Effective sport education requires authentic human connection (Salepi, 2021). There would be a risk that overreliance on AI could diminish these essential relational elements (Boskovic, 2022).



Hybrid Model for Olympic Education 2.0 Implementation – A visual representation of the balanced approach that integrates human coaching with AI technology.

It is proposed that the most effective implementations would likely be hybrid models where AI complements rather than replaces human coaching. This approach conceptualises AI as an enhancement to human capability rather than a substitute, preserving the mentorship qualities that were identified as essential to Olympic education (Salepi, 2021; Boskovic, 2022).

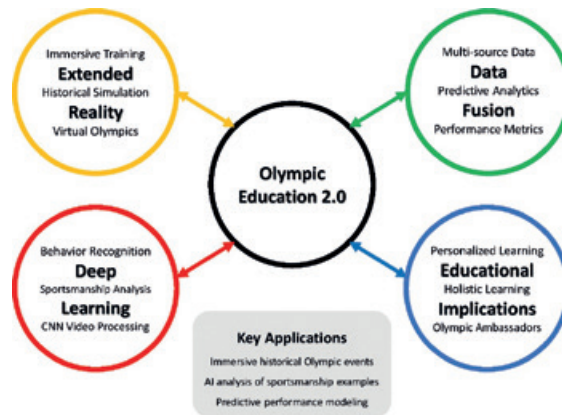
5. AI, Extended Reality, and Data Fusion in Olympic Education

5.1 AI and Extended Reality in Olympic Games

Artificial intelligence (AI) and extended reality (XR) technologies are revolutionising the Olympic Games, offering new ways to enhance both the athlete and spectator experience. Extended reality, which includes virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR), can create immersive educational environments where athletes and coaches can simulate real-world scenarios and practice under varied conditions (IOC, 2024e). For instance, VR can be used to recreate historical Olympic events, allowing athletes to learn from past performances and strategies (Forbes, 2024). This immersive learning approach can help athletes understand the nuances of sportsmanship and the Olympic spirit in a more engaging manner (IOC, 2024b).

5.2 Deep Learning for Analysing Sportsmanship in Historical Videos

Deep learning techniques, particularly convolutional neural networks (CNNs), have shown great promise in analysing video data to detect and interpret human behaviours (Luxem et al., 2023). By applying these techniques to historical Olympic footage, researchers can identify instances of sportsmanship and ethical behaviour exhibited by athletes. For example, deep learning models can be



AI and Extended Reality in Olympic Education 2.0—An illustration showing how AI, extended reality, deep learning, and data fusion technologies can be integrated into Olympic education.



Prof. Hassan A. Khachfe focused on the subject of AI in Olympic education in light of digital transformation reshaping global education.

trained to recognise gestures, facial expressions, and interactions that signify respect, fairness, and camaraderie (Zhang, 2023). This analysis can be used to create educational content that highlights exemplary behaviours, reinforcing the values of sportsmanship in Olympic education (Luxem et al., 2023).

5.3 Data Fusion for Predicting Performance

Data fusion involves integrating data from multiple sources to generate comprehensive insights. In the context of Olympic education, data fusion can be used to predict the performance of teams and individuals by analysing historical data, including past performances, training logs, and physiological metrics (Du et al., 2025). Machine learning models, such as random forests and neural networks, can process this fused data to identify patterns and predict future outcomes (Zhang & Wu, 2023). This predictive capability can help coaches and athletes tailor their training programmes to optimise performance and achieve their goals (Du et al., 2025).

5.4 Educational Implications

From an educational perspective, integrating AI, XR, and data fusion into Olympic education can provide a more personalised and effective learning experience. These technologies can help athletes develop a deeper understanding of the principles of Olympism, enhance their technical skills, and foster a culture of continuous improvement and ethical behaviour (IOC, 2024c). By leveraging these advanced tools, Olympic Education 2.0 can create a holistic educational environment that prepares athletes not only for competition but also for their roles as ambassadors of the Olympic values (Forbes, 2024).

6. Current Limitations and Future Research Directions

It is important to acknowledge that the specific intersection of Olympic education and AI is still an emerging area with limited empirical research (Liu & Cui, 2024). Future investigation is needed in several key areas:



Future Research Directions for Olympic Education 2.0 – A diagram highlighting the four key research areas needed: empirical studies, evaluation metrics, cross-cultural studies, and ethical frameworks.

- Empirical studies on the efficacy of AI-enhanced Olympic education compared to traditional approaches (Hwang, 2018)
- Development of specific evaluation metrics that capture both performance outcomes and value-based learning (Lyngdoh et al., 2025)
- Cross-cultural studies examining how AI educational tools translate across diverse contexts (Xia et al., 2024)

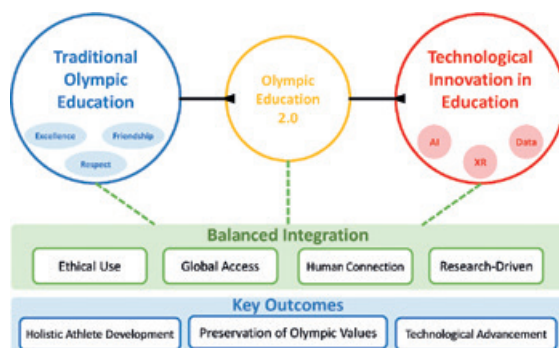
- Ethical frameworks specific to AI applications in Olympic contexts (Carrio Sampedro, 2023)

As was noted, technology in sports is developing rapidly, and research must keep pace to ensure evidence-based implementation that serves Olympic educational objectives (IOC, 2024a).

7. Conclusion

Olympic Education 2.0 represents a potential evolution that could leverage artificial intelligence to address longstanding challenges in Olympic pedagogy while preserving the core philosophical values of the movement (IOC, 2024b). The integration of personalised learning approaches, advanced performance analysis, and interactive values education could create new opportunities for holistic athlete development (Holmes et al., 2019).

However, this transformation would need to be approached thoughtfully, with careful attention to data privacy, global accessibility, and the preservation of human connection (Munck Wilson Mandala, 2024). The Olympic Movement has always balanced tradition and innovation; Olympic Education 2.0 would continue this legacy by embracing technological advancement while maintaining the humanistic values at the core of Olympic philosophy (Salepi, 2021).



Olympic Education 2.0: Evolution and Balance—A concluding illustration showing how Olympic Education 2.0 represents the balanced integration of traditional Olympic values with technological innovation.

As artificial intelligence continues to evolve, Olympic education should evolve with it, developing new approaches that harness technological potential while remaining firmly grounded in the educational vision that has distinguished the Olympic Movement for over a century (Binder, 2012). This paper offers a foundation for that evolutionary process, mapping the potential, challenges, and research agenda for Olympic Education 2.0 (IOC, 2024c).

Acknowledgment

The author would like to express his sincere gratitude to the EdTech Syndicate of Lebanon for their invaluable support throughout this research project. Their expert advice, technical resources, and commitment to advancing educational technology in sports contexts have significantly enriched this work. The Syndicate's willingness to share their expertise in the emerging field of AI applications in education has been instrumental in developing the framework for Olympic Education 2.0 presented in this paper.

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OLYMPIC EDUCATION PROGRAMMES DESIGNED AND IMPLEMENTED FOR THE DAKAR 2026 YOG

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I. Context

According to the preliminary report of the National Agency for Statistics and Demography (ANSD) in October 2023 on the 5th General Census of Population and Housing (RGPH-5), Senegal has a population of 18,032,473 inhabitants, with an estimated youth population of 7,060,570 under the age of 15 and an estimated population of 6,452,799 between the ages of 15 and 34, with a predominance of men over women.

This segment of the population represents an undeniable driving force, a powerful energy that can be used in the implementation of any development programme and in Senegal's contribution to the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals set by the international community.

This is an opportunity for Senegal to harness its young and valuable demographic potential and to protect it from the negative impact on mental well-being caused by precarious living conditions.

The Youth Olympic Games (YOG) have a tremendous capacity to transform the socio-economic situation of young people in the host countries. One of the greatest challenges facing the Dakar 2026 YOG Organising Committee is

therefore to ensure that the event is a success, obviously with young people and for young people.

This challenge requires a sufficiently high level of education, commitment and trust among young people, which can serve as a catalyst for mobilisation that meets the expectations of the global Olympic and sporting community.

This is one of the objectives of the Youth Engagement and Mobilisation Department of the Dakar 2026 YOG Organising Committee, which has set up an ambitious education programme aimed at preparing young people by instilling in them the values that will enable them to welcome the Olympic world.

Youth Olympic Games Awarded to Senegal and Africa

During the 133rd session of the International Olympic Committee (IOC) held in Buenos Aires in October 2018, Senegal was chosen to host the 4th edition of the Youth Olympic Games. The YOG, which were originally scheduled to take place in 2022, have been postponed to 2026 due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

Dakar 2022 is a victory for Africa[...] I am confident that Senegal will organise memorable games on behalf of Africa. (Thomas Bach, 2018)

Vision for the 2026 Dakar YOG

Dakar 2026 – Youth and Sport contributing to the transformation of Senegal and a source of inspiration for Africa.

II. Opportunities for Transformation

The postponement of the 4th Summer Youth Olympic Games from 2022 to 2026 provided an opportunity for the Organising Committee to develop a series of projects to preserve enthusiasm and better prepare Senegalese youth to welcome young people from around the world. The aim was also to leave a legacy for the country as a whole, but particularly for young people. The implementation of these projects, which began in 2022, will continue until the Games to keep the flame alive and provide a transition between the pre-Games period and the

Games period. During this time, other activities will be implemented, particularly with schools and sports federations.

The following projects have been underway since 2022:

- Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate (BOCS)
- Kids' Olympic Skills
- *Dakar En Jeux Festival*

2.1. Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate (BOCS)

The Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate (BOCS) is an educational programme that combines civic education and sport to transmit Olympic values to young Senegalese people. It is part of the Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games and is one of the first educational and sporting legacies of this global event. This programme is derived from the IOC's Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) and aims to embed the Olympic spirit in the Senegalese education system in a sustainable manner.

Programme Objectives

The Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate has several objectives:

- to promote Olympic values among Senegalese pupils
- to encourage young people to participate in sports by teaching them about the physical and moral benefits of sport
- to engage pupils so that they feel involved in this international event
- to prepare pupils to play an active role as volunteers and promoters of the 2026 YOG

Target Audiences

The Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate is aimed at various groups of pupils and students:

- primary school pupils: 6 to 11 years
- secondary school pupils: 12 to 14 years
- young people from schools and sports clubs
- young people from the Centres for Judicial and Social Protection (CDPJS)
- young people from Vocational and Technical Training Centres (CFPT)
- youth movements

2.1.1 Partners Delivering the Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate

Several institutions and partners are collaborating to implement the programme.

2.1.1.1 The National Olympic Academy of Senegal (ANOS)

ANOS quickly understood the role it had to play in educating and preparing young people for the 2026 Youth Olympic Games in Dakar. That is why, as soon as Dakar was awarded the YOG in 2018, a training programme was set up to help its members prepare for the organisation of the 2022 YOG in Dakar.

This programme began in 2019 with the training of young leaders to make them aware of the important role they will have to play in the successful organisation of the Dakar 2026 YOG.

The training of these young leaders, which is ongoing, always includes a section on Education in Olympic Values, which is the primary focus of ANOS's activities.

The Dakar 2026 YOG Organising Committee has made the National Olympic Academy its operational arm for the implementation of the Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate in schools throughout the country. The ANOS has set up relays in all regions, enabling its members to support teaching staff whenever the need arises.

2.1.1.2 The Ministry of National Education (MNE)

The Ministry of National Education is YOGOC's key partner in implementing the Olympic Values Education programme through the Olympic Civic and Sports Certificate. Indeed, its main target audience is school pupils.

For this reason, YOGOC has secured the commitment of the authorities by signing an agreement with the MNE to formalise the collaboration and enable teachers to become fully involved in achieving the BOCS objectives.

Stages in the Implementation of BOCS in Partnership with the MNE

June 2022

Signing of a partnership agreement between the MNE and YOGOC for the implementation of the BOCS in all schools.

July 2022: Training of Trainers for the Pilot Phase

To implement the programme, formal and well-structured training is required.

The objective is to empower a group of future trainers, ambassadors and teachers from Senegalese education inspectorates. Linked to the five educational themes, the two-day workshop aims to develop the capacity of educators and facilitators to effectively convey the learning messages of the Olympic Values Education Programme.

School Year 2023–2024: Launch in Pilot Schools and Institutions

Joint monitoring, implementation and control missions will be carried out in all academies across the country from February to May 2024.

At the start of implementation, each school or institution will receive a set of support materials including 20 bibs, 50 cups, 20 cones, one stopwatch, one whistle, one football and one handball.

A knowledge-sharing session will be organised with each school or institution's teaching team, and information will be systematically shared during teaching sessions with a view to scaling up the programme by 2025.

The implementation of the BOCS will require one hour of classroom practice per week throughout the school year, during which the Olympic values of friendship, respect and excellence will be taught to learners in theory and in practice through sport.

Teaching and learning will take place in primary schools for pupils aged from 9 to 11 and in secondary schools for those aged from 12 to 14 years, under the close coordination of the Academy's sports officer.

The 32 primary schools and 16 secondary schools participating in the pilot project will be certified. With the conclusion of the scaling-up phase at the end of the 2024/2025 school year, the 52 best schools and institutions will receive the certificate School or College Partner of the Dakar 2026 YOG, bringing the number of reference schools and institutions in Senegal awarded the Olympic, Civic and Sports Certificate (BOCS) to 100.

The production of digital resources for the dissemination of the OVEP will be provided by the School Radio and Television Division (DRTS), through sessions filmed in pilot schools and institutions and broadcast on the CANAL EDUCATION channel. The resources produced will feed into the various MNE platforms.

The project is coordinated by the Sports and Physical Education Office within the Ministry of National Education, under the technical supervision of the

Engagement Department of the Youth Olympic Games Organising Committee and the Senegalese National Olympic Academy.

Since its launch in July 2022, the programme has achieved the following objectives:

- training of 614 trainers (volunteers, teachers, sports federation technicians, specialised educators and journalists)
- reaching 140,700 people across the country through the implementation of the above-mentioned projects

Period 2025–2026: Scaling up Across the Country

To accelerate the rollout in schools, a capitalisation session was organised on 21 and 22 February 2025 with teacher trainers from Senegal's 14 regions. The aim of this workshop was to define a national rollout strategy.

The rollout plan is based on a cascade approach, structured in several levels:

Phase 1: March 2025–June 2025

- Continue to rollout BOCS in 3,500 schools
- Reach 250,000 pupils by the end of the 2025 school year
- Train local teachers through departmental teaching units
- Share digital teaching resources to support the dissemination of Olympic values
- Build on school sports federation programmes to reach as many young people as possible. Each event is an opportunity for the YOG Organising Committee to implement its programme of activities and reach young people from school federations and out-of-school youth.

Phase 2: October 2025–January 2026 (72% of targets achieved)

- Extend coverage to 7,500 schools (70% of final targets)
- Raise awareness among 650,000 pupils (72% of the 900,000 pupils targeted)
- Continue training teachers and supervisors at departmental and regional levels
- Support school sports activities to maximise the programme's impact
- Evaluate and adjust strategies before the final phase

Phase 3: February 2026 – June 2026 (100% of targets achieved)

- Reach 11,000 schools
- Raise awareness among 900,000 pupils
- Identify the best schools committed to obtaining certification
- Select schools in host cities to participate in the *L'École en Jeux* programme, enabling 300,000 pupils to attend the Dakar 2026 YOG as involved spectators

How to Motivate Participating Schools?

- Reward teachers who have delivered the lessons by facilitating their attendance at the Youth Olympic Games in Dakar in 2026
- Grant YOG volunteer places to teachers who have participated in the implementation of BOCS
- Reward young people who have completed the programme by awarding them certificates or prizes and facilitating their participation in the Dakar 2026 YOG
- Organise a competition for the best BOCS initiatives, with the winner receiving a Dakar 2026 YOG BOCS trophy

Monitoring and Evaluation of the Rollout Plan

Starting on 12 March 2025, YOGOC and MNE teams will conduct supervisory missions throughout the country to ensure the programme is implemented properly. A monitoring and evaluation system will also be rolled out, with the following performance indicators:

- number of schools included in the programme
- number of teachers and supervisors trained
- number of pupils involved in the programme

Monitoring Mechanisms:

- quarterly reports from regional and departmental trainers
- interim impact assessments and strategic adjustments
- satisfaction surveys among pupils and teachers



Cécile Faye from the NOA of Senegal and the Dakar 2026 YOGOC presented the Olympic education programmes for the first-ever YOG to take place in Africa.

2.1.1.3 Implementation of BOCS in Centres for Children in Conflict with the Law

The participation of all young people in activities organised by YOGOC Dakar 2026 remains one of the major challenges for the success of the YOG Dakar 2026.

In order to make Olympic values education accessible to all, YOGOC has decided to extend it to centres responsible for the education and reintegration of young people in conflict with the law. The aim is to strengthen the capacities of the staff of the Directorate of Judicial and Social Protection to integrate the Olympic Values Education Programme into their educational and social work with young people.

Implementation with this partner began in May 2024 with the training of trainers from centres across the country. These trainers are responsible for sharing their knowledge by empowering other operational colleagues in the field who are responsible for the day-to-day management of these young people.

2.2 Kids' Olympic Skills (KOS)

The challenge facing our Movement is to make youth education through sport as interesting today as it was when Pierre de Coubertin founded the International Olympic Committee over a hundred years ago. (Jacques Rogge)

Kids' Olympic Skills (KOS) is a programme that aims to raise awareness of the values of sport among boys and girls aged 10 to 15, while enabling them to discover the sport of their choice and encouraging them to take part in more organised physical and sporting activities. KOS is also a means of raising awareness among young people of the issues involved in Senegal's hosting of the Youth Olympic Games (YOG).

The KOS programme is based on two pillars: discovering and promoting sports and educating young people about Olympic values through sport.

The programme's activities will take place indoors and/or outdoors throughout the country, in partnership with local authorities, stakeholders in the education system and sports federations for the chosen sports.

2.2 The Dakar Festival en Jeux

Education and culture are at the heart of the Olympic Movement. The Olympic Charter clearly states 'The goal of the Olympic Movement is to contribute to building a peaceful and better world by educating youth through sport practised in accordance with Olympism and its values.' (Jacques Rogge)

That is why the Dakar 2026 YOG Organising Committee has included this sporting, educational and cultural programme in its commitment and mobilisation programme. The *Dakar Festival en Jeux* recalls the celebrations when sport was combined with culture and education during the various editions of the YOG. The aim is to give participants, especially young people, a taste of the YOG and to encourage them to get involved across all regions of Senegal as the editions progress.

Dakar En Jeux is a multidisciplinary festival, a bridge between sport and culture, the first edition of which was held from 29 October to 5 November 2022.

It is a unique opportunity to share the values of sport and culture with thousands of young Senegalese people.

The content is the same as that of the YOG, with sporting and cultural activities and stands promoting Olympic values run by young people from the National Olympic Academy.

The 3rd and final edition of *Dakar en Jeux* will be held from 3 to 9 November 2025.

III. Legacy Prospects

The national plan for the rollout of the BOCS is a key initiative to embed Olympic values in the Senegalese education system for the long term. Through cascade training, the strong involvement of teachers and supervisors, and close collaboration with the 16 education inspectorates, the programme aims to reach 900,000 pupils in 11,000 schools by October 2026.

With the integration of the programme *L'École en Jeux*, 300,000 pupils will have the opportunity to enjoy a unique experience during the 2026 Dakar YOG.

The Kids' Olympic Skills programme, which sports federations have already begun to take advantage of, goes beyond education through sport. Through the activities currently being implemented, the introduction to various sports is continuing and will continue beyond the YOG thanks to the involvement of the technicians who are the driving force behind this project.

The *Dakar en Jeux* festival, which brings together several partners from different ministerial departments, is expected to continue under the auspices of the Ministries of Youth, Sports, Culture and National Education.

The best legacy that can be drawn from the 2026 Dakar YOG is to continue to make Dakar an Olympic City and to pursue Senegal's transformation through these programmes, inspiring other African countries to bid for major Olympic events.

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THE IMPACT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ON OLYMPIC TELEVISION COVERAGE: THE CASE OF OLYMPIC BROADCASTING SERVICES (OBS) AND OLYMPIC CHANNEL SERVICES (OCS)

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Introduction

As the world enters the age of artificial intelligence (AI), industries across every sector are undergoing profound transformations, and the world of sports media is no exception. Within the Olympic ecosystem, there are two key organisations, both under the International Olympic Committee, that are predominantly engaged in producing and distributing the live and recorded media coverage of the Olympic sports, either during the Olympic Games or in the “flame to flame period” in between: the Olympic Broadcasting Services (OBS) and Olympic Channel Services (OCS).

OBS, founded in 2001, is responsible for the host broadcasting of all editions of the Olympic Games and Youth Olympic Games. Its dual mandate is to produce and provide comprehensive and unbiased television coverage of all Olympic competitions to Media Rights Holders (MRHs) and to deliver the essential technical infrastructure and services needed by these rights holders to conduct their own unilateral coverage. On the digital front, OCS, founded in 2015, manages www.olympics.com, the IOC’s official fan-facing digital platform, providing

round-the-clock audio-video and textual content, highlights, interviews, and features that keep audiences engaged year-round with Olympic sports and athletes.

The advent of AI has brought about a revolution in the scope and effectiveness of both OBS and OCS operations. From live broadcast enhancements and real-time analytics to personalised content delivery and automated editorial tools, AI technologies are redefining the Olympic viewing experience. This document explores the wide-ranging impacts of the AI revolution on Olympic television coverage through the lens of OBS and OCS, examining the innovations introduced, their implications for the industry, and the broader future of Olympic media.

AI in Olympic Broadcasting Services (OBS)

OBS serves as the operational engine behind the global broadcast of the Olympic Games. As the host broadcaster, OBS not only captures and produces live coverage but also develops the technological ecosystem that enables international media partners to deliver Olympic content to their audiences. The integration of AI into OBS's operations started as early as the Pyeongchang Winter Olympic Games of 2018 and has increased and deepened ever since. In those times, OBS had already started experimenting and operating AI of the predominantly ML (Machine Learning) and DL (Deep Learning) architectural variants. Certain technological breakthroughs in the early 2010s had already elevated ML/DL to valuable tools in the broad area of "pattern recognition" for still and moving pictures. Such functionality is always important for video and audio search in massive content archives, for example, those containing the TV coverage of past Olympic Games.

Today, and especially after the latest major deployments during the Olympic Games in Paris 2024, AI of both the ML/DL and LLM flavours is being extensively used by OBS and OCS in their production needs for the coverage of the Olympic events. As there is no wish to deploy technology just for the sake of it, OBS and OCS have attached three main objectives and expectations to the ever-growing introduction of AI into their services and workflows: enhancing the viewer experience, optimising production workflows, and increasing planning and operational efficiency.

Enhancing the Viewer Experience

OBS's use of AI to elevate the viewer experience has been particularly notable in recent editions of the Olympic Games, culminating in significant advancements for Paris 2024. Innovations have included the following:

Multi-Camera Replays or MUCAR: AI enables the synchronisation and automated stitching of multiple pictures from a number of still cameras to provide seamless, multi-angle, slow-motion replays of critical moments. This feature enhances the fan experience by delivering a detailed visual representation of athlete performance from multiple angles, especially in sports requiring technical precision such as gymnastics, basketball, etc. (Figure 1)

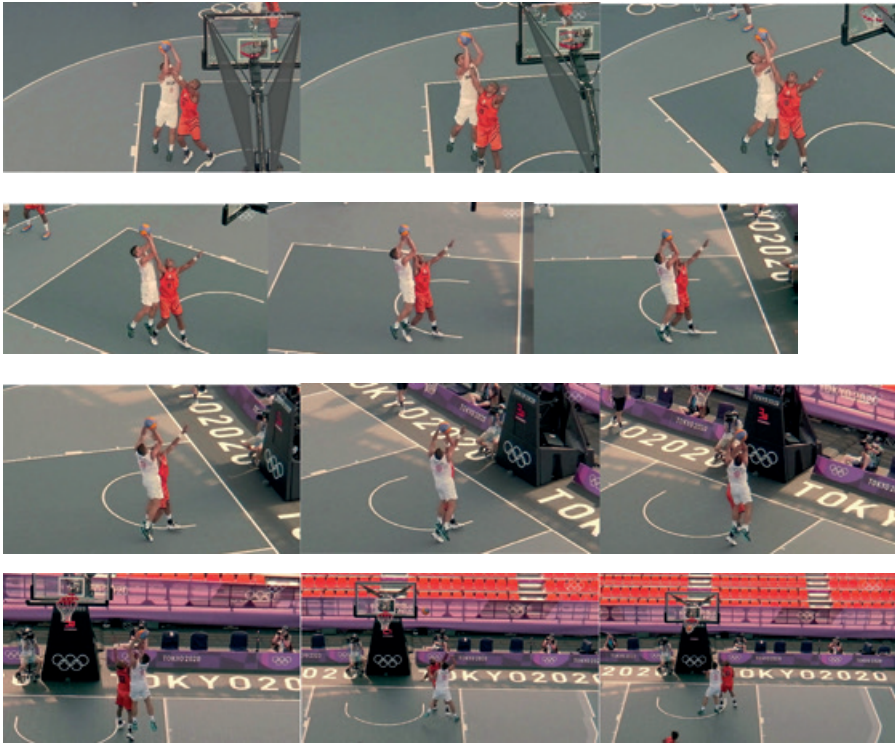


Figure 1

In the Paris 2024 Games, MUCAR technology was deployed for 21 different sports and disciplines.

Athlete and Object Tracking: Through collaboration with partners like OMEGA, which is the official timekeeper of the Olympic Games, AI-powered tracking systems are now used in several sports including rowing, sailing, and marathon running. These systems offer real-time data visualisations of athlete positioning, movement, and speed, providing an enriched broadcast experience. Such features are essential in many sports, where recognising the exact athletes or the apparatus that they may be using can be challenging for the television audience (quite often this is the case even for the local spectators, too). This is, for example, the case with sailing or marathons, where, despite the use of flags on the sails or bibs on the athletes' attire, it may not always be easy for the remote audience to distinguish what is what and who is who. (Figure 2)



Figure 2

Intelligent Stroboscopic Replay: This tool captures and analyses sequences of athlete movements, breaking them down into visual snapshots. It allows viewers to examine athletic form and technique more closely, contributing to greater appreciation and understanding of the sport. AI is predominantly employed for separating the athletes' bodies from the background and allowing for the creation of a much more engaging visual effect where the "stills" from the athletes' activity are presented over an always live background beside them. (Figure 3)



Figure 3

Enhanced Data Graphics: Used in disciplines like running or diving, these graphics analyse athletes' body positions using AI-generated skeletons, allowing broadcasters to explain scoring criteria, performance differences and variation in techniques in real time. A good example is the graphical representation of the 100 meters run where the run can be replayed graphically while providing for the instant speed of the individual athletes, both numerically but also as a “heat diagram”. (Figure 4)



Figure 4

Serve Reaction Time: In tennis, AI detects subtle body movements to measure reaction time to serves, offering real-time performance metrics to viewers. The audience can then appreciate, for the first time with objective data, the explosive responsiveness of the best athletes that allows them to react effectively to the serve hits of their opponents, essentially milliseconds after the serve was performed. (Figure 5)



Figure 5

Ball and Arrow Tracking: For sports such as table tennis, archery, or golf, AI tools visualise ball spin, arrow trajectory, and ball placement, adding a layer of detail that can enhance audience understanding and thus engagement. The audience can, for the first time, have visual proof of the curved trajectories of balls or arrows, along with detailed numerical information on the speed of spin of balls, which is a main contributor to the curvature of the trajectories in the first place. (Figure 6)



Figure 6

Such AI-driven graphical and numerical enhancements allow OBS to present Olympic events with greater clarity, accuracy, and immersion, enriching the viewing experience for both dedicated fans and new audiences.

Optimising Broadcast Workflows

AI also plays a crucial role in streamlining OBS's content production processes. Major advancements include the following:

Automatic Highlights Generation: OBS utilised the Intel® Geti™ platform to train AI models that automatically detect key moments during the live competition. These models can then be used to produce tailored highlights across multiple disciplines, creating content that is instantly distributable to global audiences. Overall, OBS, along with its partner Intel, prepared trained models for 21 sports and disciplines which were then used to produce more than 80,000 highly customised highlight clips during the Paris 2024 Games. More than 13,000 such clips were automatically produced just for athletics. Automated audio-video repurposing from the original live sports coverage, for example, in the shape of highlights or similar type of clips, is a very important type of new content generation, since it is this type of content that it is predominantly consumed on social media platforms. One additional important feature of this platform, also based on AI training of the ML type, is its ability to automatically generate vertically shaped videos out of the originally recorded horizontal ones. (Figure 7, Figure 8)

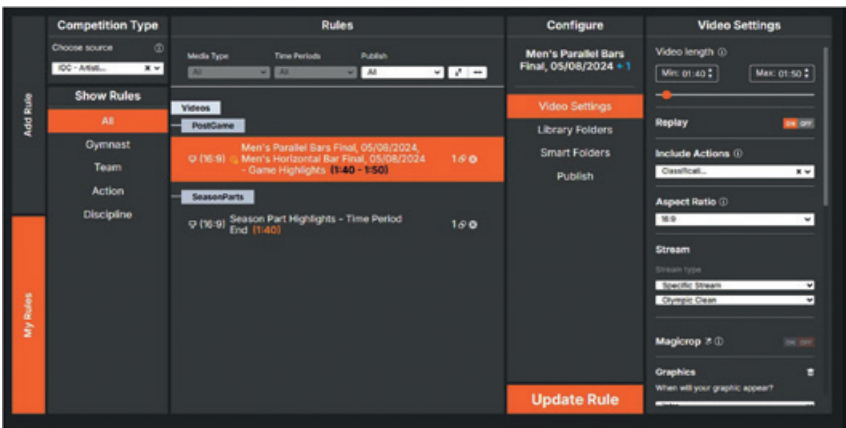


Figure 7

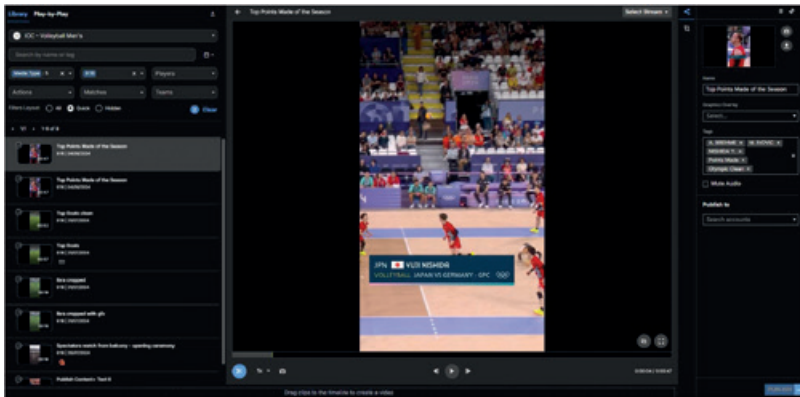


Figure 8

Generative Assisted Editing: AI systems assist human editors by recommending optimal cuts, angles, and transitions from the recorded live television signals. In this case, the AI models are acting as “content creation co-pilots” to human producers and editors, helping them post-produce engaging new content and Games/Athletes/Host City-related stories with a fraction of the effort needed in an unassisted manner. This methodology not only reduces manual labour but accelerates content turnaround, which is a crucial metric for successful content distribution in the context of a live sports event. The Generative Assisted Editing toolset has been developed in-house by OBS engineers and mainly functions by generating markers based on live commentary transcripts and large language model (LLM) summaries, integrated with market-available video editing tools. (Figure 9)



Figure 9

AI-Powered Logging and Content Classification: AI automatically logs live footage, tags key moments, and classifies content by sport, athlete, or nation. This supports faster content retrieval and targeted storytelling. Computer vision technology, together with new multimodal LLMs, is used to analyse video and extract descriptions that can be semantically correlated with natural language search queries without the need for specific keywords. The integrated application, also built internally by the OBS engineering team, generates video descriptions and automatic tagging of visual elements, actions, players, emotions, etc., that can then be browsed and searched using natural language. (Figure 10)



Figure 10

Improving Planning and Operational Efficiency

In the operational domain, OBS has embraced AI to streamline internal processes and reduce the significant burden of planning the host broadcasting of a large multisport event like the Olympic Games. Planning the television coverage of the Olympic Games is a highly complex and laborious endeavour that takes years to complete and requires the active collaboration of hundreds of professionals that work directly or indirectly for OBS, the Media Rights Holders, the International Olympic Committee and the local Olympic Organising Committee. Planning workflow automation is essential for overall efficiency, but also to help meet with the stringent deadlines for the planning of an event with immovable dates.

Traditional process automation tools, however, have been of limited help due to their inherent inflexibility and weaknesses in imitating the organic nature and amenability of the interaction between human collaborators. AI, and especially of the recent LLM type, with its ability with human language interchange and (limited, but growing) reasoning, is allowing for a serious resurrection of the concept of process re-engineering. OBS is currently quite active in using such tools to enhance and optimise its own planning workflows, either between its own personnel or in its interaction with external third parties, like service providers or the Media Rights Holders.

Currently, OBS has already established Conversational Virtual Assistants/ Agents (CVAs) which have been integrated with two of its most important planning tools: the GRPS which handles the hiring and all related logistics of its 8,000+ strong Games Time crews, and the DoS which handles the technical services bookings of all the Media Rights Holders. Both platforms now utilise CVAs to help their users navigate through the quite complex steps that are required for them to self- provision all the related logistics around their presence in the Games (which is the case with GRPS), or the quantities and detailed specifications of all the technical services that OBS should provide to them during Games times (which is the case with DoS).

AI in Olympic Channel Services (OCS)

While OBS focuses on the Olympic Games TV coverage on the behalf of the Media Rights Holders, OCS complements these efforts by managing the IOC's digital storytelling and fan engagement platforms. The primary responsibility of OCS is to maintain and develop www.olympics.com and its associated digital properties. Through the use of AI, OCS delivers personalised, engaging, and contextually relevant content to fans worldwide.

Editorial Copilot and Content Creation

OCS has integrated AI into its editorial processes to support content creators. Automated “assistants” use a range of information sources, including existing content and Olympic data, together with AI models to suggest content ideas, while also providing verified facts to speed up the writing process. The Editorial

Copilot is an AI assistant that aids the OCS writers and content editors throughout the editorial workflow.

Brainstorming and Ideation: It suggests topics based on trending themes and audience interests.

Drafting and Editing: The tool enhances grammar, improves narrative flow, and tailors the tone to suit different demographics.

Emotional Impact: It provides suggestions to boost the emotional resonance of stories, increasing viewer engagement.

By augmenting human creativity, the Editorial Copilot allows OCS to produce higher-quality content more efficiently and faster.

Real-Time Fan Engagement and Trend Detection

OCS uses AI to monitor user behaviour and identify, in real-time, engagement patterns across www.olympics.com. The trained models function over several different data streams that are indicators of particular fan engagement. More specifically, website traffic analysis is performed in real-time to identify key moments during competitions which trigger user excitement. These moments are

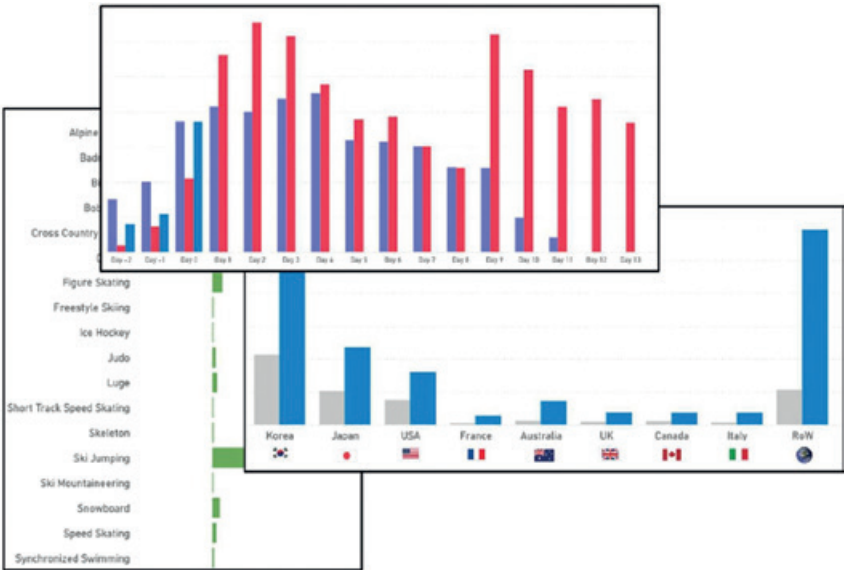


Figure 11



Sotiris Salamouris presented the impact of AI on TV coverage through the lens of OBS and OCS.

scored per country, allowing OCS to highlight events with the highest emotional and cultural relevance for different audiences. Consequently, a “story amplification” process is initiated, which allows for the timely promotion of underrepresented sports or athletes who are gaining unexpected attention. (Figure 11)

This approach ensures that editorial focus aligns with live audience interests, creating a very effective feedback loop which further drives engagement and makes certain that interest is well served and enhanced well beyond the few already well-known, popular athletes or competition sessions (i.e., finals between traditional contestants etc.)

Personalised and Localised Storytelling

Apart from supporting focused content creation and editing, AI also enables OCS to distribute content that is tailored to individual preferences and regional contexts. AI is an essential element of the www.olympics.com personalisation engine, aimed at delivering properly selected content to individual fans that

mostly meets their own interests. The engine is comprised of several modules that, collectively, aim to better “understand the expectations” of the individual user/Olympics fan and then serve her/him with the content that mostly satisfies these expectations. A number of these modules are described below:

Localised Content Delivery Module: AI identifies which stories are most relevant for specific countries and regions, optimising content distribution towards users from these areas.

Content Categorisation Module: By tagging athletes, sports, and narratives, AI ensures fans receive content aligned with their interest on these dimensions.

Recommendations Module: This tool enhances user retention by suggesting related content and live events based on the user’s previous interactions.

As a result, fans experience a more personal connection with the Olympic Games, its sports and athletes, which enhances loyalty and emotional investment.

Implications and Future Outlook

The integration of AI into OBS and OCS operations marks a transformative era in Olympic media production and distribution. These advancements not only redefine how the Games are covered and consumed but also illustrate broader trends within the global sports ecosystem.

Within the context of a massive multisport event like the Olympic Games, AI is helping less-known sports within particular territories or fan demographics to obtain higher visibility and, hopefully, gain more extended fan bases. For example, by providing explanatory graphics and data visualisations, AI makes elite sports more accessible to casual viewers and newcomers. Also, tools around trend detection help further promote diverse stories and enhance the visibility of athletes from smaller delegations that are performing well or in an unexpected manner.

A not uncommon criticism regarding big multisport events, where the Olympic Games is the uncontested leader, is about the potential of a negative impact on the host city, due to their size and temporal nature. On that front, AI, with its capacity to substantially optimise content creation workflows, can certainly help, especially in relation to the reduction of the footprint of the media operations in the host city.

Automated content creation and editing can reduce the carbon footprint

and financial overheads associated with traditional media operations. Content producers, including OBS and OCS but also the Media Right Holders, can operate at scale, delivering thousands of content pieces across dozens of disciplines in real time and with a fraction of the local human presence that this would have entailed without the support by AI.

Conclusion

Artificial intelligence is emerging as a certain game-changer in the realm of Olympic audio-video media production and distribution. Through strategic implementations by Olympic Broadcasting Services and Olympic Channel Services, AI is reshaping how the Games are produced, delivered, and experienced. OBS leverages AI to enhance live coverage and operational efficiency, while OCS uses AI to deliver personalised, relevant content to a global audience. Together, these organisations exemplify how technological innovation can enrich the storytelling and spectacle of the Olympic Games, without, however, triggering an equivalent increase in operational footprint in the host city. As we look toward future editions of the Olympic Games, AI will remain an ever-important tool for the IOC's vision to inspire and connect audiences around the world through the power of sport, while maintaining the size of the local media operations at an optimised level.

ETHICAL CHALLENGES OF AI IN OLYMPIC EDUCATION

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1. Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) has developed very rapidly in all fields, especially in sport. The use of AI in education has also grown fast, although it has been the subject of much controversy. The potential of AI to be used in most areas of human life, including Olympic education, is undeniable. However, it has important ethical implications that need to be addressed in order to avoid the collision of this technology with the foundations of education in general, and the rationale for Olympic education as a transformative philosophy of life in particular. The structure of this paper is as follows. First, in section 2, I will give a brief introduction to AI. Next, in section 3, I will discuss the benefits and risks of using AI in education, particularly in Olympic education. Finally, in section 4, I will present some of the key ethical challenges of AI in Olympic education and offer recommendations for its appropriate use.

2. A Very Short Introduction to AI

In this paper, I will adopt a widely accepted definition of AI, such as the one adopted by the Council of Europe Framework Convention on Artificial Intelligence

and Human Rights, Democracy and the Rule of Law. According to Art. 3 of the Convention:

“AI system” means a machine-based system that is designed to operate with varying levels of autonomy and that may exhibit adaptiveness after deployment, and that, for explicit or implicit objectives, infers, from the input it receives, how to generate outputs such as predictions, content, recommendations, or decisions that can influence physical or virtual environments. Different artificial intelligence systems vary in their levels of autonomy and adaptiveness after deployment. (Art. 2).¹

This definition is broad enough to encompass different AI systems. However, the emergence of chatbots has raised many questions and doubts about AI uses and applications. These concerns are not surprising. Generative AI, as a subfield of AI, has become the most popular AI tool. Chat GPT from Open AI™, Claude designed by Anthropic™, Gemini developed by Google™ or Midjourney™ for image generation, have reached millions of users around the world in a few months. But Generative AI has also raised several concerns in education. Generative AI, as a subfield of AI in processing and generating natural languages and images, is a vivid example of how AI systems are able to perform functions that traditionally require human intelligence, such as decision making, experiential learning, speech recognition and understanding natural language. Generative AI also has several applications in education such as personalising learning experiences, improving teaching methods and many others, as will be seen later in this paper.

But while many of these uses have a positive impact on education and human wellbeing, they can also lead to a situation of job displacement, reduce human interaction and raise privacy and ethical concerns. To have a clear picture of the pros and cons of AI in education, and particularly in Olympic education, it is important to take a step back and trying to understand some basic differences between AI techniques.

1. The full text of the Council of Europe Framework Convention on Artificial Intelligence and Human Rights, Democracy and the Rule of Law is available at <https://rm.coe.int/1680afae3c>

2.1. Different Types of AI

AI is a kind of umbrella term used to describe a wide range of technologies, such as algorithms, data processing systems and many different software systems. These systems process information and recommend actions by learning from mistakes and the environment. A usual way to distinguish between AI systems is differentiating narrow or weak AI from strong or general AI according to the ability of these systems to perform tasks within a limited domain or even at human level.

2.1.1 Narrow or Weak AI

The alleged weakness of these systems is related to their specific performing domain. Narrow AI systems have been designed to execute very specific tasks such as face recognition, voice identification, predicting words in a text and so on. Despite being described as a weak AI, it is the most common AI nowadays. Many of the applications of AI in sports fall under this category, such as the use of labelled data for making predictions and classifying instances of the game or even analysing and interpreting the data collected from wearable devices.

2.1.2. Strong or General AI

The name Strong AI comes from the ability of these AI systems to perform different tasks at a human level but in a much more efficient way. Strong AI is supposed to have important cognitive abilities, but they are not yet in practice (Butz, 2021). However, due to the fast development of AI, the integration of strong AI abilities into sports could allow these systems to develop intelligent coaching or make decisions according to the data that performance trackers collect. Thus, there is a minimal but very important difference between narrow and strong AI in sports: namely, who has control over the decision. Human agency is a necessary condition for the former since AI systems can recommend paths of actions but are not able to make decisions. The second, however, eliminates human agency.

2.1.3. Super AI

Super AI is, for now, an illusion. It does not exist at all, and most researchers are very sceptical that Super AI can be fully implemented in the future. Even if Super AI is theoretically possible, it would imply that machine intelligence supersedes humans. At that stage, not only would machines be able to interpret and

interact with human emotions, but they would also be able to make abstractions and interpretations that humans cannot, since the human brain is limited by nature. With the rapid improvement of Generative AI, some of the most sceptical researchers on Super AI are now convinced that it can be or even has been already achieved with the latest Gen AI developments.

To sum up, until now applications of current AI systems in sports and education fall under the category of narrow or weak AI. That is, AI systems that excel in a particular domain by emulating human intelligence and reasoning. These systems could be broadly classified into two different categories, namely i) rule-based systems and ii) machine learning systems.



Prof. Alberto Carrio Sampedro explored the theme of AI in Olympic education from the angle of the ethical challenges that emerge.

2.2. Narrow or Weak AI in Sport and Education

2.2.1. Rule-based Systems

Rule-based systems refer to a broader class of AI systems that rely on rules for decision making. Rule-based systems work just like human rules do: they rely on “if-then” statements which describe a condition to which a consequence

is attached, i.e. if the ball hits the net, then the serve is not valid in tennis and volleyball.

One type of rule-based systems is Expert systems, which are systems that, apart from the rules, also contain the facts of a specific domain. These systems incorporate an inference engine that evaluates the rules and the fact, that is the knowledge on a specific domain, to provide recommendations while producing new knowledge from the application of logic rules to the previous knowledge stored by the system (Sarker & Kayes, 2020). Expert systems are very helpful in sports and education since they have a broad knowledge base from sports or individual athletes and can recommend actions, optimising decision making in several fields of sport.

The following are examples of current relevant applications of Expert systems in sport:

- i) Tactical improvement. Several Expert systems have been developed in sports for analysing match data, individual statistics and many other factors, providing coaches with relevant tactical recommendations such as player positions, substitutions and modification of game strategies.
- ii) Injury assessment and prevention. Significant improvements in sports medicine can be reached by using Expert systems to assist in the assessment of sports injuries. These systems incorporate medical knowledge and injury databases, giving personal recommendations to athletes and professionals for injury assessment and recovery optimisation.

Examples of current relevant applications of Expert-systems in education are all the systems that attempt to generate and find data to analyse students' performance, learning enhancements, assess teaching and learning efficiency and so on.

2.2.2. Machine Learning Systems

Machine learning is a form of AI focused on how machines can learn from data and improve performance on specific tasks without being explicitly programmed. Narrow AI systems typically rely on machine learning algorithms to acquire knowledge and make predictions or decisions on a domain (Sarker 2021). There are three main techniques of machine learning, namely supervised learning, unsupervised learning and reinforcement learning. However, for the sake of the paper, I won't go into them here.

3. AI for Education

The idea of the use of AI in education has been around for a long time. For example, in the 1970s, some researchers started to analyse how computers could be used for tutoring learning and as assistive tools in the educational process (Carbonell, 1970; Self, 1974). But from those times to the present, the use and application of AI in education have developed immensely in different ways and directions. Now, we can use AI tools to support learning and assessment, teaching and even day-to-day management of educational institutions (Baker et al., 2019). It's important to realise that the impact of AI in education goes beyond the use of AI tools in the classroom or the interaction between teachers and students, goes further than learning or teaching with AI, since it also involves the whole society, which also needs to acquire some AI literacy as we are entering a new era where collaboration between AI and humans will be essential. That's because the increasing use of AI in education involves many other issues, such as the pedagogy of AI, ethical considerations, equal access and ethical use, among others.

As I mentioned earlier, AI has many proven and potential applications in education, such as increasing learner interest through chatbots, pedagogical planning through expert systems, tailored learning experiences through AI tutors, analysis of student data through machine learning, and many more (Zhang & Aslan, 2021). UNESCO has recognised the potential of AI to address some of the biggest challenges facing education, with the publication of the Beijing Consensus on Artificial Intelligence and Education. This document provides guidance and recommendations for harnessing AI for innovative teaching and learning practices to accelerate progress towards Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4): inclusive and equitable education and lifelong learning opportunities for all (UNESCO, 2019).

3.1. The Grounds of Olympic Education

Olympic education can be understood in different ways. However, this ambiguity can be overcome by contextualising the term. In this sense, we can understand Olympic education as a global educational project implemented by the members of the Olympic Movement, which could be divided into different stages and sub-programmes, such as those developed by the host cities of the Olympic Games, the International Olympic Academy, Olympic Studies Centres, and so on

(Davidov, 2021). In any case, all the different forms in which we can understand "Olympic education" have the same basis, namely the educational value of the practice of sport, and converge in the same objective: the transformation of the world through the implementation of an educational programme based on the values of sport.

In fact, that was Coubertin's goal. As he admitted, even if he were to be remembered for reviving the Olympics, his main goal was to consolidate the educational project behind them (Coubertin, 2000). In other words, the Olympic Games were instrumental in launching an ambitious educational programme destined to change the world. The seed of this pedagogical idea was planted and it only needed to be nurtured in an appropriate land, namely the Olympic Movement and the Olympic Education Programmes, even if Coubertin himself would never refer to them as such.

This ideal fuelled the first steps in establishing the IOA here in Olympia. It also encouraged the NOC to promote educational programmes. This ideal was eventually converted into a Principle of the Olympic Charter, which, from the 1978 edition onwards, incorporated the educational aims of the Olympics into the first Fundamental Principle: "to educate young people through sport in a spirit of better understanding between each other and of friendship, thereby helping to build a better and more peaceful world".

In other words, Olympic education is aimed at young people because they are the ones who, by learning through sport and its intrinsic values, are called upon to transform the world by putting these values into practice and creating a better place for everyone.

Since then, the Olympic Charter has incorporated more ethical values and commitments to human rights. Nowadays, six of the seven Fundamental Principles of the current Olympic Charter address ethical values to which the Olympic Movement is committed.

As Fundamental Principle I currently states:

Olympism is a philosophy of life, exalting and combining in a balanced whole the qualities of body, will and mind. Blending sport with culture and education, Olympism seeks to create a way of life based on the joy of effort, the educational value of good example, social responsibility and respect for internationally recognised human rights and universal fundamental ethical principles within the remit of the Olympic Movement.

So, the purpose of the first Fundamental Principle is to promote a new philosophy of life that serves as an individual and collective goal, inspiring people to act and transform the world until a perfect equilibrium is achieved between human qualities, respect for others, and the world in which we all live.

3.2. Olympic Education and AI

AI systems are, however, far from the philosophy of life that Olympism promotes. Certainly, the proliferation and increasing popularity of AI systems in education and sport does not transform them into ethical systems or imbue them with the spirit of sport and sporting values.² AI systems operate on algorithms that follow the patterns and instructions they have been trained on. The ethical side of AI systems relies on how they have been created, designed and governed by humans. But as we have seen above, AI systems can also be used to create new models and algorithms through machine learning and automated model generation. This is the challenge posed by “AI Autonomy” or “AI self-improvement”. To address this challenge, it is really important to have a strong AI governance with a continuous monitoring of AI systems to detect unintended behaviour and bias and other ethical concerns. However, incorporating human judgement and decision making in AI systems through “Human-in-the Loop Approaches” (HILA) is absolutely necessary to maintain control, validate the outcomes generated by AI systems and make necessary interventions when ethical concerns arise.

4. The Ethical Challenges of AI for Olympic Education

Good governance of AI in sports, and specifically for using it in fostering Olympic education, needs to take into account several considerations and be aligned with the Principles of Olympism as expressed in the Olympic Charter. In fact, as Fundamental Principle I states, one of the main aims of the Olympic Movement is blending sports with culture, scientific progress and education to promote sports as an example of social responsibility and respect for fundamental ethical principles. Accordingly, a responsible use of AI systems in Olympic education must be committed to safeguarding individual rights, avoiding risk and promoting the wellbeing of athletes and other stakeholders.

2. For a more detailed account of the ethical problems of AI in sport see, Carrio (2021, 2023 and 2024).

The governance of AI systems in sports must also be transparent, accountable and consistent with the principles of the Rule of Law and the ongoing process of the democratisation of sport governance, as required by the Olympic Agenda.

Sports are a key practice for human progress and wellbeing. Olympic education is a key tool not only for athletes but for society as a whole. In that sense, Olympic education must also address the key issue of human control and oversight of AI. While AI systems are already providing great insights in sports and education, human oversight ensures that final decisions are taken by considering previous ethical issues and athletes' wellbeing. Summing up, the aim of AI in Olympic education, as well as in Olympic sports, should be to promote responsible uses of AI, balancing AI insightful recommendations with human judgement, progress and wellbeing.

In order to have a better understanding of the different concerns surrounding AI governance, let us try to group these recommendations according to the Fundamental Principles of Olympism (FPO).

1. Safeguarding Individual Rights and Wellbeing

The first concern that an ethical governance of AI in sports must address is athlete safeguarding. The protection of the individual rights of the main stakeholders in sports is the first duty of SGBs. This is a requirement of FPOs 1, 2, 4 and 6

2. Good Governance

There is no doubt that good governance principles are also important requirements of Olympism. FPO 5 is clear in this respect, stating that Sports Organisations within the Olympic Movement have the responsibility to ensure that principles of good governance are applied.

3. Human Factor

Good governance of AI systems in sport needs to emphasise the fundamental role that humans play in governing and using AI in the sports domain. AI systems are not stand-alone entities but rather tools created, shaped and governed by humans. In this regard, the human factor can encompass both human agency and human oversight.

4. Sustainable AI

Sustainability is one of the three pillars of the Olympic Agenda 2020+5

(Recommendation 2). AI is an important tool for helping humanity to reach UN SDGs. In fact, there is much research done in this field as shown by the impressive work done by AI4Good network.³ But less interest is paid to the sustainability of AI itself. However, the astonishing footprint of AI systems calls for an urgent transformation in order to make them sustainable (Strubell et al 2019).

5. Positive Ethics

Defining an ethical framework to regulate AI in sports should be seen as an opportunity to change sports in a good and sustainable way. It is also an opportunity to change our mind about ethical commitments. Ethics is usually understood as a negative imposition to human actions and desires. However, by restricting some options it is possible to prevent risks and promote fair and sustainable human development and wellbeing (Coeckelbergh, 2020). Positive ethics is more about education than restriction, even if it is also sometimes necessary to restrict some actions to protect individual or collective rights and values.

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AI – OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES FOR OLYMPIC EDUCATION BRIDGING TRADITION WITH INNOVATION

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Introduction

The rapid advancement of technology has ushered in an era where Artificial Intelligence (AI) transforms countless fields, including education. These advances not only affect teaching content and methods, but also reshape educational models and organisations (Lee & Lee 2021). Researching educational technology is therefore essential for maximising resources and improving efficiency. As Liu and Cui (2024) note, AI is "like a double-edged sword, which brings opportunities as well as challenges in the application in the Olympic Movement".

Olympic education, rooted in Pierre de Coubertin's vision, seeks to instil values such as excellence, respect, and friendship through sport. But can AI truly enhance Olympic education while preserving its core values? Can Coubertin's vision of *l'éducation olympique* remain relevant in the age of AI?

Standing at the crossroads of tradition and innovation, this article explores how AI can bridge the rich legacy of Olympic education while unlocking new possibilities for its future.

What is Artificial Intelligence (AI)?

AI refers to the simulation of human intelligence processes by machines, particularly

computer systems (Craig 2024). The philosophical origins of AI are often traced back to Alan Turing's ground-breaking 1950 paper *Computing Machinery and Intelligence*, in which he posed the famous question, "Can machines think?" (Turing 1950, 1). His work laid the foundation for viewing thinking as a computational process that could, in principle, be replicated by machines.

Since then, the field of AI has advanced rapidly, impacting diverse sectors such as healthcare, finance, and, more recently, education. According to the OECD (2024, 4), an AI system is "a machine-based system that, for explicit or implicit objectives, infers from the input it receives how to generate outputs such as predictions, content, recommendations, or decisions that can influence physical or virtual environments". These systems vary in their levels of autonomy and adaptiveness.

Broadly, AI is recognised as the ability of machines to perform cognitive functions typically associated with the human mind such as learning, reasoning, problem-solving, perception, and decision-making. These systems can analyse vast amounts of data, recognise patterns, and make decisions with minimal human intervention (SAS 2019).

1. Opportunities: AI as a Tool for Olympic Education

Coubertin envisioned education through sport as a means to develop character, cultivate moral values, and promote international understanding. He saw Olympism as a tool for human and social progress. AI, when used responsibly, can advance these same goals in the following ways:

A. Personalised & Adaptive Learning: Tailoring Olympic Education to the Individual

People learn in diverse ways—some visually, others through hands-on experience. AI-powered platforms can revolutionise Olympic education by creating individualised learning plans that adapt in real time to each learner's strengths, needs, and preferences. For example, in basketball, AI systems objectively analyse player performance and offer targeted feedback for improvement (Li & Xu 2021, 56). Personalised education programmes provide pupils with a learning experience that is tailored to their own needs and abilities (Genç 2023, 27).

Pierre de Coubertin recognised the importance of adapting education to

future generations, stating "We must work on tomorrow, on the next generation that is about to enter the schools. The master of the hour is the school teacher, the professor" (Coubertin 2000, 191).

Today, AI can act as a modern "teacher", dynamically adjusting content and pacing to optimise engagement and outcomes. Many studies claim that students learn better when they are represented in a personalised way. This technology has the ability to learn from interactions with users over time to better anticipate their needs and provide more relevant results as well as personalised recommendations based on previous searches (Genç 2023, 27). This mirrors Coubertin's philosophy of adaptation and balance: "In life, balance is a result, not a goal [...] It is not achieved by taking every possible precaution but by alternating one's efforts" (Coubertin 2000, 549).

Just as Coubertin suggests that balance is achieved through varied approaches rather than rigid precautions, AI-based adaptive learning ensures flexibility in Olympic education. These platforms can personalise the learning journey, making Olympic values and history more accessible and engaging while fostering inclusivity. In essence, AI has the potential to transform Olympic education into an experience tailored to each learner's unique needs.

B. AI as a Medium for Experiential Learning: Fostering Olympic Values Through Simulations

Olympism is more than a set of rules; it is a mindset that evolves across generations and cultures. AI-based software and hardware devices can automatically extract and produce game highlights, and combine virtual reality, augmented reality, and mixed reality technologies to enhance the audience's experience (Li & Xu 2021, 56).

These tools enable students to "live" moments from Olympic history, face ethical dilemmas encountered by athletes and actively engage with values like excellence, respect, and friendship.

As Coubertin noted, "Olympism is not a system; it is a state of mind [...] It can permeate a wide variety of modes of expression and no single race or era can claim to have the monopoly of it" (Coubertin 2000, 548).

This philosophy aligns with modern experiential learning, where character is shaped through active participation. AI-driven simulations and gamified scenarios can foster critical thinking, ethical decision-making, and teamwork-core aspects of Olympism.

Coubertin also emphasised the importance of effort and struggle in personal growth: "The important thing in life is not the triumph but the struggle; the essential thing is not to have conquered but to have fought well" (Coubertin 2000, 587).

AI brings these principles to life through scenario-based learning, allowing learners to step into the shoes of athletes, face real ethical challenges, and develop essential skills in a highly engaging way.

The focus is on creating immersive scenarios that require ethical decision-making, problem-solving, and teamwork—all fundamental elements of Olympism.

Through gamification, interactive storytelling, and VR, AI transforms Olympic education from passive knowledge acquisition into a dynamic journey, deepening understanding and connection to Olympic values through direct experience.

C. AI-Powered Olympic Education: Transforming the Learning Ecosystem

Olympism refuses to catalogue the knowledge of the mind and to classify it into mutually isolated categories (Coubertin 2000, 547).

This quote reflects openness to innovative and interconnected approaches to education—an approach that aligns with the integration of AI-powered systems. AI and virtual technology-driven innovation and assessment in physical education can provide immersive and interactive experiences (Hu, Liu, & Su 2024, 2).

For example, interactive exhibits at the Olympic Museum could adapt to each visitor's interests and background, creating a personalised and engaging learning journey. It's like having a conversation with the museum. AI could analyse your progress and figure out where you're struggling, providing real-time feedback, answering questions, offering interactive lesson plans, and monitoring student progress to provide teachers with student performance data (Genç, 2023, 21).

Beyond personalising content, AI can help identify and address systemic inequalities in access to Olympic education by recommending alternative resources and activities that better suit each learner's needs. Furthermore, AI can be used more effectively in learner evaluation, providing more accurate and personalised feedback (Lee & Lee 2021, 9). This includes analysing performance in virtual simulations, identifying patterns of ethical behaviour, and providing targeted feedback to promote character growth. The emphasis is on holistic assessment that captures the full spectrum of Olympic values.

D. Accessibility and Inclusivity in Olympic Education

Olympism refuses to accept the existence of a deluxe education reserved for the wealthy classes, no shred of which should be handed out to the working classes (Coubertin 2000, 548).

For every man, woman and child, it offers an opportunity for self-improvement quite independent of profession or position in life. It is the prerogative of all, equally and to the same degree, and nothing can replace it (Coubertin 2000, 748).

These quotes directly address Coubertin's vision of inclusive and accessible education for all—a vision that AI-powered platforms can help realise in today's digital world. As Thomas Bach emphasised in his Olympic AI Agenda speech, "AI can help to identify athletes and talents in every corner of the world" (Bach 2024, 2), ensuring that Olympic education and opportunities reach beyond traditional boundaries.

For students with physical limitations or disabilities, AI technology must be designed with inclusivity at its core. The application of AI needs to be designed to adapt to different learning and physical abilities, and to provide additional support for students who have difficulty using digital tools due to cognitive, sensory or motor disorders (Wang & Wang 2024, 14).

AI can dismantle accessibility barriers through real-time translations, sign language interpretation, and adaptive tools for students with disabilities. This democratisation of Olympic education allows someone in rural Kenya to access the same high-quality materials as someone in London or Tokyo—fulfilling Coubertin's vision that sport and Olympic education should be "the prerogative of all, equally".

By leveraging AI responsibly, the Olympic Movement can ensure that education about Olympic values reaches a truly global audience, transcending linguistic, geographic, and physical limitations.

2. Challenges of AI in Olympic Education

While AI opens doors to remarkable advancements in Olympic education, it also casts a shadow of potential pitfalls. Is there a catch? Indeed, alongside the

opportunities, there are significant risks that accompany these opportunities. These challenges could threaten to undermine Pierre de Coubertin's vision of Olympism – a philosophy rooted in humanistic values such as effort, fair play, and transcendence. As AI reshapes the landscape of sports and education, it is crucial to address the red flags that may threaten the foundational principles of the Olympic Movement.

A. Loss of Human Interaction & Over Reliance on Technology

At Olympia, people gathered both to make a pilgrimage to the past and an act of faith in the future (Coubertin 2000, 597).

This emphasises the irreplaceable value of physical gatherings and shared experiences in Olympic education.

The goal of the Olympic Movement is to contribute to building a peaceful and better world by educating youth through sport practiced without discrimination of any kind and in the Olympic spirit, which requires mutual understanding with a spirit of friendship, solidarity and fair play (IOC 2025).

Direct human interaction is essential for cultivating values like friendship, solidarity, and fair play.

The increasing digitisation of Olympic education risks replacing interpersonal relationships with automated learning, reducing the role of teachers, coaches, and mentors in value transmission. AI cannot replace the personal connections that shape moral development.

Importantly, the aim is not to replace educators, but to empower them. Just as AI-driven coaching systems in basketball can assist coaches in developing personalised training plans and game strategies (Li & Xu 2021, 55), AI in Olympic education should serve as a tool to enhance teachers' effectiveness, not to substitute them. AI can process vast amounts of data and provide insights, freeing educators to focus on motivation, mentorship, and strategy. The key is to find the right balance where AI and human intelligence complement each other. As Lee & Lee (2021, 2) note, future physical education teachers will need specific expertise to integrate AI effectively into their teaching. Responsible use of AI should support, not replace, the vital human relationships at the heart of Olympic education.

B. Ethical Concerns: Data Privacy & Algorithmic Bias

A significant ethical challenge in AI is the potential for algorithmic bias. Algorithmic justice involves identifying and mitigating biases inherent in AI algorithms that can lead to discriminatory outcomes against marginalised groups (Vermeulen & Taludar 2024, 1). Such biases may stem from skewed training data, flawed algorithm design, or biased implementation.

As the Olympic Charter states:

Olympism seeks to create a way of life based on the joy of effort, the educational value of good example, social responsibility and respect for [...] universal fundamental ethical principles (IOC 2025b, 8).

To uphold these principles, it is essential to approach AI-driven educational tools critically. Educators and learners must prioritise data integrity, sound judgment, and critical thinking, rather than blindly trusting AI systems.

AI-based Olympic education programmes developed with biased datasets risk favouring certain regions, cultures, or socio-economic groups, contradicting the Olympic ideal of universality. Moreover, ethical considerations extend to data privacy. To that end, AI systems that process personal data must do so with respect for individual privacy and in compliance with data protection laws (Vermeulen & Taludar 2024, 2). AI systems often require extensive data collection, making it imperative to ensure that data is handled responsibly and in accordance with privacy regulations when using student information.

C. The Commercialisation & Commodification of Education: The Risk of a Digital Divide

Let us export rowers, runners and fencers; there is the free trade of the future (Coubertin 2000, 297).

Coubertin warned against the over-commercialisation of sport, emphasising that it should not be exploited for profit. This concern is equally relevant when considering AI in education, which is often driven by private-sector interests. The commercialisation of educational technologies can exacerbate social and educational inequalities (Selwyn 2011, 93). If access to AI tools is limited by cost, Olympic education risks becoming another paywalled resource, deepening divides rather than bridging them.

The threat extends beyond mere commercialisation. Control over AI systems and their underlying data raises critical questions: Will access to cutting-edge educational tools become a privilege reserved for wealthy nations or institutions? Such a scenario would fracture the Olympic Movement, transforming technological progress into a wedge that widens the gap between the technologically empowered and excluded. This contradicts Olympism's foundational principles of universality and inclusion, as enshrined in the Olympic Charter's commitment to "without discrimination" (IOC 2025b, 8-9).

To uphold the Olympic promise of universal opportunity, we must demand that AI serves as a ladder for all – not a gatekeeper for the few.



Dr Hilla Davidov analysed both the opportunities and the challenges for Olympic education using AI during her lecture, presenting examples and practical applications. The IOA Dean, Prof. Kostas Georgiadis coordinated the discussion with the participants.

3. Adapting Coubertin's Olympism to the AI Age

Coubertin's vision remains remarkably adaptable to modern technological developments. As a passionate advocate for education through sport, Coubertin understood the importance of growth and renewal. In this spirit, Olympism can

continue to flourish in the age of AI. Rather than viewing AI as a threat, it should be embraced as a powerful tool to realise Coubertin's ideals in the 21st century.

Olympism is not just about athletic excellence; it is about fostering cultural understanding, promoting peace, and upholding values of respect and friendship. AI has the potential to amplify these values, expanding their reach and making Olympic education more accessible and engaging for future generations.

A. Reaffirming Human-Centred Learning in AI-Based Olympic Education

Pierre de Coubertin's vision of Olympism centres on the joy of effort, the educational value of good example, social responsibility, and respect for universal ethical principles (Coubertin 2000, 528). Adapting this vision to AI-based Olympic education requires reaffirming a human-centred approach, where AI complements—rather than replaces—educators. Human-AI collaboration should reinforce mentorship and ethical reasoning.

Wang and Wang (2024, 2,13) stress the importance of incorporating AI technology into the training process for physical education (PE) teachers. They highlight that PE teachers face significant challenges in handling AI technology, including lack of knowledge, insufficient training, and resistance to change. Addressing these challenges is crucial to ensure that educators can effectively integrate AI into their teaching practices while maintaining the human-centred approach that Coubertin envisioned. To achieve this, teacher training programmes must focus on improving educators' acceptance and application abilities regarding AI technology (Wang & Wang 2024, 2). By equipping teachers with the necessary skills and understanding, AI can serve as a powerful tool to enhance Olympic education without undermining its core values of mentorship and ethical reasoning. This approach aligns with Coubertin's principles by ensuring that technological advancements are used responsibly to support human-centred learning rather than replacing it.

B. Ensuring AI Reflects the Ethical Foundations of Olympism

There can be nothing Olympic outside the contact and cooperation of the various branches of sports, united on a footing of total equality for the improvement of humanity (Coubertin 2000, 709).

AI-based Olympic education tools must embody the ethical pillars of

Olympism—fair play, respect, and international understanding—to ensure they are inclusive, unbiased, and respectful of individual rights. As highlighted in the Olympic AI Agenda, integrating AI into sports presents both opportunities and challenges, including concerns about data privacy, security, accountability, fairness, job displacement and environmental impact (IOC 2024, 4).

To align AI applications with Olympic values, it is crucial to address these ethical considerations proactively. Implementing comprehensive ethical frameworks can help mitigate risks such as bias and privacy infringements, while promoting inclusivity and fairness. As IOC President Thomas Bach emphasised, responsible leadership is needed to "offer equal access for all and ensure self-determination for any individual [...] while preserving human dignity and Olympic values" (Bach 2024, 2). By doing so, AI tools can enhance the Olympic educational experience without compromising the core principles that define the Olympic Movement.

C. Using AI to Expand Access to Olympic Education

Coubertin believed in spreading Olympic education, writing that "Olympism is a doctrine of fraternity" (Coubertin 2000, 569). AI can serve this goal by making Olympic education multilingual, universally accessible, and tailored to different educational contexts. By involving affected communities and conducting fairness audits, we can create AI systems that better address the needs of all users (Vermeulen & Taludar 2024, 7). This principle is essential for Olympic education—AI tools must be co-designed with underserved regions to ensure they bridge, rather than widen, access gaps.

Conclusion: The Future of Olympic Education & AI

Coubertin's philosophy of Olympic education was never static—it evolved alongside society, adapting to new challenges and opportunities. Today, at the crossroads of technological transformation, we are once again called to adapt. Olympic education must not resist change but guide it with vision and responsibility. As IOC President Thomas Bach wisely stated:

Our continued success depends on how we embrace the ever-accelerating development of digital technology, and in particular AI. This makes our Olympic Agenda 2020 imperative "change or be changed" even more urgent (IOC 2024, 2).

Rather than viewing AI as a threat to human-centred learning, we should harness its potential to advance Olympism's mission of promoting respect, excellence, and solidarity. AI offers unprecedented opportunities to personalise learning, increase accessibility across cultures and geographies, and engage young people in new and meaningful ways. As the Olympic AI Agenda recognises, "AI has the power to bridge some of the gaps that exist within sport" (IOC 2024, 4).

However, while the IOC's Olympic AI Agenda outlines a broad vision for integrating AI into the Olympic system, the focus remains largely on operational, competitive, and technological aspects, with less emphasis on innovative educational programmes or the integration of Olympic values in the digital age. This gap highlights the need for a dedicated policy to integrate AI into Olympic education, ensuring that Coubertin's values are preserved and strengthened in an era of technological change. The International Pierre de Coubertin Committee is planning meaningful steps to bridge this gap. One of their main initiatives will be to support the global network of Coubertin Schools through dedicated workshops for teachers. These workshops are intended to guide and empower educators to integrate AI responsibly into values-based Olympic education, ensuring that technology enhances—not replaces—the human and ethical core of learning.

In addition, the CIPC plans to use AI to make Coubertin's writings accessible, personalise learning, and create content for diverse cultures—helping share Olympic values worldwide.

All these efforts aim to keep Coubertin's vision alive in the digital age.

Yet, these opportunities come with profound responsibilities. The human dimension must remain at the heart of the Olympic spirit. As the Agenda warns, "AI stands in stark contrast to the particularly human context of Olympism" (IOC 2024, 4), raising ethical questions around fairness, transparency, and the preservation of values such as respect and solidarity. Olympic education must ensure that the values of fair play, mutual understanding, and personal growth remain central—not replaced but amplified by technology.

Just as Coubertin expanded the vision of sport from an aristocratic pursuit to a universal educational philosophy, so must we expand Olympic education to embrace AI in a way that reflects our core values.

This is not about choosing between humans or machines or between tradition and innovation, but about forging a partnership—one where technology amplifies human potential rather than replaces it. "Together, we can unlock the full potential of AI to promote solidarity [...] and reinforce the role of sport in society" (IOC 2024, 4).

If implemented wisely, AI can serve as a powerful tool for inclusion, peacebuilding, and value-driven education. Olympic education can evolve into a force that not only preserves Coubertin's legacy, but also reimagines it for a more connected, inclusive, and resilient future. Olympic education will not only endure in the age of AI it will thrive, inspiring future generations through a renewed vision that blends tradition with innovation.

In every innovation, let us remember the heart of the Olympic spirit, human connection and excellence. This dual commitment – to progress and to principles – can guide the responsible integration of AI into Olympic education, ensuring that Coubertin's vision not only survives but thrives in the era of AI.

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IOA – IOC OLYMPIC SOLIDARITY INSIGHT SESSION

THE OLYMPIC VALUES UNIT OF THE IOC OLYMPIC SOLIDARITY

Nils HOLMEGAARD (IOC)

*Head of the Olympic Values Unit, IOC Olympic Solidarity
Continental Manager Europe*

Thank you so much for the invitation to be here. It is truly special to stand in the birthplace of the Olympic Movement— not only because of its connection



to the ancient Games, but because of what this place represents for humanity. Greece, and Olympia in particular, remind us of the origins not only of sport, but of thought, philosophy, dialogue, and reflection.

We live in an age of short attention spans, where much of life is reduced to scrolling and quick reactions. Yet here we are, in a place where people still sit over a coffee and discuss ideas for hours. That feels almost revolutionary – and deeply symbolic because the Olympic Movement was built on the same foundation: that sport can be a platform for reflection, values, and human connection.

We are not just a federation of sports organisations. We are the Olympic Movement – something far greater, built on education, inclusion, peace, and respect. These ideas were born here, and we carry them forward across the world.

I would like to thank our hosts, the International Olympic Academy through President Tsolakakis, and you, Makis, for your leadership and the warmth of your team. You have built an institution that continues to inspire and educate across generations. My thanks also go to Alexandra, Professor Gangas, and Professor Georgiadis, who have been pillars of this work for many years, and to the new colleagues joining with great energy and vision.

It is a true honour to be with you. Over the past few days, I've seen your projects and presentations, and I'm deeply impressed. The number of young people whose lives are better thanks to your work is remarkable. You should all be proud.

From the IOC side, through Olympic Solidarity, our mission is to make sure these ideas can grow – that sport's impact reaches further. Ninety percent of the IOC's income is redistributed to support sport globally, mainly through Olympic Solidarity, which channels Games revenues – primarily from broadcast rights – to National Olympic Committees.

The Olympic Solidarity Commission, chaired by Dr Robin Mitchell and led administratively by our Director, James Macleod, oversees the share going to NOCs. For 2025–2028, we are managing USD 650 million, an increase from the previous period.

These funds support NOCs' participation in the Games, strengthen their structures, develop athletes and coaches, and advance education and values-based programmes – including projects led by the IOA and the National Olympic Academies – that bring Olympism to life worldwide.

Within Olympic Solidarity, I lead the Olympic Values Unit, managing USD 30 million dedicated to promoting sport as a force for good. When we speak

of Olympic values, we mean not only education but also concrete impact—in schools, communities, and daily life. It's about turning the IOC's vision of building a better world through sport into reality.

The NOAs play a vital role in this. Across the world, they expand access to sport, promote inclusion and sustainability, and make sport safer and more equal. Between 2021 and 2024, activity in this area grew by over 40 percent compared to the previous four years—and around one third of all Olympic Solidarity projects now involve an NOA. That is an extraordinary contribution.

So, thank you—for turning philosophy into action, and for showing that sport can indeed make the world a better place. The partnership between the IOC, the IOA, and the NOAs grows stronger every year.

Thank you for your commitment, your creativity, and your belief in the power of sport. And thank you for continuing to write new chapters in the Olympic story—a story that began right here.



INTERNATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY: THE GLOBAL CENTRE FOR OLYMPIC EDUCATION

Dr Makis ASIMAKOPOULOS (IOA)

IOA Director

This year represents a moment of great pride for the International Olympic Academy (IOA). We are hosting what is, in all likelihood, the largest ever joint session of Delegates from National Olympic Academies (NOAs) and National Olympic Committees (NOCs). We welcome representatives from 80 countries, a truly remarkable figure given that approximately 100 countries are currently active within our network. This level of participation is not merely symbolic—it is evidence of the vibrancy, commitment, and collaborative spirit that defines the global Olympic education movement. It is a powerful statement that NOAs and NOCs around the world are working with energy, purpose, and a shared vision.

The NOAs & NOCs

One of the distinctive strengths of the Olympic education network is its diversity. NOAs take different forms depending on the national context. Some operate as fully independent institutions with their own statutes and educational programmes. Others function as commissions under their respective NOCs but deliver robust and impactful work nonetheless. In other countries, educational initiatives are implemented directly by NOC commissions, fulfilling many of the responsibilities traditionally associated with an NOA.

Despite these differences in structure, all these bodies are united by a common mission: to provide educational opportunities and sporting pathways that embody and promote the philosophy of Olympism. This mission extends well beyond young people. Professionals working in facility management, events, federations, and national sport organisations also benefit from Olympic education. The IOA recognises that the Olympic Movement is not sustained solely by athletes and youth—it depends equally on a broad ecosystem of professionals who contribute their expertise and commitment every day.

Education in and Through Olympism

For more than six decades—since its founding in 1961—the IOA has worked to build a community where Olympic education is not confined to theory but is transformed into practical, meaningful action. Our goal is not simply to talk about values, but to use these values as the foundation for education and development.

Education through Olympism means offering programmes that equip individuals—regardless of their professional background—with the skills, perspectives, and ethical grounding to make a difference in their communities. This approach is central to our philosophy: Values are not an end in themselves, but a framework through which learning, leadership, and change are achieved.

Every year, we welcome NOA and NOC Delegates to a range of sessions and programmes: the NOA/NOC Sessions, the Young Ambassadors programme, the Postgraduate Master's Programme, and the Educators' Session, among others. These initiatives provide spaces where ideas are exchanged, professional networks are built, and participants return home inspired to act.

In addition, we are exploring new educational opportunities, including

programmes tailored for NOC Presidents and General Secretaries – recognising that leadership renewal takes place every four years and that engagement with Olympic education at the leadership level is vital. We are also considering initiatives for media professionals and athletes, including linking these programmes with symbolic events such as the Olympic Flame Lighting Ceremony to enhance their impact.

The Contemporary Challenges

The world of sport is evolving rapidly, and with it, the educational needs of the Olympic community. We are actively developing sustainable and affordable programmes that address pressing contemporary challenges: environmental sustainability, social responsibility, good governance, integrity, and ethics. Many sports organisations now employ sustainability managers and integrate social responsibility into their operations. The IOA aims to be at the forefront of preparing and supporting this new generation of professionals.

We work closely with the International Olympic Committee (IOC) on these initiatives. The IOA collaborates on the ethics programme and other strategic areas of education, with Dr Georgiadis playing a key role in the design and implementation of many of these programmes.

Over the past 20 years, the Olympic education landscape has expanded and diversified. Education in and through Olympism is now delivered through a multitude of actors: government ministries of education and sport, NOAs and NOCs, Pierre de Coubertin schools, athlete-founded foundations, Olympic Studies Centres, Olympic Libraries, Olympism365 initiatives, and even private sector entities. This richness presents both opportunities and responsibilities. It calls for clarity of purpose and for renewed articulation of the IOA's distinct role.

Defining the IOA's Role: The Global Centre for Olympic Education

In response to this evolving environment, the IOC commissioned an independent research study to assess the IOA's current positioning. Conducted over eight months, the study involved extensive interviews with Olympic education experts, NOA representatives, IOC officials, IOA stakeholders, media professionals, sponsors, and academics.



The IOC Olympic Solidarity programmes as well as the IOA activities were presented by Nils Holmegaard and Dr Makis Asimakopoulos respectively.

The outcome of this process is clear and inspiring: The IOA is recognised as the global centre for Olympic education, where timeless and universal values shape future leaders and change makers.

This vision goes beyond education “about” Olympism. It embraces education in and through Olympism – using the philosophy and values of Olympism to inform learning across all professional and personal domains. Whether participants are facility managers, programme coordinators, federation officials, or educators,

our goal is to help them develop as leaders and role models, guided by the value of excellence.

Our educational programmes aim to offer a transformational experience—one that fosters holistic development both personally and professionally. Olympic education is not only a philosophical endeavour; it is also a practical tool for professional growth. This is a crucial distinction that informs our strategic direction.

A Laboratory for Ideas: Balancing Freedom and Structure

As part of the Olympic Movement, the IOA occupies a unique position: We are both an academic institution and a member of a global sports structure. This dual role means that we must carefully balance our responsibilities. On one hand, we uphold and support the Olympic Movement. On the other, we maintain the intellectual freedom necessary to serve as a laboratory for new ideas—including those that are bold, radical, or ahead of their time.

Where better than here, in Olympia, to encourage critical reflection on the future of Olympism? Through rigorous academic teaching, open enquiry, and engagement with our worldwide network of experts, we strive to foster spaces where meaningful dialogue and vigorous debate thrive. These exchanges are not abstract exercises; they help shape how Olympism is applied in daily life around the world.

Guided by the values of excellence, respect, and friendship, and working in close collaboration with the global network of NOAs, the IOA brings together a diverse community of international participants. Here, they learn, discover, and draw inspiration from the philosophy of Olympism.

Education for a More Humane and Connected World

The IOA's work is grounded in a profound belief: Education has the power to create a more humane and connected world. By promoting education through the universal and timeless values of Olympism, we aim to help individuals realise their potential, bridge cultural divides, and foster mutual understanding.

This is not merely a vision for the IOA—it is a shared mission with NOAs, NOCs, and partners across the globe. The Olympic Movement looks to us to play a leading role in shaping its educational future. Through the people we

educate, train, and inspire here in Olympia, we collectively shape the future of Olympism itself.

Establishing the IOA Awards for Educational Programmes

As part of this commitment, we are launching a new initiative: the IOA Awards for Educational Programmes, to be introduced in 2026. This initiative aims to recognise and celebrate the outstanding work of NOAs and NOC education commissions worldwide. Over the past days, we have heard inspiring examples of impactful educational initiatives from many countries. These awards will acknowledge such achievements and encourage even greater innovation and excellence.

The awards will highlight exceptional contributions across a number of thematic categories, including excellence in educational programmes, athlete development, Olympic cultural legacy, sustainability and green sports, research as well as community engagement and social impact educational programmes.

The process will be structured and transparent. Each May, during the NOA/ NOC Session, a commission of IOA representatives and NOA experts will review and refine the awards framework. Categories will be announced publicly in October, submissions will close at the end of December, and evaluation will be completed by March. The awards ceremony will take place in May each year in Ancient Olympia.

Through these awards, we hope to inspire continuous improvement, recognise best practices, and create role models within the Olympic Movement. By sharing and celebrating these achievements, we can encourage their wider adoption and strengthen the global Olympic education community.

Strengthening IOA Infrastructure and Academic Foundations

Beyond new initiatives, the IOA is committed to reinforcing its existing foundations and resources.

Young Olympic Ambassadors' Session

Each June, the Young Olympic Ambassadors' Session remains one of our flagship

programmes. For many participants, it is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity to visit Ancient Olympia, engage in transformative experiences, and build global friendships. We encourage all countries to ensure that their young people have the chance to participate.

For Dr Georgiadis and myself, who first attended as young participants in 1989, it is particularly meaningful to now serve as leaders of the Academy and witness this enduring legacy.

Modernising the IOA Library

We are also proud to be modernising our library, already the second largest Olympic library in the world, and connecting it with the IOC Olympic Studies Centre and the IOC's Olympic World Library. After a period of limited development during the economic recession in Greece, we are now investing significantly in upgrading this resource.

We warmly invite NOAs and NOCs to contribute publications from their countries to enrich our collection and make these materials available to researchers and practitioners worldwide.

Expanding Academic Partnerships

The IOA has re-engaged with Erasmus+ projects and is eager to collaborate with NOAs and NOCs to develop competitive proposals. These projects not only enhance the IOA's activities but also provide direct benefits to our partners.

We also continue our academic collaboration with the University of the Peloponnese, with which we co-organise the Master's Programme in Olympic Education and Event Management. In partnership with the University of Patras, we are now working to establish a School for Olympic Studies in Ancient Olympia.

This new academic institution will offer two bachelor's degrees – one in Sustainable Event Management and another in Digital Humanities – as well as postgraduate studies. With a projected student body of 600–700 students living and studying in Ancient Olympia, this initiative aims to transform the region into a global hub for Olympic education, research, and innovation.

The IOA stands at a pivotal moment in its history. The expansion of Olympic education around the world is a source of inspiration, but also a call to action. We must embrace our role as a global centre of Olympic education – a place

where timeless values guide future leaders and where new ideas shape the path forward.

Through our programmes, our collaborations, and our academic initiatives, we will continue to strengthen the foundations of Olympism. Together with NOAs, NOCs, and our global partners, we will build an educational movement that not only preserves the Olympic ideals but translates them into meaningful action for a better world.

In a spirit of excellence, respect, and friendship, I thank you all for your ongoing commitment and look forward to working together to realise this shared vision.





From the works of the Session in the IOA Amphitheatre.





Alexandra Karaïskou and Tolis Matsaridis coordinated the video presentation of the work carried out by the NOAs and NOCs on the field of Olympic education.

**SHORT PRESENTATIONS
BY THE NOAs' AND NOCs' DELEGATES**

NZOC EDUCATION ACTIVITIES 2024

Olympic Ambassadors and Values Promotion

2024 saw a record number of 308 NZOC Olympic Ambassadors' visits, with teachers commenting on the strength of the messaging around the Olympic Values of friendship, respect and excellence and the ideas of resilience and persistence. Ambassadors travelled to regions that do not have local Ambassadors for multiple visits, and upon returning from the Paris Olympic Games many of our Olympic Ambassadors brought fresh inspiration to schools in their hometowns, reinforcing the connection between Olympic achievements and local communities. These visits reached over 60,000 students.

Feedback from schools was overwhelmingly positive. Students found the visits motivational and educators appreciated the alignment of the Olympic messages with school values and the New Zealand Curriculum. Survey results supported this impact, with 100% of students reporting they enjoyed the visits and felt inspired, and 99.5% acknowledging a better understanding of perseverance. Teachers found the visits highly relevant, with 99.5% affirming their educational value.

Olympic Education Resources and School Engagement

There was a very good uptake of NZOC education resources by teachers and students during the Paris 2024 Olympic Games, with a significant increase in primary, intermediate and secondary schools registered to access the resources on the NZOC Education website.

The NZOC's digital education initiative saw expanded reach and impact in 2024. Paris 2024-themed resources covering Getting to Know France, Finding Out About Paris and the Olympics, Olympic Sports, Environmental Sustainability

at the Paris 2024 Olympic Games, Building the Legacy of the Games and The Integrity of the Games – Values and Manaaki were made available on the newly redesigned NZOC website. Resource registration rates increased significantly, with 87% of primary and intermediate schools and 86% of secondary schools (up 7% and 10% respectively from 2023) registered to access Olympic education content.

Over 4,800 new email registrations were recorded across the NZOC website platform throughout the year, with users ranging from schools to home schoolers and early childhood educators. Teachers praised the resources' flexibility and relevance, with many integrating them into broader learning inquiries and PE programmes.

Olympic Day and Community Activations

Olympic Day 2024 was celebrated in Invercargill, where over 300 students from Southland Boys High School participated in physical and interactive sessions themed "Let's Move." The students took part in activities such as sport climbing, the interactive multi wall, touch tag, boxing and the Tour de Fern cycling activation and these were complemented by an inspirational Ambassador presentation from Olympian Alexis Pritchard. This event, alongside 21 school visits that occurred around Olympic Day, provided students with hands-on Olympic experiences and motivational storytelling.

The Tour de Fern initiative brought Olympic excitement to schools across six cities, allowing students to race in a virtual Tour de France simulation while learning about the Games and hearing from Ambassadors. This fun and educational activation strengthened student engagement and knowledge about the Olympic Movement.

Digital Engagement: My Virtual Mission and Kahoot

Digital tools played a vital role in 2024. Two hundred and fifty classes participated in My Virtual Mission for Paris 2024. The virtual route was just over 1500 kms around France, greater Paris and the city of Paris, passing by many of the venues where the NZ Team competed. Milestone points along the way gave more details about the NZ Team athletes and teams, as well as venues and famous landmarks in Paris. When classes reached a milestone they also received a video message from



Prof. Maria Bulatova from the NOA of Ukraine and Prof. Asta Sarkauskiene from the NOA of Lithuania donated publications to be included in the NOAs' repository in the IOA Library.

one of the NZ Team athletes. Additionally, a Kahoot on all things Olympics and The New Zealand Team, “The NZ Team – Paris 2024 Olympic Games” Kahoot, was played over 1200 times, involving over 15,800 players during the Games.

Strategic Oversight and Future Readiness

The Olympic Education Commission continues to operate effectively, with representatives across all education sectors contributing strategically and practically. Their work ensures the NZOC’s education programme remains responsive, inclusive and forward-looking.

In summary, 2024 was a very successful year for Olympic education in New Zealand, marked by record school participation, increased digital engagement and meaningful promotion of Olympic values that will resonate with students for years to come.

THAILAND OLYMPIC ACADEMY

Dr Nipat UNGPAKORNKAEW (THA)

Member, NOA of Thailand

Dear Olympic Fellows,

It's my pleasure to present the work at Thailand Olympic Academy regarding the promotion of Olympism among young athletes, their families, friends and communities at large. At the beginning of each year, we reflect on past performance, asking how we, as Olympic volunteers, can achieve better results for Olympism and make profound impacts further, wider and deeper.

Apart from such reflection and passion, we always integrate policies, plans and guidelines from the International Olympic Committee and the International Olympic Academy regarding the global context of the Olympic Movement and also the Thailand National Sports Development Plan on the mandate within the local context in particular.

At present, Thailand's Constitution envisions sport towards excellence and the greater good of Thai citizens. Given that there are about 100 National Federations, 77 Provincial Federations and thousands of sports clubs spreading around the country, the Thailand Olympic Academy always strives to put young athletes at the heart of these sports organisations, together with Olympism and good governance, including safeguarding in sport.

Having implemented hundreds of projects at the Olympic Academy for 20 years so far, we have a strong opinion that Thailand is now ready to assume a bigger role and responsibility in the Olympic Movement through bidding for the Youth Olympic Games 2030.

Since 2018, the vision of Bangkok-Chonburi 2030 has been shared by the Royal Thai Government, the National Olympic Committee of Thailand, and

Khunying Pattama Leesawatrakul, the IOC member in Thailand. During this time, the Thailand Olympic Academy has worked closely with the Sports Authority of Thailand on the feasibility and planning of the Games.

The vision of the Games has been well communicated and discussed with all National Federations and Provincial Federations through workshops and seminars organised by the Sports Authority of Thailand and also at the National Games including the Youth Games, Master Games and Para Games.

In addition, we have also introduced and promoted the Olympic Values Education Programme to the Ministry of Education hoping that, one day in the near future, tens of millions of students from year 1 to year 12 will enjoy and benefit from the lifelong learning of OVEP.

My friends, if the bidding is successful, it will be the honour of our Olympic Academy community to play the major role in hosting the Youth Olympic Games 2030. If not, we will instead be proud of having been a crucial part of a historical milestone for the Olympic Movement. Today for a Better Tomorrow.

Carpe diem. Seize the day, my friends.

ESWATINI OLYMPIC AND COMMONWEALTH GAMES ASSOCIATION (EOCGA) 2024–2025 PROGRAMMES

The Eswatini Olympic and Commonwealth Games Association (EOCGA) implemented several impactful initiatives between 2023 and 2025 to advance sports development, education, leadership, gender equality, and youth empowerment in Eswatini. These programmes reflect the organisation’s ongoing commitment to the Olympic values of excellence, respect, and friendship, while promoting sustainability and inclusion across all levels of society.

1. Olympic Education Programme

As part of a strategic effort to reshape perceptions of sport in Eswatini, EOCGA launched an Olympic education programme aimed at integrating sport into the national educational curriculum. This initiative emphasises the vital role sport plays in personal development, discipline, and community cohesion. Khanyisile Primary School notably participated in one of the sessions, showcasing enthusiasm and knowledge that exemplified the programme’s goals. Through this initiative, students are encouraged to view sport not merely as extracurricular, but as a fundamental aspect of their holistic development.

2. Sports Administration Level 1 Training

In 2023 and 2024, EOCGA held Sports Administration Level 1 courses at the Olympafrica Centre in Lobamba to enhance leadership and governance in sport. Two cohorts – 35 participants in October 2023 and 52 in May 2024 – completed a comprehensive curriculum covering communication, governance, equality, finance, project management, and resource mobilisation. Facilitated by Pearl Dlamini and Thoba Mazibuko, the training concluded with an examination and

a joint graduation ceremony in September 2024. Certificates were awarded to 72 participants, with top performers receiving special recognition. The presence of EOCGA President, Adam Mthethwa and Vice President, Zakhele Dlamini underscored the significance of building a capable and ethical leadership pipeline for Eswatini's sports sector.

3. Olympic Day Celebrations

Olympic Day was celebrated on June 28 2024, in Mbabane and July 5 2024, in Lobamba, drawing over 2,500 participants in total. These events promoted Olympic values through athletics, tennis, boxing, gymnastics, teqball, and other fun activities. Ekwetsembeni Primary School, serving students with disabilities, also participated, showcasing inclusivity. The presence of regional Olympic leaders and active involvement from national federations highlighted the strength of regional cooperation. The Lobamba event concluded with a symbolic tree-planting ceremony, representing growth and sustainability.

4. Athletes' Forum 2024

Held on October 19 2024, the Athletes' Forum gathered 80 athletes from 23 federations at the Olympafrika Centre. Chaired by Sibusiso Matsenjwa and featuring Olympian guest speaker Sizwe Ndlovu, the forum provided a space for athletes to voice their concerns, learn about anti-doping, and address mental health challenges. Psychologist Lungi Khanya delivered an impactful session on mental well-being, emphasising the importance of holistic athlete support. An open Q&A fostered strong dialogue and unity among athletes.

5. Gender Equality Forum

The Gender Equality Forum, hosted on April 13 2024, at Ezulwini Happy Valley Hotel, addressed critical issues such as inclusion, sustainability, safeguarding, and athlete well-being. With 70+ participants – 85% of whom were women – the event featured notable leaders, including Minister Bongani Nzima and ANOCA 2nd Vice President Matlohang Moiloa Ramoqopo. Key discussions focused on protecting

athletes from abuse, supporting mental health, and integrating environmental sustainability into sport. Interactive sessions allowed attendees to engage directly with experts, fostering collective action for equitable sports development.

6. “O! Yes” Youth Empowerment Programme

Launched at the Olympafrica Centre, the “O! Yes” programme targets youth aged 10–16, promoting equal gender participation while integrating sport and sustainability. Since January 2025, athletics and volleyball have been the primary focus, complemented by Sustainability Workshops encouraging students to collect and repurpose waste. On January 31 2025, students from Elangeni, Lobamba National, and St. Mary’s Primary Schools actively participated in a clean-up and recycling initiative.

The programme also included School Activation Tournaments in October 2024, introducing friendly competitions that reinforced teamwork, fair play, and Olympic values. These activations strengthened school partnerships and laid the groundwork for continuous engagement and growth.

Conclusion

The EOCGA’s initiatives from 2023 to 2025 reflect a strategic and inclusive approach to developing sport in Eswatini. Through education, leadership training, gender equality advocacy, youth empowerment, and community engagement, these programmes collectively build a stronger, more ethical, and sustainable sporting ecosystem. Each initiative not only upholds Olympic values but also positions sport as a powerful vehicle for national development and social cohesion in Eswatini.

NATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY OF BARBADOS 2024 REPORT

The Barbados Olympic Association Inc. and its National Olympic Academy are committed to ensuring, through initiatives, that the ideals and values of Olympism are infused within all educational, training and sport-for-all programmes. The testimonies within our 2024 Year in Review Report support how we seek to transform the lives of all stakeholders while supporting their professional and personal development. Additionally, every activity executed within our NOA is aligned with the strategic pillars of the Association to assist in the achievement of our goals and objectives.

Pillar 1 – Inspiring Excellence, Fuelling Passion

Barbados Athletes Commission & Athlete Leadership Development

The Barbados Athletes Commission has been actively supporting athlete development through education and engagement. Media Interaction Workshops trained 70 athletes in effective communication to better promote themselves, their sport and their country and ultimately as ambassadors of the Olympic Movement's values. The Mix & Mingle event re-introduced the Commission's role and encouraged athletes to form commissions within their federations. This event also unveiled the Barbados Sport Co-Operative Society Ltd, aimed at supporting sports entrepreneurship. Looking ahead, the Commission plans to implement the Commonwealth Games Federation's Game Changers programme in 2025, focusing on amplifying The Athlete's Voice, which seeks to allow our athletes to boost public engagement and education on how sport and the values of the Movement have contributed to their development.

Pillar 2 – Transforming Lives Through Sport

Promotion of the Olympic Values – Tours, Conferences, Activities, Youth Development Initiatives

Transforming Lives Through Sport saw several impactful initiatives in 2024. Museum tours hosted by Academy staff engaged school children and visitors to our island with Olympic history – both in general and within the Barbadian context – and the values associated with Olympism. The I Am... Conference educated students on sports career pathways and highlighted Barbadian athletes' achievements, with Academy representatives managing the BOA booth to engage our youth in the opportunities within the Movement. TAFISA World Walking Day featured a coastal sunrise hike to increase awareness about sustainability and environmental issues to encourage people to contribute to attainment and participation in key areas of the SDGs. The Pontifications & Poetry Competition in collaboration with our Ministry of Education promoted public speaking and sports awareness, with an emphasis on a healthy lifestyle and how Olympic values and qualities can be exhibited when involved in sports. Our category garnered the most finalists in the competition, with strong primary school participation. Notable winners from the sports category were recognised. Additionally, Ayanna Morgan and Nakish Joseph initiated their IOC Young Leaders Programme (2025–2028) applications, with Ayanna shortlisted from 400+ applicants.

Despite the lack of human resources during the first half of the year, efforts to promote Olympic values in schools were still made, and with the addition of more staff this will hopefully be remedied. Additionally, to address this, we have sought permission to introduce OVEP to our schools to utilise the PE teachers within schools as a critical partner. However, the awards podium created in 2020 has expanded its reach to government ministries, businesses, schools, and sports federations, increasing awareness of Olympic values at various events and allowing for greater community engagement and education on the values. TAG sessions successfully integrated values-based learning in schools, engaging 50 students with archery, taekwondo, and tag rugby. The debriefing confirmed students gained deep insights into key life skills and the overall objective of demonstrating how Olympic values are used within everyday life and contribute to a better world.

International Sessions & Youth Development

Representatives Nakish Joseph and Carl Hinkson attended the 64th International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors (YOA 2024) in Greece, excelling in their presentations and cultural engagement. The 4th National Session for Young Participants (NSYP 2024) had its highest participation yet, featuring 24 attendees, including CANOC members from Dominica, Guadeloupe, and Saint Kitts and Nevis. Participants engaged in panel discussions, museum tours, and quizzes, finding it transformative. The NYSP Session serves as the medium in which we identify the following year's Ambassadors. At this 64th Session, Cherise Slocombe (tennis) and Tremayne Griffith (badminton) were selected to represent us at the 65th Session.

Global Celebrations

The International Day of Sport for Development and Peace (IDSDP) 2024 was celebrated at Mapp Hill Playing Facility, primarily involving at-risk children. Sixty students engaged in boxing, judo, karate, taekwondo, and wrestling, learning about self-discipline and peaceful conflict resolution. The National Peace Programme praised the initiative and suggested future workshops for Change Agents. The Olympic Day celebrations spanned two weeks, featuring a Virtual Walk Challenge, a week-long walk, and a GLOW Run & Fun Walk, encouraging participation across various age groups. Both initiatives were used to promote Olympic values within schools and communities. Collaborations with Barbados Community's College's Sports Day and an International Festival Day highlighted Olympic traditions and allowed students to have the opportunity to engage with Olympians and fun interactive games.

Pillar 3 – Building Capacity

Coaching Development, Sport Administrative Management & Policy Implementation

The Barbados Coaching Pathway Framework was formally implemented with the training of Learning Facilitators and Course Evaluators to conduct the National Coaching Certification Program Level 1 course delivery across the island. This flagship project sought to improve the knowledge, skills and competences of

our coaches, physical education teachers and volunteers within the sporting community. The introduction of our Coaches Community of Learning practice allows for a safe space for coaches to present topics to learn and share with each other, while opportunities to attend training camps to upskill were also provided.

Olympic scholarships were utilised under the International Support Program to African and Caribbean Sport (PAISAC) where Althea Belgrave completed advanced coaching certification, and Jarad Murray was accepted for PAISAC 2024–2025. Kerry Trotman graduated from the International Coaching Course (ICC) in Hungary, while the MEMOS XXVI programme saw Jesse King receive a distinction for his strategic project on elite athlete development in Barbados.

Our Sport Administrators benefited where engaging with persons from a diverse number of sports within their group and with a wide range of topics, which allowed for a better understanding of the Olympic sporting environment and the values it represents and safeguards for its membership. Additionally, we conducted Team Management workshops and expanded the Safeguarding in Sport initiative where we trained 11 facilitators, with four of these individuals completing a trainer-of-trainers certification, ensuring a stronger framework for protecting athletes and their entourage.

Pillar 4 – Sustaining Our Legacy

Community Engagement & Social Impact

The reactivation of the National Olympic Academy Instagram page on October 14, 2024, managed by intern Kásahra Hinds, led to increased engagement with Olympic-related initiatives. It is critical to use social media to communicate all initiatives executed by the Academy to build greater awareness of the Olympic Movement and the values which we promote. The unveiling of the bust of James Wedderburn – our first ever Olympic medallist – paid tribute to his legacy. Various stakeholders have given positive feedback and appreciated the enhanced engagement and our efforts to communicate more effectively.

With continued emphasis on athlete empowerment, coaching development, Olympic values' promotion, and sport-based community engagement, Barbados remains committed to transforming lives through sport while enhancing its presence in local, regional and international sporting initiatives in 2025.

ARGENTINE OLYMPIC ACADEMY REPORT 2024-2025

In 2024, the traditional annual session of the Argentine Olympic Academy was held with great success.

This educational initiative, driven by the Argentine Olympic Committee, aims to promote the values, principles, and foundations of the Olympic Movement among new generations.

The session brought together 40 young people aged 19 to 29, carefully selected by their national sports federations and provincial governments for their commitment to sport, leadership, and values-based education.

Throughout five intensive days, participants engaged in a comprehensive educational experience, combining theoretical content, recreational activities, and spaces for reflection and debate.

The academic programme covered a wide range of topics related to Olympism, including the following:

- the structure of sport at international and national levels
- Olympic values education
- sport and sustainable development
- anti-doping education
- the role of athletes and Athletes' Commissions
- the organisation of an Olympic mission
- the bidding and selection process for hosting the Olympic Games
- leadership in sports organisations
- the experience of attending the IOA Young Ambassadors Session
- communication and AI in the Olympic Games, among other topics.

The academic experience was complemented by recreational and sports activities, designed not only for enjoyment but also to embody the values of respect, friendship, and excellence.

Shared moments helped strengthen bonds and encourage collaboration

among participants. Additionally, these activities promoted experiential learning through the Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) of the International Olympic Committee.

As part of the closing of the session, representatives were selected to attend the International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors in Olympia (Greece), organised by the International Olympic Academy.

The selected participants will have the opportunity to carry the Argentine Olympic spirit to the birthplace of the Olympic tradition, engaging with youth from all over the world.

New Educational Experiences in 2025

Continuing with this educational approach, in February 2025 a new initiative was implemented as part of a high-performance training camp for youth national teams, bringing together 278 athletes from individual sports.

On this occasion, the Olympic Values Education Programme (OVEP) was applied as a pedagogical tool, generating another meaningful learning opportunity. Likewise, in April 2025, the initiative was replicated with winter sports athletes preparing for the Milano Cortina 2026 Winter Olympic Games, reinforcing the connection between high-performance training and values education.

Moreover, in an unprecedented initiative, a dedicated Olympic education programme is being developed for the first time for a regional Games event that is part of the Olympic cycle: the South American Games, to be held in the province of Santa Fe in 2026.

This programme seeks to leave a tangible educational legacy among young people in the host province and surrounding communities.

Impact and Projection

The Argentine Olympic Academy continues to establish itself as a key space for training and developing future generations of sports leaders, educators, and promoters of Olympism.

The 2024 session not only met its intended goals but also reaffirmed the Argentine Olympic Committee's commitment to education and the transmission of values through sport, expanding its reach to new audiences and contexts.

NOC OF SERBIA AND OLYMPIC ACADEMY OF SERBIA OLYMPIC EDUCATION BEST PRACTICES 2024

Project: “Promotion of Olympic Values – Respect, Friendship, and Excellence”

Based on the Memorandum of Cooperation signed in June 2022 between the Ministry of Education and the Olympic Committee of Serbia, project Promotion of Olympic Values – Respect, Friendship and Excellence was organised for the second time with the main idea being to bring the fundamental values of Olympism to life in the elementary school education system in Serbia.

Students were introduced to values-based learning, while using sport pedagogy to highlight excellence, respect, and friendship. The project was implemented from March to May 2024 in 64 Primary Schools across 17 districts in Serbia, engaging over 12,000 sixth and seventh-grade students and 800 teachers. The initiative began with seminars for teachers and included various resources: Olympic education textbooks, OVEP materials, the Virtual Olympic Museum, as well as the *TreninGO* Mobile App to encourage physical activity and specially designed interactive MapApp posters.

Each school organised activities across various subjects and engaged students, teachers and communities. As a final task, they submitted a creative final work on the theme “Olympic Day”, tracked student activity via the *TreninGO* App, and completed an Olympic quiz. An expert commission selected five schools for the final event held on May 29th in Belgrade, which included visits from Olympic champions and fun competitions in the following activities: Olympic Quiz – Test Your Knowledge, Memory Game – Match Paris Pictograms, Creative Game – Make School Olympic Poster, Eco Game – Separate the Waste through Polygon and Physical Activity – *TreninGO* Exercise Test.

The winning school was Josif Pančić from Belgrade. All finalists received valuable prizes, including training equipment, educational workshops, and a visit from an Olympic champion. In addition, Fair Play Awards were given for the best teams of fans, who were asked to create choreography, mascots, cheers and song. The project had a strong media and social media presence, reaching one million people.

Exhibition Olympic Games—More Than Sports!

Ahead of the Olympic Games in Paris, the largest and most important sporting event in the world, the exhibition *Olympic Games—More than Sports!* was organised from 7 June to 30 June 2024, at the Silosi venue in Belgrade, by the Olympic Committee of Serbia Olympic Museum and the Gaia Movement. The exhibition represented a fusion of sport, art, and education, with the main goal of bringing the Olympic Movement closer to the visitors—emphasising that its greatness and importance go beyond competitions and records.

In a unique 700 m² industrial space, the exhibition was divided into 13 thematic units, each focusing on specific aspect of Olympism. These units included Olympic Flame, Olympic Ceremony, Posters and Pictograms, Olympic Timeline, Life in the Olympic Village, Olympism365 and Olympic Values.

One of the most attractive parts of the exhibition was the holobox which used new technologies to recreate the relay races with Olympic torches that had passed through Serbia several times. The Olympic flame, as a symbol of peace and friendship among all people and nations of the world, was the central feature of the exhibition and represented the very essence of the Olympic spirit.

Top visual artists and graphic designers from around the world contributed to the creation of mascots, posters, and pictograms for the Olympic Games, blending sport and art, tradition and modern culture - something the audience at Silosi experienced through the evolution of the Olympic brand identity.

Every Olympic Games opening ceremony has also been a kind of fashion show, which is why a special segment of the exhibition was dedicated to the ceremonial uniforms proudly worn by Serbian athletes throughout the 112-year-long history of Olympism in the country.

Serbian athletes made their Olympic debut in 1912, and the exhibition *Olympic Games—More than Sports!* also showcased numerous historical photographs,

video recordings, and objects through the Virtual Olympic Museum. Through a lexicon, designed as a cherished book of memories, visitors got to know the Serbian athletes who participated in the qualifications for the Paris Games – learning about their favourite music, how they prepare for competition, and what drives them in their daily battles to surpass their own records.

Visitors also discovered what life is like in the Olympic Village and what our Olympians carry in their bags. Everyone had the opportunity to leave a message for the athletes on a specially created Wall of Wishes, while those with an adventurous spirit could take a virtual bike ride through the host city of the XXXIII Summer Olympic Games or join one of the BeActive workshops.

The importance of the Olympic Movement was also conveyed through inspiring stories from past Games that promote Olympic values, as well as through the “Olympism365” strategy of the International Olympic Committee, which supported the exhibition via Olympic Solidarity – along with sponsor DDOR Insurance, which helped make possible sports-educational workshops such as Treasure Hunt and the Olympic Quiz held as part of the exhibition.

The exhibition was accompanied by a specially designed programme for all generations: guided tours, creative workshops during the Olympic Class and Chats with Champions eco-workshops organised by the Children’s Environmental Academy, panel discussions by the Women and Sport Commission of the Olympic Committee of Serbia on topics such as Olympic Champions Then and Now and What Comes After Olympic Gold?, the promotion of the book *The Circles of Berlin 1936* by author Tamara Malešev, and the commemoration of 40 years since the Olympic Games in Los Angeles.

A modified version of the exhibition was also presented in Paris under the name *Le chemin des vraies valeurs* from 25th July to 16th August 2024 in the Serbian Cultural Centre during the Olympic Games. The Paris edition included interactive educational workshops, quizzes, a treasure hunt, film screenings, and guided tours.

The exhibition attracted over 15,000 visitors from Serbia and abroad. For all those who did not have the opportunity to visit in person, a virtual tour was created and is accessible via the Virtual Olympic Museum website: www.olimpijskimuzej.rs.

MALTESE OLYMPIC ACADEMY – PUBLICATIONS 2024–2025

Olympic Education

Our national OE workshop marks its 3rd consecutive year and has become ever so popular with school students attending their Yr5 classes. It is a hands-on programme set to promote and assist learners to understand the importance of working together to achieve a common goal through a 3-hour programme that is run at the MOC HQ. During the two-fold programme, students learn to achieve excellence through Faster-Higher-Stronger games TOGETHER. They also learn about the modern Olympics & legacy through a scavenger hunt. They also meet a local Olympian/Paralympian who serves as an inspiration, helping them visualise their dream and set their targets for their developing years.

As part of the ongoing learning process, in November 2024, the Maltese Olympic Committee, represented by Olympic Academy members Edmund Mifsud and Maria Zammit, participated in the Olympic Values Education Programme which was held in Birstonas, Lithuania. This international event brought together 17 representatives from National Olympic Committees and Olympic Academies, all aiming to deepen their understanding of sports values, including friendship, excellence, respect, solidarity, inclusion and equality.

The OVEP is an invaluable tool which will help us enhance our efforts towards promoting Olympic values and implementing new strategies through various programmes hosted by the Maltese Olympic Academy.

Olympic Legacy

As part of its ongoing efforts to preserve and celebrate Malta's Olympic legacy, the Maltese Olympic Committee's Olympic Academy created the Olympian

Pathway – a sustainable initiative that will honour every Maltese Olympian with a tree planted in their name. This symbolic gesture not only commemorates their achievements but also contributes to a greener future. Following on the initial preparation and to further honour Malta's sporting heroes, a dedicated event celebrating the Olympians took place in March 2025 at the MOC/MOA HQ, with an encouraging number of former Olympians attending.

School Olympics Malta Garners Strength & Becomes MALTA SCHOOL GAMES (MSG)

The Maltese Olympic Academy, as part of the Maltese Olympic Committee, in partnership with its associated Federations and Associations, and alongside The Centre of Physical Education & Sport within the Ministry for Education, Sport, Youth, Research (MEYR), has enhanced its commitment with a long-term strategical implementation of the MALTA SCHOOL GAMES (MSG).

This initiative invites middle (U13) and secondary (U15) school students to engage in competitive inter-school competitions in various sport-disciplines (14 in total). School teachers worked alongside their students to qualify, with the first four in their specific sport discipline placing in the FINALS which took place between 19 and 23 May 2025.

This freshly applied strategy has proved to be highly successful and has spurred strong enthusiasm and passion in students to achieve excellence in their performances. There has been increased anticipation from students who relish the opportunity to engage in their favourite sport discipline at school level.

The MSG encompasses various disciplines such as football, volleyball, basketball, netball, table tennis, chess, cross-country, squash, athletics T&F, swimming, water polo, rugby, handball, futsal & beach soccer.

*Visit our website Maltese Olympic Committee's albums | Flickr
<https://www.flickr.com/photos/malteseolympiccommittee/albums/>*

Celebrating Sport and Olympic Values in Post-Secondary Education

On 24 of February 2025, the Maltese Olympic Academy (MOA) in collaboration

with the Ministry for Education, Sport, Youth, Research & Innovation (MEYR) and the Malta Schools Sport Federation (MSSF) held a full day of interschools competitions as part of the Malta School Games (MSG) programme. The event took place at St. Aloysius College and hosted more than 250 students from ALL national participating post-sec schools.

The Malta School Games day's programme – which kicked off at the beginning of the scholastic year – saw participants born in 2007 and 2008 take part in various disciplines, including athletics (track), badminton, basketball 3×3, football (men), football (women), handball, indoor rowing, table tennis and volleyball.

This programme was developed to foster a wider perspective on the Olympic values and to allow students to gain experiences which will prepare them for possible future international competitions/events.

The Malta School Games have played a vital role in promoting the core values of the Olympic Movement – excellence, respect, and friendship – while demonstrating the importance of fostering a healthy society and integrating these values into our daily lifestyles.

CROATIAN OLYMPIC ACADEMY – ANNUAL ACTIVITIES AIMED AT PROMOTING OLYMPIC VALUES – 2025

In 2024, the Croatian Olympic Academy organised the 13th edition of the art competition titled "School Sports and the Olympic Movement" which was focused on French art styles such as Fauvism and Surrealism. Inspired by the Paris 2024 Olympic Games and held in collaboration with the French Embassy in Zagreb, the competition attracted 661 artworks from 106 schools across Croatia. The best entries were exhibited in June at the French Institute in Zagreb.

The 2025 edition of the same competition is themed around Futurism, paying homage to Italy, the host of the 2026 Winter Olympic Games in Milano Cortina. Students are encouraged to create sports-themed artwork using elements of the Futurist style. The project is ongoing and will conclude in mid-2025.

The Academy also partnered with the Primorje-Gorski Kotar County Sports Association to organise an annual sports photography exhibition, promoting Olympic values and celebrating the relationship between sport and visual culture.

Throughout 2024, the Academy delivered Olympism workshops in schools, reaching over 2,400 students. These sessions, approved by the Ministry of Science and Education, engaged students with interactive content on Olympic history and values.

Recognising the importance of early education, the Academy launched a new initiative in kindergartens. Colourful posters featuring Olympic and sports-related motifs were distributed, helping children explore the spirit of Olympism through play and creativity.

In collaboration with Primorje-Gorski Kotar County, the Academy continued the project "Little School of Olympism". During 2024, four sessions were held, involving 1,085 children aged 4 to 12, with educators trained in the previous year to teach about active lifestyles and Olympic ideals.

Since 2022, Olympism workshops have also been conducted at the Zagreb

Sports Museum, where children interact with sports exhibits and simulators. In 2024 alone, 2,116 children participated in these educational programmes.

One of the Academy's major achievements in 2024 was the publication of the *Olympic Workbook*, a richly illustrated educational material tailored for primary school students. The workbook covers topics such as the ancient Olympic Games, Pierre de Coubertin's legacy, Olympic symbols and values, and the history of Croatian Olympic success.

The workbook was promoted at public events in several cities, including Zagreb (May 24), Velika Gorica (October 1), and Karlovac (October 24). In March 2025, it received special recognition from the Croatian Sports Journalists Association. The workbook was authored by Ana Popovčić and illustrated by Lara Žigić.

As part of its professional development initiatives, the Academy organised a workshop for physical education teachers during the Summer School of Kinesiologists held in Zadar on June 28 2024. Three cycles of lectures for sports professionals were also completed, with 300 participants from across Croatia attending.

The Croatian Olympic Academy celebrated International Olympic Day with various public events including workshops, lectures, sports contests, and art competitions. The Olympic Day Run, held on May 11 2024 in Zagreb, featured 527 participants, with Olympian Matea Parlov Koštro serving as event ambassador.

In addition, the Academy hosted a special celebration of Croatian Olympic Day at Platak on September 10 2024. It featured a variety of sports activities designed to engage children and families with Olympic values.

From July 7 to 14 2024, the Academy organised the Little Olympic Camp in Savudrija, attended by 25 children from eight schools in Zagreb. The camp combined sea and land sports with educational sessions about the Olympic Movement and the achievements of Croatian athletes.

Olympism-themed workshops were held as part of Zagreb's "Summer at Mažuranac" programme, as well as at the "Every Child One Sport" conference in Osijek on May 28 2024. During the European Week of Sport in September, workshops were conducted in Zagreb, Kutjevo, and Makarska, encouraging children's participation in sport and Olympic learning.

In collaboration with the National Sports Museum and the Archaeological Museum, the Academy co-organised the exhibition *Citius, Altius, Fortius – Communiter*, exploring the ancient and modern Olympic Games. The exhibition

ran from 26 June to 5 October 2024 and attracted around 5,000 visitors. Plans are underway for it to tour other Croatian cities.

Complementary to the exhibition, a series of lectures was delivered at the Archaeological Museum in Zagreb. This included a lecture on the ancient Olympics (June 15), a panel with Croatian Olympians (July 9), and a lecture on the intersection of the Olympic Games and politics (October 5).

The Academy further strengthened ties with the Croatian Sports Museum and the Croatian Institute of History through a formal partnership, facilitating joint projects, academic training, and events related to sports heritage.

As part of the Erasmus+ SURE project, the Academy, in cooperation with the Croatian Olympic Committee, will organise a series of workshops in 2025 at the SOS Children's Village in Lekenik, aimed at children without parental care.

The Academy also launched the "Olympism at Work" programme in collaboration with the Croatian Kinesiology Association. This initiative helps schools in underprivileged or disaster-affected areas procure essential physical education equipment.

Finally, the Academy maintained a strong media presence. A television interview with the Academy's Director, Assoc. Prof. Dr Saša Ceraj, was broadcast on national TV, offering insights into the Academy's mission and achievements during 2024.

NOC SOUTH AFRICA

Planned Activities for 2025

No.	Date	Activity	Event/Topic
1.	04/06/2025	Meeting with NOC South Africa President and CEO/ Secretary General	• To discuss the implementation of the NOA in South Africa. • To discuss the implementation of Olympic education activities by NOC while waiting for the NOA to be established
2.	10/06/2025	Meeting with Ms Liana Laubscher, Managing Director of Altus Sport NGO promoting Olympic Education in South Africa	• To discuss their planned activities on Olympic education
3.	20–23/06/2025	Olympic Day	Olympic Day Run in Irene, Centurion with 300 participants
4.	24/09/2025	Peace Day Event	Celebrating International Fair Play Day and Heritage Day
5.	02/10/2025	International Day of Non-Violence	
6.	10/10/2025	World Mental Health Day	
7.	11/10/2025	International Day of Non-Violence	

PALESTINIAN OLYMPIC COMMITTEE: KEY ACTIVITIES AND INITIATIVES

Dr Atta RIMAWI (PLE)
NOA of Palestine, Head

1. Promoting Sports at School Level

The Palestinian Olympic Committee has prioritised engaging youth through school-based initiatives to foster a culture of sports and healthy lifestyles:

- **Muay Thai Schools Tournament:** Organised to introduce Muay Thai as a martial art, promote discipline and fitness among students, and lay the foundation for future champions.
- **School Sports Programme:** A national initiative under the supervision of the Committee to integrate regular physical activity into schools and identify young talent early.

2. National Sporting Events

Our Committee has successfully hosted inclusive events that aim to involve the general public and people with disabilities:

- **Istiklal Park Marathon:** An open-to-all community event encouraging citizens of all ages to embrace running and a healthy lifestyle.
- **Bethlehem Wheelchair Tournament:** A landmark event that promotes sports inclusivity and empowers athletes with disabilities.

3. Capacity Building and Sports Education

The Palestinian Olympic Committee, through the Palestinian Olympic Academy, continues to develop human resources through specialised training and educational programmes:

- **Coaching Courses:**
 - **C-Level Football Coaching Course** (in cooperation with the Asian Football Confederation)
 - **Training Course for Female Coaches:** Focused on empowering women in sports leadership and coaching roles.
- **Refereeing Courses:** Training programmes aimed at raising the standards of officiating across various sports.

4. Legal, Administrative, and Strategic Development

We believe that sound governance and institutional frameworks are essential for sustainable sports development:

- **Legal Reference and Arbitration Course:** Aimed at unifying legal concepts and training stakeholders on sports arbitration mechanisms.
- **National Federations Educational Course:**
 - Topics included sports marketing and media, judiciary systems, protocol and etiquette, public relations, strategic governance, and the execution of strategic plans.

Conclusion

The Palestinian Olympic Committee remains committed to promoting sports at all levels—from grassroots programmes in schools to institutional development through education and governance. With a growing calendar of events and training programmes, we continue to foster a sports culture that is inclusive, strategic, and future-focused.

TUNISIAN NATIONAL OLYMPIC COMMITTEE (CNOT)

Recent Activities and Initiatives in Olympic Education

The Tunisian National Olympic Committee (CNOT) places Olympic education at the heart of its mission. Through structured and evolving programmes, CNOT promotes Olympic values across all levels of sport. Three flagship initiatives support this commitment: the Course on Sports Administration (CAS), the Advanced Course in Sports Management (CAMS), and MEMOS (Executive Master in Sport Organisations Management).

1. CAS – Course on Sports Administration

Organised annually in collaboration with universities or training institutions, the CAS aims to introduce young people – students, beginner coaches, and sport enthusiasts – to the fundamental principles of sports management and the Olympic Movement.

This short but intensive programme covers the basics of sports organisation, governance, and ethics. For many participants, CAS is their first meaningful exposure to the broader ecosystem behind sport – beyond the competition – and to their potential role as future sport leaders.

2. CAMS – Advanced Course in Sports Management

The CAMS programme is designed for sport administrators, federation members, and local sport managers. It provides deeper training in strategic planning, governance, sustainable development, and leadership in sport organisations.

Over the years, numerous Tunisian professionals have participated in CAMS. Many of them have since launched projects such as Olympic education workshops, public awareness campaigns, and Olympic Day celebrations, thereby applying their training directly within their communities.

3. MEMOS – Executive Master in Sport Organisations Management

MEMOS is a high-level international programme aimed at senior sport leaders seeking to develop and implement strategic projects for their organisations or countries. Tunisia has consistently taken part in MEMOS by nominating one participant per year.

In 2024, Tunisia had the honour of hosting a French-language MEMOS session in Hammamet, which brought together international experts for a week of collaboration, exchange, and collective learning. This event marked a major milestone for Tunisia’s visibility in the international sport community. Another session – in English – is already planned for 2026, reaffirming CNOT’s ongoing commitment to supporting the development of sport leadership worldwide.

Conclusion

Through these three key programmes – CAS, CAMS, and MEMOS – CNOT is implementing a comprehensive Olympic education strategy focused on

- inspiring youth,
- supporting field-level actors,
- shaping long-term sport policies.

These efforts reflect Tunisia’s strong and continuous commitment to sport that is ethical, inclusive, and deeply aligned with Olympic values.

EDUCATIONAL INITIATIVES OF THE PAKISTAN OLYMPIC ASSOCIATION

The Pakistan Olympic Association (POA), in its role as the custodian of the Olympic Movement in Pakistan, remains firmly committed to advancing Olympic values through a wide array of educational initiatives. In alignment with the Olympic Agenda 2020+5 and the objectives of the International Olympic Committee (IOC), the POA has actively developed and delivered programmes designed to foster athlete empowerment, institutional integrity, and community engagement.

A key focus of the POA's educational strategy is the holistic development of athletes, with a particular emphasis on their transition beyond active sports careers. The Association organised a comprehensive seminar titled Empowering Athletes, hosted at Lahore College for Women University, which brought together current and former athletes to engage with experts on topics such as mental health, doping awareness, safeguarding, and career development. This initiative underscored the POA's recognition of athletes as future leaders and influencers within the Olympic ecosystem.

Furthering this commitment, the POA conducted a targeted Educational Workshop for Top Athletes in Lahore, aimed at providing high-performance athletes with the knowledge and tools essential for ethical, physical, and psychological excellence. The programme featured sessions on sports psychology, injury prevention, nutrition, and protection against abuse and harassment—areas that are increasingly central to athlete well-being and integrity in sport.

Complementing athlete-focused programmes, the POA has also prioritised good governance across the national sports framework. In collaboration with the Sindh Olympic Association, a dedicated Seminar on Good Governance was held in Karachi, disseminating the IOC's Basic Universal Principles of Good Governance among sports administrators and organisational leaders. This initiative reflects

the POA's efforts to ensure transparency, accountability, and efficiency within national federations and regional bodies.

Recognising the importance of integrity in sport, the POA also convened a two-day Integrity Workshop: Fair Play and Beyond with the support of the IOC and the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA). This workshop served as a vital platform to educate Olympic-bound athletes on anti-doping regulations, the prevention of competition manipulation, and athlete safeguarding protocols. The programme reinforced the values of fair play, trust, and ethical responsibility – cornerstones of the Olympic Movement.

In addition to educational activities directed at athletes and administrators, the POA has aligned its community outreach with broader sustainability goals. On the occasion of Olympic Day, the POA launched a tree plantation campaign under the theme Plant – Preserve – Play, in collaboration with Government College University Lahore. This initiative highlighted the Association's commitment to environmental stewardship and the integration of sport into sustainable development efforts.

Through these diverse educational programmes, the Pakistan Olympic Association continues to cultivate a culture of excellence, integrity, and responsibility in sport. These initiatives not only reflect the guiding principles of Olympism but also serve as a foundation for the future leadership of sport in Pakistan and beyond.

NOC OF KAZAKHSTAN

Athlete365 Career+ Seminar (17–18 October 2024)

Career planning remains a pressing issue for athletes in Kazakhstan. Many athletes have requested guidance on how to transition into post-competitive careers. To address this need, a seminar was held in 2024 with invited experts from the International Olympic Committee (IOC).

During the seminar, athletes learned how to pursue education while remaining active in sports, explored various career continuation opportunities, and received practical tips on writing resumes and preparing for life after sport.

Notably, the speakers were former Olympians who had experienced similar transitions themselves – Simona Castro (artistic gymnastics, Chile) and Zsolt Csonka (shooting, Hungary). Fifty athletes from different types of sports participated in this seminar including Olympic champions and medallists. NOC Kazakhstan actively involved Athletes' Commission members in this seminar. Based on the positive feedback received, similar events are planned to be held annually.

In 2023, Aiya Aitbay – an archer and international-level judge – participated in the Athlete 365 Career+ seminar. Inspired by the event, she developed an interest in pursuing a master's degree in sports management. In 2025, with support from the National Olympic Committee of the Republic of Kazakhstan (NOC Kazakhstan), Aiya received an ANOC grant to study in the “Dream Together Master's” programme at Seoul National University (Republic of Korea). She will study there from 1 September 2025 to 31 August 2027. Her journey is a clear example of the effectiveness of the Athlete 365 Career+ seminars for Kazakhstani athletes.

Through Olympic Solidarity, approval has been granted to host the next

seminar in Almaty from 7–8 August 2025. This will be the third IOC-led seminar for athletes in Kazakhstan.

National Sport Administrators Course (14–16 November 2024)

It is important to highlight the significant collaboration between NOC Kazakhstan, National Federations, and other sports organisations. In line with IOC-supported practices, professional development courses for sports managers are organised regularly. These seminars serve as a platform for specialists to exchange knowledge and experiences across diverse areas – such as sports law, management, project planning, finance, event organisation, public relations, and sports marketing.

These courses are based on international standards and incorporate IOC educational resources like the Sport Administration Manual and the Advanced Sports Management Course, adapted to meet national needs. With the support of Olympic Solidarity, NOC Kazakhstan actively develops and delivers professional development opportunities for sports specialists. In partnership with national federations and other organisations, NOC Kazakhstan offers training programmes aimed at strengthening the human resource capacity of the sports sector.

In 2024, a three-day training course for sports managers was held in Astana at the Nazarbayev University School of Medicine. Organised under the Olympic Solidarity programme, it brought together over 60 specialists from various regions of Kazakhstan. Participants included representatives from sports federations, multi-sport organisations, coaches, national team managers, and professionals in legal affairs, international relations and PR.

The course aimed not only to enhance professional knowledge but also to create a collaborative space for sharing experiences and discussing emerging challenges and trends. The programme covered topics such as project management, sports law, anti-doping initiatives, financial management, gender equality, sports medicine, sustainable development (in cooperation with UNESCO Kazakhstan), Olympic Games operations, social media content creation, community engagement, and educational opportunities within the Olympic Movement.

Women's Empowerment and Career Transition Seminar (28–29 November 2024)

Gender equity remains a strategic priority for the IOC. The Paris 2024 Olympic Games made history by achieving full gender parity among athletes, with equal participation by men and women. This marked a major milestone in advancing fair and inclusive sport. However, the IOC's commitment to equality goes beyond the competition arena. As part of the Olympic Agenda 2020+5, the IOC encourages NOCs and international federations to increase female representation in leadership roles to 30%–50%. As of 2023, women made up 41.1% of IOC Commission Members and approximately 20% of Presidents of International Federations – and efforts are ongoing.

NOC Kazakhstan actively promotes gender equity both in sport and beyond. A key initiative in this area was the Women's Empowerment and Career Transition seminar, held on 28–29 November 2024 in Astana, supported by IOC Olympic Solidarity, the Olympic Council of Asia and Nazarbayev University. The seminar brought together 40 female athletes from various regions and disciplines.

Topics covered included career planning, financial literacy, psychological adaptation, anti-discrimination, and personal brand development for life after sport. The seminar served as an important platform for learning, professional growth, and sharing experiences.

Joint Project with UNESCO Kazakhstan on Quality Physical Education for PE Teachers (27 September–01 November 2024)

The project "Quality Physical Education in Kazakhstan" was successfully implemented and included motivational meetings with Olympic champions, medallists, and elite athletes to promote quality physical education across the country. The project was supported by the National Commission for Women and Family-Demographic Policy under the President of the Republic of Kazakhstan, and the National Commission of Kazakhstan for UNESCO and ISESCO, in partnership with NOC Kazakhstan and the Ministry of Education of Kazakhstan.

Events took place from 27 September to 1 November 2024 in six cities: Uralsk, Kostanay, Astana, Turkestan, Aktobe, and Almaty.

NOC Kazakhstan fully supports this initiative. We recognise that physical

education teachers play a vital role in shaping future athletes and champions. They not only provide physical training but also instil healthy lifestyle habits and a love for sport.

NOC Kazakhstan involved representatives from national sports federations and well-known Olympians to share their knowledge and experiences with young people and PE teachers. As part of this project, seminars were conducted for more than 600 physical education teachers and more than 300 students from state schools across six regions of Kazakhstan. NOC Kazakhstan will continue this project in collaboration with UNESCO Almaty Regional Office in other regions of the country.

ARMENIAN NATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY INITIATIVES AND ACTIVITIES

The Armenian NOA was established in 1990 on the instructions of the NOC, which was also founded in the same year. The organisational structure of the NOA is best described as a sub-division of the NOC and it is also affiliated with the Armenian State Institute of Physical Culture and Sport (ASIPCS), which carries out all NOA activities.

The activities of the Armenian NOA include regional and national propagation of the Olympic idea – which is promoted via media platforms and seminars at educational institutions – and scientific engagement with the Olympic Movement. Moreover, the Armenian NOA is active at various events, for instance the Pan-Armenian Games which celebrates the participation of Armenia in the ancient Greek Olympic Games.

The most ambitious project at the moment is the introduction of a special school subject called Physical Culture to the national curriculum. The subject will be taught to students from the 2nd to the 12th grades and topics will include the origins of the Olympics and sport and fair play. In the NOA, we have an interesting and informative Museum which includes all Armenian Olympic history and, thanks to this museum, schoolchildren attending the Armenian NOA are introduced to Olympic ideas, told about the history of the Armenian Olympic Movement and Armenians' achievements in the Olympic Games in a very vivid way.

This year, a book named *Olympic Symbols* was written and co-authored by the Young Participant in the 62nd IOA Session, the current coordinator.

In the Armenian State Institute of Physical Culture and Sport the students are taught the discipline Olympic Movement. In the frame of this subject, themes such as The Role And Significance of the Olympic Movement, Features of the Formation of a Positive Attitude Towards Sports, Armenia and the Olympic Movement, the Creation of The Armenian Olympic Committee, Peculiarities of

Cooperation Between the IOC and NOA in the Field of Olympic Sports Science, and Analysis of Current Issues of the Olympic Movement are discussed.

NOA Delegates, educators and Young Participants take part in the annual Sessions of the International Olympic Academy (IOA). As a result, they carry out their activities for the dissemination of Olympic ideas in Armenia and are even sometimes published in the IOA Journal. They have informational meetings, talking about their activities in Olympia, and organise interesting games and quizzes both in Yerevan and in the regions.

The 2022 National Olympic Delegates presented their participation to students, Young Ambassadors, and educators at the dissemination meeting.

Then, the Young Ambassadors made their presentations at dissemination meetings with students and schoolchildren in Yerevan and in the regions.

THE AUSTRALIAN OLYMPIC COMMITTEE'S COMMUNITY AND SCHOOL PROGRAMMES

Our Purpose: Sharing the Olympic Spirit with all Australians – promoting the values of friendship, sportsmanship and striving for excellence.

1. **Olympics Unleashed** brings the power of the Olympic spirit straight to Australian schools, inspiring students to be their own personal best! Olympians and aspiring Olympians share their personal journeys, giving students a front-row seat to the incredible impact of goal-setting, resilience, and pursuing your passion – whether in the classroom, on the field, or at home.

During each Unleashed visit, athletes connect with both primary and high school students through motivational keynote speeches followed by interactive Q&A sessions. Every student leaves with a signed goal-setting card to inspire their own journey. The best part? This empowering programme is completely free for schools, and presentations can be tailored for individual classes or large year groups. Let's unleash the potential in every student!

The programme has reached almost 500,000 visits since 2018, and over 360 athletes have taken part in the programme.

2. The **Australian Olympic Change-Maker** programme celebrates secondary students who embody the true Olympic spirit – friendship, sportsmanship, and a relentless pursuit of excellence – both on and off the field. These young leaders are driving positive change in their schools and communities, shaping the future through their actions and ideas.

This programme isn't just about recognition – it's an opportunity to connect, inspire, and be inspired. Selected students will engage with like-minded changemakers, gain exclusive access to Olympian-led experiences, and take part in the National Change-Maker Forum and Summit.

Teachers can nominate up to two standout students from Years 10, 11,

or 12 who are making a real impact. Participants receive a Certificate of Recognition and the chance to share their voice on a national stage.

The Australian Olympic Change-Maker is more than an award – it's a movement.

3. The **Australian Olympic Indigenous Coaching Scholarship (AOICS)** programme aims to provide high-level professional development, education, and formal training to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Olympic sport coaches. Upon completion, graduates can deliver ongoing coach development courses and sports clinics, and pass on their knowledge in Indigenous communities across Australia.

Scholarship coaches develop their skills and techniques through various training and practical experiences. Graduates are then paid to deliver coaching services for the AOC and their National Federations, as part of the AOC's Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander procurement strategy and Reconciliation Action Plan.

Scholarship coaches complete two phases as part of the AOICS programme.

During phase one (Student Coach phase), scholarship holders learn from sports industry experts and benefit from the Australian Olympic Committee's partnerships, including the following:

- Olympic sport National Federations
- universities
- the Centre of Healing and Justice Through Sport
- the Royal Australian Air Force.

These partners support the delivery and teaching of the units and practical experiences offered in this scholarship.

In phase two (Graduate Coach phase), AOICS coach graduates, in collaboration with their respective National Federation (NF), deliver coach education to aspiring Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander coaches based in the community. Additionally, the graduate coaches conduct sports clinics and events. These clinics and events provide AOICS graduates an opportunity to practically apply their new skills acquired during the scholarship, and be paid to deliver services on behalf of the AOC and their NF.

4. **Australian Olympic Pathway School** status is available to schools that have an established elite athlete development sport programme including five Olympic sports. To be recognised as an Australian Olympic Pathway

School, a school must meet strict criteria at the discretion of the Australian Olympic Committee (AOC).

In naming these Australian Olympic Pathway Schools, the AOC is recognising the extraordinary opportunities available for students to pursue their athletic journey. Students at these schools are given access to high-quality sport training environments, sports academies, accredited coaches, support services (wellbeing, nutrition, etc) and crucially, formal pathways through to high performance teams with sports bodies.

Schools can apply to be recognised as an Olympic Pathway School via our website.

5. The **TeamAUS Olympic Schools Hub** offers teachers a diverse range of engaging, curriculum-aligned resources designed to delve into the fundamental Olympic values, igniting excitement for the Olympic Movement within the classroom.

These resources are a step-by-step guide in exploring the core Olympic values. They include all lesson materials and links in an easy-to-navigate format. Teachers can use them on interactive whiteboards or class devices to develop students' higher-order thinking skills and provide a stronger learning experience than ever before! Get ready to unleash the Olympic spirit and bring the Games to life in your classroom!

6. **#HaveAGo** invites all Aussies to play Olympic sports.

With the Olympic and Paralympic Games returning to Australia for Brisbane 2032, it's the perfect time to #HaveAGo at Olympic sports to ignite an Olympic dream. Now's the best time to get kids excited about Olympic sports, and to Have A Go. Whether playing for fun, or as an aspiring Olympian, great things happen when you Have A Go!

7. **Australian Olympic Connect** brings the excitement of the Olympic Games to life by connecting Australian schools with classrooms in Olympic host cities! This programme builds international friendships and celebrates the unifying power of sport, sparking anticipation as the Games approach.

Once registered, Aussie schools will be paired with schools in the host nation for an unforgettable exchange—through video calls, letters, videos, and engaging class activities. This global collaboration ignites the Olympic spirit, creating lasting memories as students from different cultures come together to share in the excitement.

ZIMBABWE OLYMPIC COMMITTEE – OLYMPISM IN ACTION INITIATIVES

*Compiled by Newman Gomendo (ZIM)
NOC of Zimbabwe, Programmes Officer*

The Zimbabwe Olympic Committee has the following initiatives to promote Olympism and its values in Zimbabwe, while also contributing to the country's social, economic and sporting development.

1. Summer Sport Festival

All roads led to Mucheke Stadium in Masvingo for the 2024 Summer Sport Festival on 8 November, which started bright and early at 9 am. The Safe Sport Summer Festival is an annual event that was initiated by the NIF (Norwegian Olympic and Paralympic Committee and Confederation of Sport) partners during the Safe Sport Training Workshop in Zambia in 2017. Since its inception, the festival has been promoting safe and inclusive sports across Zimbabwe, with previous editions held in Harare, Bulawayo, and Kwekwe. The sports codes featured included netball, boys' football, girls' football, tennis, and volleyball. The "Train the Trainers" workshop on November 7 aligned with the principles of OVEP (Olympic Values Education Programme) and equipped local coaches and administrators with the skills and knowledge to promote safe and inclusive sports in their communities, ensuring the festival's impact continues long after the event.

2. World Play True Day 2024

The NOC was proud to join the rest of the world on 19 April 2024 in celebrating the World Play True Day. This year marked 25 years of the global initiative

that promotes clean and ethical sport. The campaign aimed to promote clean sport and raise awareness about the importance of doping prevention. WADA encouraged participants to share the Play True message on NOC social media channels using hashtags #Play True, #PlayTrueDay, and #OnePlayTrueTeam

3. Chitungwiza Junior Football League Safe Inclusive Sport and Olympism Campaign

The NOC in partnership with the Chitungwiza Junior Football League conducted a Safe Inclusive Sport and Olympism campaign for the under-15 Chitungwiza Junior Football League. Over 1,000 young players, coaches and fans engaged with the efforts to empower the athletes and lay the foundation for a bright future for Zimbabwean football. The campaign also was helpful in encouraging athletes and their entourages about the principles of Olympism, including excellence, friendship and respect.

4. Taekwondo Tournament Anti-doping Education and Awareness

The Zimbabwe Olympic Committee Athletes Commission conducted an anti-doping education and awareness campaign at the Korean Ambassadors Taekwondo Tournament held in Belvedere. The tournament featured participants from Malawi, Mozambique and Zimbabwe. The sessions covered topics such as the WADA prohibited list, the athlete's biological passport and the consequences of doping. Participants also learned about resources to support informed decisions on health and well-being.

5. Olympic Day Celebrations

The Zimbabwe Olympic Committee hosted lively and engaging Olympic Day celebrations on June 22, bringing the Olympic spirit to the hearts of Zimbabweans. The event was held at Gokwe Center, and was a resounding success as the nation came together to play, run, dance and share the joy of the Olympic Movement. From young athletes showcasing their sport prowess to the community joining in the festivities, the day was marked by a palpable sense of unity and enthusiasm.

6. 16 Days of Activism Against Gender-based Violence

The NOC ran a media campaign on its social media as part of the fight against gender-based violence. From November 25 to December 10, the campaign shared stories, statistics, and solutions to end GBV. Top athletes in the country like Makanaka Charamba and Tapiwanashe Makarawu (Paris 2024 Olympian) participated in this noble cause.

7. Handball IHF Zone 6 Under 18 and 20 Regional Games Anti-doping Education and Awareness

The NOC, supported by the Norwegian Olympic and Paralympic Committee & Confederation of Sports (NIF), provided anti-doping education and awareness to 272 athletes from eight countries at the IHF Zone 6 Under 18 and 20 trophy in Chitungwiza. Participating countries were Lesotho, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia, Zimbabwe, Malawi, Namibia, and Swaziland. Through workshops, the NOC delivered critical information on anti-doping regulations and the importance of integrity in sport.

8. World Cleanup Day

It is worth noting that the Zimbabwe Olympic Committee plays an important role in promoting Olympic values and developing sports in the country. The NOC took part in the World Cleanup Day as part of efforts to promote social responsibility and community engagement. The event was held at Africa Unity Square in Harare with the Environmental Management Agency taking the lead in the process.

9. WADA President Visit to the Country

WADA President, Mr Witold Banka, visited Zimbabwe where he held productive meetings with key stakeholders including Dr Kirsty Coventry, Minister of Sport, Arts and Recreation, and Dr Emmerson Mnangagwa, Head of State for Zimbabwe. The visit focused on strengthening anti-doping efforts in Zimbabwe and promoting

clean sport. During his visit, the WADA President emphasised the importance of robust anti-doping regulations and offered WADA's assistance in fine tuning Zimbabwe's Sport Integrity Bill which aims to address doping, match fixing and good governance in sport. Mr Banka also met with representatives of the Zimbabwe Olympic Committee, the National Anti-Doping Coordinating Committee and athletes to discuss ways to promote clean sport and to protect the integrity of sports in Zimbabwe.

10. Safe Sport Advocacy

Advocacy on safe inclusive sport conducted by the NOC on national radio. Topics discussed included harassment, match manipulation and fixing, corruption and safeguarding. Safeguarding Officers will be conducting the sessions

11. Sport and the Environment Initiative

The NOC participated in the tree planting activity at Chishawasha Primary School. The Athletes' Commission and the Zimbabwe Olympians' Association took the lead. One hundred and fifty trees were planted.

12. OVEP Mentorship Programme

Programme hosted at Belvedere Primary School for 30 students. The programme played a crucial role in promoting fair and safe sport by instilling core Olympic values such as teamwork, respect, and excellence. Past IOA Young Ambassadors took a leading role in this programme.

13. Training of Trainers (ToT) Induction on Safe and Inclusive Sport

Programme hosted at Tongogara Refugee Camp. Forty-five participants were trained with knowledge and skills to promote safe, inclusive, and drug-free sports environments. The training focused on safeguarding principles, gender inclusivity, and the role of sport in fostering community cohesion. Trained facilitators played

a key role in community mobilisation during the subsequent Anti-Drug and Substance Abuse Campaign.

14. Anti-Drug and Substance Abuse Campaign

Programme hosted at Tongogara Refugee Camp. It was held during the World Refugee Month commemoration and successfully raised awareness of the dangers of drug and substance abuse through the power of sport. The event effectively used sport as a tool for education and advocacy, fostering community discussions on drug prevention and positive lifestyle choices.

PRESENTATION OF THE ACTIVITIES OF THE NATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY OF FRANCE (ANOF)¹

Prof. Nicolas Chanavat (FRA)

*ANOF Vice-President, Co-founder and Manager
of the Centre of Olympic Studies of France*

Célia Rousselle (FRA)

ANOF Administrator in charge of territories

Preamble

Founded in 1994, the National Olympic Academy of France (ANOF) is an institution dedicated to the promotion of Olympic and Paralympic values in France. In application of the Olympic Charter, and being a partner of the Olympic and Sports National Committee of France (CNOSF), the principal objective of ANOF is to promote Olympic and Paralympic values through research, culture and education in France and internationally. ANOF represents the International Olympic Academy in French territory.

1. Introduction

The year 2024, the year of the Olympic and Paralympic Games in Paris (Paris 2024), proved to be very rich in terms of activities for ANOF. With 30 years of commitment to promoting Olympic and Paralympic values, ANOF intensified

1. This document is notably based on a summary of the ANOF 2024 activity report.

its activities throughout France and internationally. As a result, there has been a proliferation of educational, cultural, scientific, and institutional initiatives led by the Academy.

2. Major Activities

At the heart of ANOF's activities lies the Centre of Olympic Studies of France (CEOF). As a key scientific stakeholder for the Games of Paris 2024, CEOF has strengthened its mission to support research into the Olympic and Paralympic Movements. Through multiple initiatives such as its research grant programme, the organisation of scientific and public events, or its academic publications, CEOF has strengthened synergies between the Olympics and the academic world.

In parallel, the Educational and Cultural Section (PEC) has deployed original educational tools such as the *Archéo Sport* game, the Olympic and Paralympic quiz, and two flagship exhibitions promoting Olympic and Paralympic values widely among young people and the general public. The publication of the series of short stories entitled *Dépassons les limites* (Beyond Limits) also reflects the creative and inclusive approach adopted by ANOF in raising awareness.

3. Heritage and Memory

The MéMos programme was a key focus in 2024, particularly through the *Grande Collecte des Archives du Sport* (Great Collection of Sports Archives). This initiative, supported by ministerial authorities, aims to preserve the memory of French sport by involving federations, communities, and witnesses of the sports movement. It is part of an ambitious and sustainable heritage approach.

4. Local Anchorage and International Influence

ANOF has set up a network of regional representatives responsible for identifying and promoting local initiatives that support Olympism. This local approach helps initiatives spread more easily and strengthens their anchorage in local communities.

Internationally, ANOF has consolidated key partnerships with the Olympic Academy of Portugal, the European Olympic Academies (EOA), AFAO, and

IOAPA. These collaborations have enabled the pooling of projects and the sharing of expertise at European and French-speaking levels, with the prospect of Erasmus+ initiatives.

5. Communication

In 2024, ANOF benefited from increased media coverage. Thanks to an effective digital strategy, the Academy's social media accounts saw a significant increase in audience size and engagement. ANOF officials were also reached by print and broadcast media to share their expertise and promote the Academy's projects, particularly those related to the Paris 2024 Games.

6. Conclusion and Perspectives

For 2025, ANOF plans to continue consolidating its regional network, strengthening its Olympic education initiatives, and deepening its international collaborations, capitalising on the legacy of the Paris 2024 Games. The development of research, youth involvement, and the promotion of sporting heritage will remain at the heart of its priorities.

CABO VERDE OLYMPIC ACADEMY

Presented by Mitza Sousa (CPV)

This report presents the main actions approved by the Activities and Budget Plan (APAO) and by the AOCV, and carried out throughout 2024/2025. These initiatives aim to promote Olympic values, strengthen connections with communities and contribute to the development of Olympism in Cabo Verde.

Members of the Cabo Verde Olympic Academy

Orlando Mascarenhas, President; Maria Eduarda Vasconcelos, Vice-President; Mitza Sousa, Director; Glenda Araújo, Director; Fernando Pinto, Director; Sabino Tavares Correia, Director; Carlos Tavares, Director

Annual Activity Report

Olympic Education in Schools

- o Open doors of the Olympic Committee
- o Lectures
- o Comic book The Adventures of Alex and Lia – A journey through Olympism
- o Olympic Carnival
- o Street sports
- o Kriolimpismo

- African Session of the Olympic Academy
- Olympic Day
- IOA Session for Young People
- IOA Directors Session
- Worldwide Cleanup Day
- 6th Olympic Academy Forum
- Annual Session of the Portuguese Olympic Academy
- Club 365 - Olympic Values Programme

Olympic Education in Schools

This activity aims to raise awareness among school authorities about the introduction of the Olympic Movement in schools to reach students at all levels of education and to promote Olympism: games, training and sports practice in schools, based on Olympic values.

African Session of the Olympic Academy

The 9th Annual Session of the African National Academies for Directors, held in Algeria, under the theme “environmental protection and the fight against global warming”, was attended by the President of the Olympic Committee, Filomena Fortes, and President of the Olympic Academy, Orlando Mascarenhas.

Olympic Day Under the Three Pillars of Olympic Day

Discover, Learn and Exercise: this year, the theme chosen for the celebration was "Amilcar Cabral and Olympism", and its symbolic connection with the Olympic ideals of exploration, discovery and unity.

IOA Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors

This year, for participation in the IOA annual Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors in Greece, Cabo Verde was represented by Youth Ambassador Olivia Boyarm. Athlete and sports activist, she applied with a project that aims to bring volleyball to the communities which are most susceptible to social risks such as drug abuse and juvenile delinquency.

IOA Session for NOAs' and NOCs' Delegates

In the 17th annual IOA Session for NOAs' and NOCs' Delegates in Greece, Cabo Verde was represented by Director Fernando Pinto.

Worldwide Cleanup Day

The activity had more than 50 participants, 30% of whom were female and the rest were children and teenagers. Approximately 50 bags of garbage were collected. During the activity, educational and recreational activities were also introduced (building a paddle surf), a way of raising awareness among children about the reuse of waste in the environment.

6th Olympic Academy Forum

This year, the Academy Forum was celebrated through a debate panel with the aim of discussing and raising awareness about the challenge of youth in gender equality and what impact it will have on the community. It also saw the participation of the Presidents of the PALOP Olympic Academy, namely Portugal, Angola and São Tomé and Príncipe.

Annual Session of the Portuguese Olympic Academy

At the 35th annual Session of the Portuguese Olympic Academy, Cabo Verde was represented by the President of the Cape Verde Olympic Academy, Orlando Mascarenhas, and the President of the Football School (EFAT), Edmilson Garcia, with the theme "The Role of the Olympic Movement in International Relations".

Olympism365 Olympic Values Programme

The Olympism365 initiative represents an ambitious certification process aimed at clubs and organisations associated with sport and Olympism. Its aim is to partner with organisations to reinforce the role of sport as a vital enabler of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (ODS da ONU).

NOA AND NOC OF TANZANIA

2024 was an Olympic year

The NOA and NOC of Tanzania's initiatives, activities and work included increasing public awareness of the significance of the Olympics and the Olympic Games.

Early in the year, a special 5 km and 10 km Fun Run were organised. The 5 km and 10 km Fun Run began at the French School in Masaki Oysterbay and ended at the French Cultural Centre-Alliance Française in Upanga.

The event attracted more than 300 people. The event was dubbed "*TWENDE ZETU PARIS*", literally meaning "Let us go to Paris".

Other similar events were held in Mbeya region, Singida region and Coast region, Pwani. In these regions, both cultural and sports activities were held. The importance of the Olympics and Olympic Games were the main agenda of the events.

In May 2024, the NOA organised a five-day Sports Administration course in Morogoro under Olympic Solidarity. The course attracted 30 participants, of whom 15 were men and the rest were women, making a good gender equality division. The course was conducted by two National Course Directors, namely Ms Irene Mwasanga and Muharam Mchume.

In June, the NOC and NOA organised the Olympic Day Run in Morogoro region. More than 500 participants took part in the event. Participants in the Sports Administration course were some of the volunteers making the event well organised and successful. The Regional Commissioner, Adam Malima, a basketball veteran, graced the occasion.

Apart from participating in the Paris Olympic Games in July/August, the NOA and the NOC also had an opportunity to organise another Sports Administration course in Zanzibar under Olympic Solidarity. The course was mainly for the

Chairmen and Secretaries of Olympic Sports Organisations in Zanzibar. It was also attended by 30 participants.

The last event held was the Karatu Sports Festival where more than 600 people participated in various disciplines including football, volleyball, cycling, athletics and cultural activities such as traditional dancing and choirs.

COLOMBIA – NATIONAL OLYMPIC ACADEMY ACTIVITIES REPORT 2024–2025

Carlos E. VILLEGAS (COL)

Full Member of the Colombian Olympic Academy

Introduction

During the 2024–2025 period, the Colombian Olympic Academy (COA) continued its mission of promoting Olympic values across multiple social and educational spheres. Drawing inspiration from the principles of Olympism and aligned with the International Olympic Committee’s strategic framework, the COA implemented a wide range of academic, cultural, and community-based initiatives that brought the Olympic spirit closer to youth, educators, athletes, and all the stakeholders of the Olympic Movement.

A new chapter began with the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding between the International Olympic Academy (IOA) and the Colombian Olympic Academy during the International Congress Olympism, Development, and Peace, held in Bogotá in April of 2024. This agreement aims to strengthen collaboration between both institutions to promote Olympic education and the values of Olympism in Colombia. These activities reaffirmed the COA’s commitment to building a culture of peace, respect, and solidarity through sport and education. With a growing national network and strong international allies, the Academy solidified its leadership as an agent of Olympic education in Latin America, ensuring that the legacy of Baron Pierre de Coubertin remains relevant and transformative in today’s world.

Chairs of Olympic Studies

One of the Colombian Olympic Academy's most impactful accomplishments has been the expansion and consolidation of the Chairs of Olympic Studies across a wide network of superior academic institutions. These chairs serve as dynamic platforms for embedding Olympic values into university programmes, encouraging civic engagement, and fostering interdisciplinary research inspired by Olympism.

As of 2024, active chairs are present at the Universidad de Ciencias Aplicadas y Ambientales (UDCA), Universidad de la Guajira, Universidad Manuel Beltrán (Bogotá), Fundación Universitaria del Área Andina (campuses in Bogotá, Pereira, and Valledupar), Universidad de Pamplona, Universidad Católica Luis Amigó (Medellín), Corporación Universitaria del Caribe (CECAR), Escuela Nacional del Deporte (Cali), Universidad de Antioquia, Universidad de Cundinamarca, Universidad de San Buenaventura (Cartagena y Cali), Universidad Libre (Bogotá), Universidad del Tolima, Universidad Distrital Francisco José de Caldas, and the Escuela Militar de Cadetes General José María Córdova.

Additionally, Olympic education initiatives have reached the secondary level through institutions such as the Agustín Fernández School (Bogotá) and Instituto Nacional de Educación Media Diversificada INEM Manuel Murillo Toro (Ibagué). Together, these Chairs of Olympic Studies have become a cornerstone of Colombia's Olympic education movement, generating knowledge, leadership, and commitment among students and faculty nationwide.

University Research Centres in Olympic Studies (CEIOs)

The COA, in close collaboration with the academic direction of the NOC, expanded their network of University Research Centres in Olympic Studies (CEIOs) which play a central role in academic development and knowledge exchange. These centres have contributed significantly to the international dialogue on Olympic education. The most active CEIOs are based at UDCA, Fundación Universitaria del Área Andina, Universidad de Pamplona, Corporación Universitaria del Caribe (CECAR), Escuela Nacional del Deporte, Universidad de Antioquia, Medellín, Universidad de Cundinamarca, Universidad Libre, Bogotá, Universidad del Tolima, and Universidad de San Buenaventura in Medellín and Cali.

In July 2024, Colombian University Centres for Olympic Studies and Research

(CEIOs) participated in two landmark academic events held in Besançon, France, marking a significant milestone for Colombia's Olympic education movement. From July 19 to 21, they took part in the 16th International Symposium of the International Centre for Olympic Studies (ICOS). This was followed by the 4th International Colloquium of CEIOs from July 22 to 24.

Olympic Gatherings or *Tertulias*

A signature component of the Colombian Olympic Academy's outreach is its internationally recognised series of public events known as Olympic Gatherings or *Tertulias Olímpicas*. These gatherings function as informal yet intellectually engaging spaces where scholars, students, artists, athletes, and professionals convene to reflect on contemporary issues related to Olympism, sport, and society. Emphasising a relaxed, conversational style rather than formal lectures, the *tertulias* promote open dialogue and critical thinking on the challenges and opportunities facing the Olympic Movement in today's world.

Held almost every month, these sessions addressed a wide range of topics including inclusion, ethics, peacebuilding through sport, and the impact of artificial intelligence and digital media on Olympic education. By bringing together voices from multiple disciplines and generations, the *tertulias* fostered a vibrant culture of interdisciplinary and intergenerational exchange. These conversations enriched the Academy's intellectual life and helped position Olympism as a living, participatory philosophy – one that is deeply relevant to the Colombian context and essential to cultivating a more inclusive, ethical, and culturally rooted Olympic identity.

Olympism for All Programme

The Olympism for All programme was a cornerstone of the Colombian Olympic Academy's outreach during the period. Designed by the COA and currently developed in collaboration with the Ministry of Sport, this initiative focused on bringing Olympic values to schools and communities across the country. Its methodology emphasised playful, pedagogical, and experiential learning, aiming to connect children and young people with Olympic principles and values through accessible and culturally relevant formats.

The programme has been implemented through three educational modules:

Olympism for Children, Olympism for Youth, and Olympism for the Family. Each module was adapted to its audience, combining storytelling, sports-based activities, and value-based discussions. This structure allowed the Academy to reach students, educators, and caregivers alike, ensuring that the Olympic message extended beyond the classroom into homes and everyday life. Olympism for All reinforces the notion that Olympism is not just for athletes but for all members of society.

Olympism in Action Programme

Olympism in Action represented a broader cultural and civic engagement strategy designed to connect Olympic values with Colombian society at large. At the heart of this initiative is a broadcast through the NOC's social media platforms that explores the meaning and application of Olympism in everyday life. Through interviews, thematic episodes, and community storytelling, the programme has become a powerful tool for democratising Olympic education and making it accessible to a wide and diverse audience across the country.

Publications and Academic Community

The Academy continued to develop and promote its official publication, *La Revista Olímpica*, which serves as a vital platform for academic articles, essays, interviews, and reflections centred on Olympic values, education, and history. The magazine has solidified its position as a reference point for scholars, educators, and students in Colombia and across the broader Latin American region. In parallel, members of the Academy contributed to the advancement of Olympic knowledge by producing original research papers and participating actively in academic conferences, both nationally and internationally.

A highlight of the Academy's international engagement has been its continued presence at the official sessions of the International Olympic Academy (IOA) in Olympia, Greece. Colombian Delegates participated in the annual sessions for Directors of National Olympic Academies in both 2023 and 2024, and the country was proudly represented at the International Session for Young Olympic Ambassadors. In 2023, Luis Hernando Hernández took part as a Delegate from the UDCA Olympic Studies Chair, followed in 2024 by Luisa María Valencia, designer of the emblem for the Winter Youth Olympic Games.

CZECH OLYMPIC ACADEMY

In recent years, the Czech Olympic Academy (COA) has established itself as a prominent actor in the promotion of Olympic history and culture. In addition to its educational and research activities, it has been actively engaged in curatorial and publishing projects targeting both expert audiences and the wider public. COA has long cooperated with major institutions, including the National Museum, the Military History Institute, and Czech Public Television Service.

Exhibitions: Olympism in Public Space

Since 2022, COA has organised or co-organised a number of exhibitions that present Olympic heritage from various perspectives. The most notable projects include:

- *Věra Čáslavská* – life and legacy of the famous gymnast (National Museum, 2022);
- *100 + 100: Dana and Emil Zátopek* – a joint project with Prague Zoo (2022);
- *Karel Novák: Painter of Sport* – exhibited in Prague and Jindřichův Hradec (2023–2024);
- *Paris 1924: A Hundred Years Later in the City on the Seine* – Ostrava, spring 2024
- *Olympic Stories* – upcoming exhibition in collaboration with the National Museum (2024–2025);
- *Unbroken: Olympians* – Jindřichův Hradec (2024);
- Photography exhibitions within the Sportfilm Liberec festival (2022–2024).

Retrospective Monographs: Mapping Olympic History

Since 2022, COA has been developing the *Retrospective Monographs 1896–1936*

project, which revisits the early Olympic Games. The aim is to reconstruct Czech and Czechoslovak Olympic participation using primary sources – from archival materials to memoirs and photographs.

Volumes published so far:

- *Los Angeles 1932: The Story of the Czechoslovak Olympic Team* (Zdeněk Škoda, 2022);
- *Antwerp 1920: First Time under the Czechoslovak Flag* (Zdeněk Škoda et al., 2023);
- *Athens 1896: The Rebirth of the Olympic Games* (Zdeněk Škoda et al., 2024);
- *Paris 1924: Coubertin's Farewell and Czechoslovakia's First Gold* (Z. Škoda, L. Swierczeková, F. Kolář, 2024);
- *London 1908: How the British Saved the Olympic Games* (Martin Kovář and Zdeněk Škoda, 2024).

For this editorial achievement, COA received the *EOA FLAME AWARD* in 2024 in the Olympic Heritage category.

Other Publishing Projects

In addition to the monographs, COA publishes titles devoted to notable figures and broader themes in sports culture:

- *Zdeněk Němeček: Sculptor of Motion* (ed. Petr Volf, 2024);
- *Pierre de Coubertin: The Revival of the Olympic Games* (J. Dovalil, F. Kolář, Z. Škoda, 2024);
- *BodyEducation* (TěloVýchova, Antonín Kratochvíl, 2024).

Olympism in the Media and Education

A major initiative is the digital platform *Olympism, Sport and Media*, created in cooperation with Czech Radio and Czech Television. The website olympijskytym.cz/sportamedia documents 100 years of sport in Czech media and serves as a teaching tool at universities.

A complementary project is the podcast series *Přes Příkop* ("Across the Pit"), which explores historical and philosophical aspects of Olympism. COA is also an active partner in academic conferences, such as those organised in cooperation with high schools and universities (2022–2024).

GUATEMALAN OLYMPIC ACADEMY (NOA GUATEMALA) REPORT

Overview

The Guatemalan Olympic Academy (NOA Guatemala), under the guidance of the Guatemalan Olympic Committee, continues to promote Olympic values through diverse educational, cultural, and community-based initiatives. Between 2024 and 2025, the Academy focused on expanding its outreach, strengthening partnerships, and fostering Olympic education among youth and professionals across the country.

1. National Olympic Education Programmes

- **Olympic Values School Programme (Programa Escolar de Valores Olímpicos)** Implemented in collaboration with the Ministry of Education, this ongoing programme reached over 12,000 students in 2024 across public and private institutions, focusing on respect, excellence, and friendship.
- **Train-the-Trainer Workshops**

Educators and sports leaders received Olympic education training in three regions of the country. These workshops provided methodological tools to incorporate Olympism in their local programmes.

2. Academic and Youth Engagement

- **XXXII Olympic Youth Session (November 2024)**
Held at Oceana Resort, this national session brought together 60 youth

athletes and leaders aged 18–28 for three days of interactive learning, debates, and cultural exchange, under the theme "Building Olympic Leadership for Tomorrow."

- **University Forums**

Organised in partnership with two leading universities, these events explored Olympic themes, such as gender equity, sustainability, and sport ethics, engaging over 400 university students.

3. International participation

- Guatemala actively participated in the following IOA Sessions:
 - **2024 & 2025 Young Olympic Ambassadors Sessions**
 - **15th IOA Session for Educators of Higher Institutes of Physical Education (2025)**
 - **32nd International Seminar on Olympic Studies for Postgraduate Students (2025)**
- The selected participants were nominated based on their contribution to national Olympic education efforts and potential for leadership in the Olympic Movement.

4. Strategic partnerships and Innovation

- **Olympic Education and Technology**

A pilot project was launched with local NGOs using digital platforms to teach Olympic values through storytelling and e-learning modules for children and teenagers.

- **Olympism and Social Inclusion**

Joint activities were carried out with organisations working with older adults, migrants, and indigenous communities, incorporating inclusive sports and Olympic workshops.

Future Directions

In the coming year, NOA Guatemala will:

- launch the Olympism in Action Lab, a programme focused on innovation in sports education;
- expand its national network of Olympic educators;
- strengthen regional cooperation with Latin American Academies.

Final Remarks

The Guatemalan Olympic Academy remains committed to spreading Olympism as a tool for education, peace, and development. We thank the IOA for its continued support and for fostering collaboration among Academies worldwide.

NOC OF ISRAEL HIGHLIGHTS

As the national body guiding Olympic sport in Israel, the Olympic Committee of Israel remains deeply committed to the values at the heart of the Olympic Movement: excellence, respect, friendship, sustainability and inclusion. Over the past year, the Olympic Committee of Israel has expanded its scope of action, delivering year-round initiatives that allow Israeli athletes to reach and uplift underserved populations, promote sustainability, and build long-term community resilience. These efforts reflect our belief that Olympism is not only about athletic achievement but also about the transformative power of sport to shape character, communities and futures. Through a growing portfolio of initiatives delivered year-round and in partnership with schools, municipalities, civil society, and international organisations, we continue to empower the next generation, elevate underrepresented voices and extend the reach of Olympic values to every corner of Israeli society. The following summary outlines key activities undertaken in recent months, each one a testament to the Olympic Committee of Israel's role in building a more resilient, inclusive and value-driven sporting culture. The pages that follow document how sport in Israel continues to serve not only as a platform for excellence, but also as a springboard for national cohesion, shared identity, and social transformation.

Olympic Education

Beyond the Rings – Olympic Education Workshop for Young Athletes

Recognising that Olympic education shapes not only athletic performance but also personal development, the Olympic Committee of Israel hosted a powerful workshop titled *Beyond the Rings*. This initiative gave young athletes a rare

chance to step away from the intensity of training and competition and connect with the deeper meaning of the Olympic spirit. The workshop placed Olympic values at the heart of the experience, focusing on integrity, decision-making, and personal growth. Through hands-on activities and interactive stations led by prominent athletes, participants explored core principles such as teamwork, resilience, and sportsmanship. They were encouraged to reflect on who they are beyond their results and how the values of the Olympic Movement apply to their lives – on and off the field. Key topics such as safeguarding, anti-doping, fair play, Olympic legacy, and the prevention of manipulation in sport were woven into the programme, underscoring the broader responsibilities athletes carry.

At its core, *Beyond the Rings* is built on the belief that athletes are not just competitors – they are role models, ambassadors of values, and leaders who inspire others through their actions.

Opening Olympic Doors in Non-Jewish Communities

The Olympic Committee of Israel held a large-scale Olympic talent identification day for approximately 1,500 schoolchildren from the Druze communities of Ein Qiniyye, Mas'ade, Majdal Shams and Buq'ata in the Golan Heights. This initiative is part of the Committee's broader vision to make the path to the Olympic Games accessible to all children in Israel – regardless of their background. By actively engaging non-Jewish communities in Israel's national effort to develop elite athletes, the programme aims to create real opportunities for future representation on Team Israel. More than just a sporting event, the day reflected a deeper commitment to inclusive sport – one that bridges communities, fosters excellence, and strengthens the shared fabric of Israeli society. Powered by collaboration across the entire Olympic ecosystem in Israel, this event represents a vital step toward building a more diverse and unified future for Israeli sport.

Special Olympic Days for Orphans and Refugees

In a powerful celebration of resilience, belonging and opportunity, the Olympic Committee of Israel hosted two special Olympic Days for dozens of orphaned and refugee children. These events brought together schoolchildren and Olympic athletes for uplifting experiences rooted in the Olympic values of excellence, friendship and respect. More than just sports events, they were celebrations of inclusion and the unifying power of sport. The Olympic Committee of Israel

remains deeply committed to advancing human rights through sport and proudly supports athletes like Tachlowini Gabriyesos and Jamal Abdelmajid – members of the IOC Refugee Olympic Team, who embody the Olympic spirit as full and equal members of Israel's Olympic community. At each event, the children participated in hands-on sessions across a range of sports, including fencing, sailing, athletics, judo, skateboarding, taekwondo, cricket and gymnastics. Guided by elite athletes and coaches, these activities created lasting memories through connection, movement and shared inspiration.

Olympic and Paralympic Summit

Initiated and led by the NOC Athletes Commission, a first-of-its-kind summit took place in Tel Aviv, bringing together Olympic and Paralympic athletes for a unifying and inspiring event. During the event, athletes from various sports and disciplines met, shared experiences, got to know one another outside the competitive framework, and took part in an Olympic Education Workshop that was designed to strengthen the connection between athletes and to highlight the shared values of the Olympic Movement: excellence, respect, and friendship.

Sustainability

Leading by Example: Olympians and Students Clean Up the Coast

As part of its commitment to environmental sustainability and community engagement, the Olympic Committee of Israel in collaboration with EcoOcean, organised two Beach Cleanup Days with Jewish and non-Jewish schools, in the centre as well as the periphery of Israel, to address the growing threat of marine pollution. Solid waste, household and industrial sewage as well as other pollutants pose severe risks to marine ecosystems, public health, and water sports such as surfing, sailing, and rowing. This initiative combined hands-on environmental action with education and sports, reinforcing the connection between athletic excellence and ecological responsibility. Around 150 middle school students worked alongside Olympic athletes as well as EcoOcean instructors to clean the beach and learn about marine conservation. By engaging young students and elite athletes in a shared mission, the project not only helped clean the coastline

but also fostered a deeper understanding of sustainability and the role of sports in protecting our environment.

Sports and Sustainability – Shaping the Future

A unique and groundbreaking conference exploring the connection between sports, sustainability, and accessibility was held for the first time in Israel, placing the integration of environmental and social issues in the sports sector at the centre of public discourse. The event – a collaboration between the Olympic Committee of Israel, Reichman University, and Access Israel – introduced a forward-looking vision for both local and global sports, emphasising the growing interconnections between athletics, environmental responsibility, and social inclusion.

The conference showcased how sports can act as a powerful driver of positive change, influencing both society and the environment. Topics included athlete behaviour, sustainable management of sports facilities, and the organisation of environmentally and socially responsible sports and community events – all aimed at reducing the ecological footprint of the sports industry. As part of the programme, the Olympic Committee of Israel unveiled its sustainability strategy. Olympic athletes, sports managers, and industry experts shared insights and initiatives from their work in the field. The event underscored the sports sector's potential to serve as a key agent of change, harnessing values, creativity, and innovation to promote a more inclusive and sustainable future.

Being Israeli Means Giving

Demonstrating the power of Olympism beyond sports, the Olympic Committee of Israel partnered with LATET (Israel's largest NGO combating poverty and food insecurity) for the third consecutive year to support families in need. In March 2025, in a large-scale food packing drive, 130 Olympic and Paralympic athletes, coaches, and officials gathered at the organisation's logistics centre to assemble and distribute 2,140 food packages.

This hands-on initiative exemplified the Olympic values of solidarity, respect, and social responsibility, reinforcing the role of athletes as changemakers in their communities. The event underscored the broader mission of the Olympic Movement – to drive sustainable social change and promote human dignity. By engaging directly in community service, Israel's Olympians continue to inspire action and highlight the unifying spirit of sport in addressing social challenges.

Legacy

We Are The 11 – Remembering the Munich 1972 Victims

In partnership with the Tel Aviv Municipality, the Olympic Committee of Israel held a special memorial event titled We Are The 11 to honour the 11 Israeli athletes murdered at the 1972 Munich Olympics. Held at the Tel Aviv Cinematheque, the event included a screening of the documentary and brought together over 200 young athletes from local sports clubs.

The goal was to preserve the memory of the Munich victims and to pass on the lessons of this tragic chapter in Olympic history to the next generation. The ceremony was attended by family members of the victims, former Olympians and members of the original 1972 delegation.

Looking Ahead

As we look toward Milano Cortina 2026 and Los Angeles 2028, the Olympic Committee of Israel remains committed not only to competitive success but to leveraging the full power of sport to create a more just, healthy and inclusive society. These programmes represent the foundation for that vision – built athlete by athlete, classroom by classroom, community by community.

OLYMPIC EDUCATION AND PROMOTIONAL ACTIVITIES OF THE POLISH OLYMPIC COMMITTEE AND POLISH OLYMPIC ACADEMY – THE 2024 ANNUAL REPORT

The Olympic Education Department of the Polish Olympic Committee, with the support of the Polish Olympic Academy, undertakes and implements a wide range of initiatives aimed at promoting Olympic values, fostering sportsmanship, and enhancing the educational dimension of sport among children, youth, teachers, educators, and the broader school community.

One of its flagship programmes is the *School Olympic Academy*, a free educational initiative conducted regularly for children and teenagers. Around six sessions are delivered each week as part of the programme, reaching approximately 600 students every month. These sessions introduce students to the history and significance of the Olympic Games and Olympic values in a way that is both engaging and accessible.

To encourage and support teachers in their independent efforts to promote Olympism within their school communities, the Olympic Education Department develops and provides *comprehensive educational resources*. These include detailed lesson plans, multimedia presentations, activity worksheets, and quizzes. The materials are designed to facilitate high-quality Olympic-themed education across all age groups and school levels.

Another significant contribution to Olympic education is the publication of original books that explore Olympic history and legacy from a Polish perspective. Among the notable titles published in 2024 are *The First Team* by Daniel Lis as well as *Where is Smoky?*, a creative collection of stories featuring Olympic mascots as narrators who introduce children to the key Olympic values in an imaginative and relatable way.

As part of the Olympic Education Department's outreach efforts, the *Fair Play Run competition* has become a regular national event that encourages schools to organise inclusive and cooperative running events. The initiative, organised

in collaboration with the Fair Play Council of the National Olympic Committee of Poland, promotes the idea that participation, joy of movement, and mutual respect are more important than competition. In previous editions, winning schools were awarded the opportunity to participate in the Olympic Fair Play Camp, a multi-day event featuring meetings with Olympians and introductions to new sports disciplines. A sports psychologist was also present during the camp, providing continuous observation and support throughout its duration. Prizes in the upcoming edition will include professional sports equipment and a visit from an Olympian.

The Olympic Education Department also offers dedicated support to *schools named after Polish Olympians* by participating in patron day celebrations, assisting with educational programmes, and supporting the organisation of school events, thereby helping these institutions uphold and celebrate their legacy.

Another impactful initiative is the *Olympism Ambassadors Programme*, which brings Olympians into schools as mentors and project leaders. Before their school visits, Olympians undergo training in areas such as self-presentation, team building, storytelling, and organising physical activities for youth. Each project includes three phases: an introductory visit, a mid-point evaluation of student progress, and a final presentation of the completed project. This personal interaction between students and Olympians brings the values of hard work, perseverance, and fair play to life, fostering a deeper understanding of these principles.

A key annual event is *Kreator Sportu*, a national educational conference combined with practical workshops. This initiative targets physical education teachers, educators, coaches, and parents. Each edition is developed in collaboration with Olympians and specialists, and focuses on a specific area that is aligned with Olympic philosophy. Participants not only receive valuable insights and inspiration but also free educational materials to support their work with youth.

In 2021, the conference focused on individualised teaching methods and the recognition of student potential. The 2022 edition focused on outdoor physical activity and reconnecting with nature. In 2023, the conference explored two main themes: sports psychology in PE lessons and the rise of urban sports.

The 2024 edition of the conference, inspired by the Olympic motto "Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together", focused on cooperation and community. The choice of theme was driven by a longing for relationships built on respect and relationships that unite and strengthen. Today, we are witnessing an increasing number of

misunderstandings between teachers and students, students and parents, and, ultimately, between parents and teachers – misunderstandings that benefit no one, deepen divisions, and push us further from the true and lasting goal: finding genuine joy and fun in sports. Believing that mutual understanding begins with dialogue – and at its core, the words we speak to ourselves and to others – the 2024 event was expanded to include not just physical education teachers, but also the entire teaching staff, parents of young athletes, and psychologists – those who have the power to shape a positive sports environment in the kind of school we all dream of.

An important element in promoting Olympic knowledge and education is the *Olympic Logos Competition*, which has been held biennially by the Polish Olympic Academy since 2003. This prestigious academic competition invites submissions of bachelor's, master's, doctoral, and post-doctoral theses, along with published academic works and books related to the Olympic Games. Topics cover a wide range – from sports law, ethics, history, education, and economics to architecture and Olympic philosophy. The competition continues to generate increasing interest within the academic community. As noted by the late Professor Józef Lipiec, former Chairman of the Polish Olympic Academy and a distinguished member of the competition jury, “The Olympic Games are not just a sporting event, but also a source of profound humanistic knowledge that deserves continuous exploration and discussion.”

PROMOTING OLYMPISM AND OLYMPIC VALUES IN SLOVENIA: A REVIEW OF THE OLYMPIC COMMITTEE OF SLOVENIA'S ACTIVITIES IN 2024

In 2024, the Olympic Committee of Slovenia (NOC Slovenia), in cooperation with the National Olympic Academy, implemented a wide range of programmes and events aimed at promoting Olympism, Olympic values, and sport participation across all generations.

Aligned with the mission of the Olympic Movement to build a better world through sport, the NOC Slovenia actively pursued a comprehensive strategy in 2024 to promote the Olympic values—excellence, friendship, and respect—and to foster sport participation. Through national campaigns, youth programmes, cultural collaborations, and Olympic-themed celebrations, the NOC Slovenia demonstrated its commitment to both community engagement and Olympic education.

The *Mini Olympic Festival* was one of the flagship programmes of the year, reaching 17,992 children in 55 events throughout Slovenia. Mainly targeting children in kindergartens and the first three grades of primary school, the events combined playful sport challenges with education about Olympic symbols (the torch, flag, and oath) and values. Over 385 local sports clubs participated, reinforcing local community engagement and sport development. The involvement of Slovenian Olympians and elite athletes played a key motivational role.

The *Olympic Sports Hours* programme focused on active learning for children at the Slovenian Olympic Education Centre. Across 52 sessions, more than 2,000 children participated in sport activities, Olympic quizzes, and cooperative games. The programme emphasised inclusive values, stating that “everyone who tries and participates is a winner.”

A notable summer initiative was the *Olympic Sports Camp* with our mascot Foksi, held in the forests of Pokljuka. Over six days, 22 children experienced a

multi-sport programme enriched with Olympic storytelling and mentorship by distinguished Olympians such as Urška Žolnir Jugovar and Klemen Bauer.

Another innovative programme, *Read & Sport*, combined sports and reading promotion. Delivered in partnership with national ministries and educational institutions, seven workshops were conducted in libraries across Slovenia, involving over 600 youth and 14 elite athletes. Monthly reading recommendations for young athletes complemented the events, nurturing both physical and cognitive engagement.

Olympic Day (June 23) was marked in cooperation with 18 primary schools, engaging more than 5,700 pupils. Olympians visited their primary schools, shared their journeys, and led Olympic-themed educational and physical activities. Featured athletes included Alenka Bikar, Vid Poteko, and Valter Bonča, who helped bridge the gap between Olympic history and local school communities.

The *Slovenian Torch Relay* was among the most ambitious projects of 2024. Starting 100 days before the Paris 2024 Olympic Games and concluding 14 days before the opening ceremony, the torch relay travelled through 203 Slovenian municipalities and four expatriate communities, involving over 10,500 official torchbearers. The initiative celebrated national unity and anticipation for the Olympic Games, serving as a powerful symbol of collective identity.

During the Paris 2024 Olympic Games, *different Olympic Festivals* were organised in five Slovenian cities, bringing together over 5,000 participants to cheer for national athletes and engage in sports activities. These events featured live broadcasts from Paris, interactive sport stations, and community engagement, further amplifying Olympic excitement and fostering national pride.

In the autumn, the main Olympic Festival celebrated its 10th anniversary and took place in the Slovenian capital, Ljubljana. The event drew more than 5,500 visitors despite challenging weather conditions. Organised by the NOC Slovenia in collaboration with 44 national sports federations, the event offered hands-on sport experiences led by local sports clubs and volunteers, showcasing the strength of Slovenia's grassroots sports community.

The NOC Slovenia also emphasised sport for all through programmes aimed at adults and seniors. The Sports Games for Employees engaged 2,431 participants from 295 Slovenian companies, fostering physical activity in workplace settings and promoting wellbeing in professional environments.

For older populations, the *Active Day for Seniors* was organised in 11 municipalities, alongside a major activation at the *Festival for the Third Age of*

Life in Ljubljana. Free physical assessments and personal consultations were provided to over 2,065 individuals, promoting active and healthy ageing and encouraging lifelong sport participation.

The *Sport and Cultural Heritage* initiative linked sport with Slovenian cultural institutions. Delivered in partnership with the Tržič Museum and Zasavje Museum Trbovlje, children explored the intersection of sport and Slovenian history through guided tours and physical challenges. Nearly 250 pupils participated, illustrating the potential of cross-sector collaborations in Olympic education.

Slovenia also marked National Sports Day (September 23) and participated actively in the European Week of Sport, promoting movement and sport for all citizens through local activations and public engagement. These national celebrations, along with the visibility of elite athletes, contributed to strengthening the social relevance of sport and Olympic values.

In conclusion, the Olympic Committee of Slovenia's 2024 activities demonstrate a holistic and inclusive approach to promoting Olympism, sport participation, and community cohesion. By combining educational initiatives, national celebrations, cross-sector partnerships, and the inspiration of elite athletes, the NOC Slovenia continues to play a vital role in embedding Olympic values into the fabric of Slovenian society.

OLYMPIC ACADEMY COMMISSION – COU REPORT ON THE DEVELOPMENT OF OLYMPIC VALUES IN THE URUGUAYAN OLYMPIC COMMITTEE IN 2024

Prof. Gabriela Fernández (URU)

Introduction

The Uruguayan Olympic Committee (COU) has worked tirelessly for years to promote the fundamental values of the Olympic Movement: excellence, friendship and respect. In the framework of the preparations for the Paris 2024 Olympic Games, the COU has launched several initiatives with the aim of strengthening these values in both athletes and sports leaders. This report analyses the development of these values through various activities organised by the COU during 2024, highlighting in particular the training courses, the collaboration with the Athletes' Commission, the organisation of the Third Athletes' Forum and the seal of participation in the Olympic Games, with a focus on Fair Play.

Advanced and Basic Sports Management Courses

In 2024, the Uruguayan Olympic Committee organised two key programmes to promote excellence and professionalisation of sports actors in the country:

Advanced Sports Management Course: This course is aimed at directors, coaches and those responsible for high-level sports institutions. Its objective is to provide management and leadership tools, focusing on the strategic development of Olympic values within the organisational structure of national sport. Participants are trained in areas such as sports planning, ethics in management and the importance of Olympic values in decision-making.

Decentralised Basic Sports Management Course: This programme is implemented in different regions of the country in order to decentralise knowledge and education in sports management. The training covers basic principles of organisation, sports promotion and how to integrate the Olympic values of respect, friendship and excellence into the foundations of local sport. This decentralisation ensures that Olympic values not only reach the capital, but are accessible throughout the national territory.

Both courses seek to raise the quality of Uruguayan sport, improve the conditions of athletes and prepare future sports managers to work within the framework of the values that define the Olympic Movement.

Working Together with the Athletes' Commission

The Uruguayan Olympic Committee has maintained close collaboration with the Athletes' Commission, which plays a fundamental role in defending the rights and interests of athletes. During 2024, roundtables and periodic meetings were organised with the aim of strengthening the sense of community and respect within the sports environment, focusing on the following key points:

Preparation for the Paris 2024 Olympic Games: Uruguayan athletes who will participate in the Paris Olympic Games have received guidance in both sports and ethics. The Athletes' Commission has implemented mental and physical preparation programmes, while the COU reinforces the importance of respect, friendship and excellence in their behaviour on and off the field of competition.

Developing a Fair Play Culture: The Athletes' Commission has promoted initiatives so that athletes do not only focus on winning, but always respect the rules and the opponent, in line with the principles of Fair Play and Olympic values.

Third Athletes' Forum

The Third Athletes' Forum, held in 2024, has been a crucial platform for the exchange of experiences, the continuous training of athletes and the reinforcement of Olympic values. At this forum, Uruguayan athletes were able to discuss the following:

The importance of Olympic values in a sports career: The workshops and conferences analysed how the values of excellence, friendship and respect

should be an integral part of an athlete's life, both in their training and in their participation in international competitions.

The Promotion of Fair Play and ethics in sport: Practical cases were discussed on how to handle competition situations in an ethical manner, always respecting the rival and following the rules of the game, regardless of the pressure for victory.

Preparation for Paris 2024: The forum also included specific sessions on preparation for the Paris 2024 Olympic Games, with an emphasis on how to represent Uruguay under the principles of Olympic values, both on and off the field.

Olympic Games Participation Stamp

The Paris 2024 Olympic Games Participation Stamp awarded by the Uruguayan Post Office to the Uruguayan Olympic Committee aims to recognise and reward athletes who meet the standards of excellence and respect during their preparation and participation in the Games. This stamp is awarded under the following criteria:

Compliance with the principles of Fair Play: The COU has established a programme of participation in the Olympic Games in Paris 2024, which is aimed at promoting the participation of athletes in the Games.

This seal is awarded under the following criteria:

Compliance with the principles of Fair Play: The COU has established a protocol where Uruguayan athletes must demonstrate, during their preparation and participation, exemplary behaviour that reflects Olympic values.

Promotion of friendship and respect among athletes: Initiatives that athletes undertake to foster camaraderie, mutual respect and cooperation with other international participants are valued.

Commitment to ethics and integrity: Athletes are encouraged to actively participate in programmes that reinforce the importance of competing fairly, without resorting to doping or unsportsmanlike practices.

Celebration of the 101 Years of the Uruguayan Olympic Committee

2024 also marks the 101st anniversary of the Uruguayan Olympic Committee, a milestone that reflects the COU's long history of promoting Olympic values in the country. During this year, several commemorative activities have been organised

that underline the importance of the COU in the evolution of Uruguayan sport, always based on the fundamental principles of excellence, friendship and respect.

Commemorative events: Seminars, conferences and celebrations have been held to remember the historical achievements of the COU and how these have been aligned with the promotion of Olympic values.

Strengthening the commitment to young people: Within the framework of the anniversary, the COU has launched awareness campaigns so that future generations of Uruguayan athletes follow the example of Olympic athletes and work towards the values that give identity to the Olympic Movement.

Conclusion

The Uruguayan Olympic Committee has managed, through various activities in 2024, to strengthen and expand the promotion of Olympic values in the country. From sports management courses, through joint work with the Athletes' Commission, to the Third Athletes' Forum and the celebration of the 101st anniversary of the COU, all these actions have been fundamental to ensuring that the legacy of the values of excellence, friendship and respect remains alive in Uruguayan sport, especially with a view to the upcoming Olympic Games in Paris 2024.

The integration of Fair Play as a guiding principle in all activities and the constant reflection on ethical values in sport have made 2024 a key year in the development of a solid sports culture in Uruguay, aligned with global Olympic principles.

NOC OF UZBEKISTAN

The National Olympic Committee of Uzbekistan continues its active work to popularise mass sports and attract the population to a healthy lifestyle. Particular attention is paid to the development of sports infrastructure, support for children's and youth schools and the organisation of mass sports events.

In parallel, targeted training of athletes for the Milan Cortina 2026 and Los Angeles 2028 Olympic Games is being carried out. As part of the preparation, modern conditions for training are being created, qualified specialists are being attracted, and scientific, methodological and medical programmes are being implemented.

The NOC's activities are aimed at ensuring high results for Uzbek athletes in the international arena and strengthening the country's sports image. In particular, from April 1 to 10, a table tennis seminar was held in Tashkent as part of the Olympic Solidarity project of the International Olympic Committee. The event was organised jointly with the International Table Tennis Federation. A specialist from Jordan, Muhammad Atum, was invited as an expert. For nine days, he shared his knowledge and experience with 28 coaches who came from all over Uzbekistan. The training included both theoretical and practical classes. Upon completion of the seminar, the participants who successfully completed the training received certificates from the leadership of the National Olympic Committee of Uzbekistan.

The 5th International Seminar on Digital Communications and Social Networks is planned to be held in Tashkent on June 2–5 this year, organised with the support of the International Olympic Committee and in cooperation with the NOC of Azerbaijan.

This year, the main topic will be the coordination of work with artificial intelligence in the field of social media. The seminar will be attended by representatives of more than 20 National Olympic Committees, International Federations, as well as experts and specialists in media communications.

The programme includes master classes, exchange of experience based on the results of the latest international competitions, as well as discussion of preparations for the Asian Youth Games, the European Youth Festival, the Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games and the Milan Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics.

All sessions will be broadcast online and accessible to international observers and experts. Hosting the seminar in Uzbekistan is an opportunity to showcase the country's achievements in sports and media.

CONCLUSIONS OF THE WORKING GROUPS





Introductory Meeting of the IOA Dean, Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis with the working groups' coordinators, during which the necessary guidelines were given.

FRENCH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 1

This 18th Session for NOA and NOC delegates is an opportunity for us to reflect together on “the future of sport”, and more specifically on the subject of “Olympic Education and Artificial Intelligence: a process of transformation”.

Indeed, since 1894 and the revival of the Olympic Games by Baron Pierre de Coubertin, our societies have had to deal with the constant evolution of populations and respond to new needs. Various working groups have been set up to develop the concepts acquired from the lectures and presentations.

The French-speaking group 1 began a reflection on the evolution of Olympism in the face of major technological transformations, in particular the rise of artificial intelligence and esports. It was recognised that, while preserving the fundamental values of Olympism (Excellence, Respect, Friendship), adaptation is necessary to remain relevant to younger generations.

Question 1: Impact of Esports on School Education: Opportunities and Challenges.

According to the Olympic Charter, “The goal of the Olympic Movement is to contribute to building a peaceful and better world by educating youth through sport practiced in accordance with Olympism and its values” (Olympic Charter, Chapter 1, Rule 1.1)

The introduction of electronic sports (esports) into schools represents an innovative opportunity to modernise education and bring young people closer to digital tools in a pedagogical manner. These digital disciplines arouse great interest among young people, encourage motivation and develop cross-disciplinary skills such as concentration, teamwork, strategy and stress management. As well as being a key driver of inclusion for pupils with disabilities or those who are less

attracted to traditional sports, esports can also open up career prospects in the digital, video games or digital communications sectors.

However, integrating esports into the education system presents challenges that should not be overlooked. The main risk is to young people's health: a sedentary lifestyle, screen addiction, vision or sleep problems and abuses linked to cybercrime require strict supervision. There is also a need to reduce inequalities in access to digital technology, particularly in rural areas or areas with fewer resources. The lack of training for teachers and the absence of a clear regulatory framework can also put the brakes on this innovation if they are not properly anticipated.

In order to make the most of esports in the school system, it is essential to do the following:

- adopt a balanced approach: regulate usage times, select content with educational value and raise pupils' awareness of healthy and responsible use of digital technology,
- work with stakeholders (Ministry of Education, sports federations and technology stakeholders): schools can transform video games into genuine learning tools,
- safeguard the well-being and ethics of users by providing a favourable ecosystem,
- combine the enjoyable with the useful: in this pedagogical and educational approach, esports can become a real lever for personal and academic development.

All these best practices could be focused on a digital exchange platform accessible to Olympic Committees and Academies.

The involvement of NOAs is essential in the implementation of these digital strategies.

Question 2: The Means of Funding NOAs in Their Digital Strategies to Promote Olympic Values

Particular attention has been paid to the educational mission of the Olympic Academies, which play an essential role in disseminating Olympic values. However, the lack of a regular subsidy for the implementation of their activities remains problematic.

Our recommendations:

- Adapt educational activities to new technological contexts to remain relevant
- In collaboration with the IOA, organise practical courses for stakeholders within the NOAs
- Ensure the financial autonomy of National Olympic Academies through Olympic Solidarity subsidy (via the NOC)
 - Proposal to provide the Academies with a clear and independent structure, including statutes, dedicated staff, an official headquarters for efficient operation
 - Set up a specific subsidy budget to enable autonomous operation, without excessive dependence on the NOC
- Avoid the creation of a parallel Olympic Education Commission within the NOCs, and support the NOAs in their mission to educate people in the Olympic values
- Update NOC statutes to better define roles and guarantee structural and financial support for Olympic Academies.

Conclusion

The group recommends a thoughtful integration of technology and artificial intelligence into the Olympic world, while reinforcing existing educational structures. Olympism must evolve without losing its foundations, guaranteeing inclusivity, accessibility, sustainability, education and respect for the human being. “Science without conscience is the ruin of the soul”, François Rabelais.

FRENCH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 2

“Olympic Education and AI: a Process of Transformation”

Olympism is, above all, a philosophy of life that goes beyond the practice of sport: it embodies universal values such as excellence, respect and friendship (Olympic Charter),¹ inclusion, solidarity and living together. Olympic education makes it possible to transmit these values, shape responsible citizens and promote a more ethical and peaceful society.

Today, artificial intelligence is an integral part of this educational process. It offers new ways of learning, stimulating, including and interacting, adapting to the needs of each individual. Used properly, AI can become a powerful tool in the service of Olympic ideals.

All these elements lead us to formalise the following problem:

How can AI impact citizen development through an Olympic education programme while preserving humanism and ethics?

Artificial Intelligence Opportunities for Olympic Education

AI offers powerful levers for strengthening Olympic education. It makes it possible to personalise learning from an early age, for example by identifying the needs of young people according to their local context, in the service of their overall well-being.

It provides strategic support for coaches, helping them to plan and adapt

1. Comité International Olympique (2025), Charte Olympique (version janvier 2025)
<https://stillmed.olympics.com/media/Documents/International-Olympic-Committee/IOC-Publications/FR-Olympic-Charter.pdf>

training more effectively. It can also help transmit Olympic values via interactive, fun platforms hosted by Young Ambassadors.

It saves time, and can help us to take Olympic education projects a step further.

However, to guarantee ethical use, it is essential to preserve the educator-learner link, define a clear usage charter and set up an internationally recognised regulatory mechanism.

Barriers to Integrating AI into Olympic Education

Despite these advantages, AI raises several limitations. The lack of technological equipment, particularly in certain regions of the world, high cost, environmental impact and unequal access are major obstacles.

Added to this are issues linked to resistance to change, poor understanding of AI, and ethical risks: respect for personal data, loss of social interaction or abuses linked to the use of chatbots. The perpetual use of AI could restrict the capacity for human reflection.

It is therefore becoming essential to train educators, personalise tools according to audiences, and regulate the use of AI to guarantee an ethical and inclusive pedagogical framework.

Questions raised

Faced with these opportunities and challenges, two central questions emerge:

- What concrete contributions can AI make to Olympic education programmes to foster the development of citizens?
- How can we ensure that the use of AI in this context respects the ethical principles and humanist values promoted by Olympism?

Recommendations

Without claiming to provide absolute answers, our reflection on the integration of AI into Olympic education leads us to make a few concrete recommendations, both pedagogical and ethical:

Recommendation 1: Use AI to personalise learning paths, adapting content according to age, level, language or specific needs.

Recommendation 2: Develop interactive educational platforms based on AI, including quizzes, simulators or games around Olympic values, by raising awareness among spokespeople such as Young Ambassadors.

Recommendation 3: Draw up an ethical charter on the use of AI in Olympic educational programmes, supported by an authority such as the IOC.

Recommendation 4: Maintain the central role of the educator, ensuring that AI remains a pedagogical support tool, not a substitute, in the educational relationship.

Properly used, artificial intelligence can become a powerful lever for Olympic education. It can make learning more accessible, personalised and interactive, while facilitating the transmission of the fundamental values of Olympism. However, its use must remain ethical, controlled and human-centred, in order to preserve the spirit of sport and the educational mission of the Olympic Movement.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 1

Topic 1: Integrating AI into Olympic Education: A Strategic Vision for the Future

The integration of artificial intelligence (AI) into Olympic education represents a transformative opportunity to enhance how the Olympic values of excellence, respect, and friendship are communicated to new generations. With technology reshaping the global educational landscape, leveraging AI can personalise learning, make abstract concepts more tangible, and bridge generational gaps in knowledge. However, such integration requires careful strategic planning, especially within schools, where children's development and safety are paramount.

AI can significantly improve how Olympic education is taught, understood, and experienced. AI can be leveraged to analyse individual student's learning patterns and adapt to their needs, therefore enabling educators to offer personalised teaching experiences. This can include tracking a student's progress, identifying areas where they need improvement, and tailoring content such as lessons on Olympic history, values, and ethical issues to their level of understanding.

Virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR) powered by AI can allow students to experience historical Olympic events, interact with Olympic athletes, or explore the venues of the Games. AI can also assist in creating personalised Olympic stories, drawing from various Olympic Games. By utilising Natural Language Processing (NLP), AI can curate content based on different time periods, sports disciplines, or Olympians; it could help students understand the human side of the Games and the global impact of Olympism through storytelling.

Olympic education involves engaging with global students and promoting the Olympic values of respect, excellence and fair play. Olympic education also

facilitates cultural exchanges. AI tools can facilitate communication between schools from different countries, enabling students to collaborate on joint projects, share experiences, and engage in discussions on the universal principles promoted through Olympism.

To effectively introduce AI into Olympic education within schools, the foundation must be laid in both infrastructure and curriculum design. Schools could embed adaptive quizzes and Olympic education topics on the importance of healthy lifestyles and virtual fair play in primary education into the curricula and use interactive tools powered by AI, such as storytelling avatars, to deliver the messaging.

Teaching children about Olympians and their journeys can be inspirational. Schools can integrate stories of Olympic athletes who have overcome adversity and achieved greatness to create engaging and personalised learning content that showcases the human side of sport. That information can be acquired by using AI to analyse data about athletes' backgrounds, achievements, and struggles.

Olympic education promotes the values of physical fitness and well-being. AI can assist in sports training by providing feedback on student performance and offering personalised tips for improvement at a young age.

However, before using AI tools, children need a foundational understanding of how AI works since there might be ambiguity between illusion and reality. This ensures they interact with technology critically and responsibly.

AI can be integrated into physical education programmes through wearable technologies or fitness apps that track students' performance, provide feedback, and encourage a healthy lifestyle. AI-powered sports simulators could also help children understand Olympic disciplines and visualise the demands of different sports, making it easier for them to relate to athletes and the Olympic Games. Teachers must ensure that AI is not used just as a technical tool, but as a medium through which Olympic ideals are conveyed and reinforced, emphasising character, respect, and global citizenship.

Educators are central to the success of AI-integrated Olympic education. Without adequate training, they may find it difficult to implement new tools effectively. Capacity-building initiatives must include professional development programmes to learn how to use AI tools and technologies in their classrooms. Partnerships with universities, Olympic Academies, and tech companies can provide continuous professional development and access to updated tools. Educators from different countries and educational systems can benefit from

knowledge-sharing platforms which connect educators to exchange ideas, best practices, and lesson plans related to Olympic education. Educators can also be trained to incorporate diverse cultural perspectives, which aligns with the Olympic principle of "unity in diversity". AI can facilitate this process by offering multi-language support, clarifying cultural differences, and recommending strategies that encourage inclusivity and respect for all cultures.

Safeguarding is a critical issue when integrating new technologies such as AI into Olympic education and policies should be established to protect children's privacy, security, and well-being. While AI systems gather data on student learning patterns, preferences and performances, there should be strict adherence to data privacy laws. Schools should guarantee that AI tools used in Olympic education comply with international data protection regulations (such as GDPR) to safeguard children's personal data.

AI systems used in Olympic education should be designed to provide appropriate content that aligns with the ethical values of Olympism. Schools should have robust content monitoring mechanisms to ensure that AI-generated content does not promote harmful behaviour or spread misinformation. This includes preventing exposure to inappropriate material or content that conflicts with Olympic values like respect, fair play, and inclusion. AI tools used in Olympic education should also protect against biases and stereotypes, especially regarding gender, race and nationality. Teachers should be trained to monitor and mitigate biases in AI applications, ensuring that all students have an equal opportunity to engage in Olympic education.

Schools and educators should also have child protection policies that specifically address the use of AI in Olympic education, including protocols for reporting any misuse or harm caused by AI technologies. Additionally, schools should ensure that AI-driven tools are age-appropriate, preventing children from being exposed to harmful or inappropriate interactions.

AI holds great potential for enhancing Olympic education. Through personalised learning experiences, virtual Olympic simulations, and global collaboration, AI can enrich how students experience Olympic education. However, to realise this potential, careful consideration must be given to capacity-building for educators, ensuring safeguarding for children and athletes, and the responsible use of AI. The International Olympic Academy's mission of promoting Olympic values worldwide can be greatly enhanced by AI, but its implementation must always prioritise ethical considerations, data privacy, and child protection.

Topic 2: The Integration of Esports into Olympic Education

The rapid, global rise of esports and its integration into Olympic values education pose several questions around its legitimacy as a sport, its educational value, and its alignment with the principles of Olympism. This report considers examples of esports use in sport, and opportunities, challenges, and strategic recommendations for incorporating esports into educational systems and traditional sporting cultures.

Esports, or competitive video gaming, has grown into a multibillion-dollar global industry with increasing influence on youth culture and education. As established definitions of sport evolve, the debate over esports' status among established sport (whether esports meet the established criteria to be called an athletic disciplines) continues. At the same time, educational institutions and Olympic stakeholders are examining the role of esports in fostering engagement, inclusion, and digital literacy.

Another area of concern is the alignment of Olympic values—such as respect, excellence, and friendship—with the esports environment, which is purported to lack a consistent emphasis on these ideals. Additionally, the strong commercialisation of esports raises questions about its compatibility with the values-driven philosophy of Olympism. The deliberation that remains is whether esports can strike a balance between profit and purpose, highlighting the complexity of fully integrating esports into traditional sports frameworks.

Countries around the world are embracing esports as a legitimate, structured and innovative discipline to boost strategic initiatives in sport. In Jordan, different sport simulators are used for athletes, such as those in car racing, to introduce and improve different skills like focus, strategic thinking, teamwork and mental agility. Japan has taken a more formal approach by developing dedicated esports schools that offer specialised curricula to professionalise young gamers and integrate digital gaming into the broader educational landscape. Meanwhile, several National Federations are forming esports governing bodies to mirror the organisational frameworks of traditional sports, promoting regulation, integrity, and development. These efforts highlight a growing recognition of esports as a valuable tool for education, economic opportunity, and youth engagement.

Esports offers a wide range of benefits that extend beyond gaming. It enhances critical thinking, strategic planning, and decision-making, while also improving hand-eye coordination and reflexes. Through team-based gameplay, participants develop strong communication, collaboration, and leadership skills. Esports is

also promoted as inclusive and accessible, welcoming individuals of all abilities and backgrounds, including those who may not engage in traditional/established sports. It also opens academic and career opportunities in fields such as game design, marketing, event management, and cybersecurity, with many colleges now offering scholarships and structured esports programmes. Additionally, proponents of esports suggest that they foster mental resilience by teaching players how to manage pressure, stay disciplined, and cope with setbacks, while building a sense of community and encouraging responsible digital citizenship.

Economically, esports contributes to local development through events and technology investments and often sparks interest in STEM and entrepreneurial pathways. When integrated with physical activity and wellness programmes, esports can support a balanced lifestyle and promote mental health awareness.

Esports can play a powerful role in supporting traditional sports by increasing youth engagement, expanding its audience base, and promoting physical activity through gamified training tools. By integrating elements of sports into video games on football (soccer), basketball, or racing, esports can spark interest in established sports among gamers, encouraging more active participation in those sports. Additionally, partnerships between sports organisations and esports leagues help build brand recognition and foster a deeper appreciation for athletic strategy, teamwork, and competition. This synergy can be a gateway for younger generations to explore and respect both digital and physical forms of athleticism.

There are, however, several challenges and ethical concerns about esports that require careful attention. One major issue is the lack of standardised regulations across platforms and tournaments, leading to inconsistencies in rules, player protection, and fair play. Ethical concerns include excessive screen time, potential addiction, and the mental health impact on young players who face intense pressure and burnout. Additionally, there are concerns about inclusivity, online harassment, and toxic behaviour within gaming communities. The monetisation of esports, including loot boxes and in-game purchases, also raises questions about consumer exploitation, especially among minors. Addressing these concerns is essential to ensure esports develop in a responsible, sustainable, and ethical manner.

The successful integration of esports into education and Olympic education frameworks requires a multi-faceted approach. Introducing esports at the primary or secondary level can help establish responsible gaming habits early and empower students to make informed choices. Rather than focusing solely on competition,

schools should promote broad participation to engage youth inclusively and foster teamwork, creativity, and critical thinking.

Inspired by Japan's model, dedicated esports schools or programmes can be developed to nurture talent while maintaining academic rigor. The use of AI tools and simulation platforms can further enhance both training outcomes and the curriculum through physical education, digital literacy, or extracurricular activities, ensuring structured learning while recognising gaming as a modern cultural practice. Finally, professional development for educators and administrators is key, providing them with the knowledge and tools to effectively guide students through the educational benefits of esports.

We consider that esports offer a dynamic opportunity to modernise education and promote Olympic values in a digital era. When approached strategically and ethically, esports can foster inclusion, engagement, and innovation in schools and sports. However, successful integration of esports with "traditional" learning systems and sports will require effective collaboration, policy development, and ongoing monitoring and evaluation to ensure it aligns with educational goals and the spirit of Olympism.

Considering AI and esport integration into Olympic education, our group has determined that face to face/human interaction is more humanistic than seeing the world through digital media and artificial intelligence lenses. We are not convinced that AI and esports help with social, cognitive skills, etc. but we do acknowledge that they are useful education delivery tools. Consequently, we opt out of a final judgment until further studies and recommendations can be advanced.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 2

Exploring AI's Role in the Olympic Movement: Education and Governance

As artificial intelligence (AI) increasingly influences global industries, its integration within the Olympic Movement presents both opportunities and challenges. From enhancing athletic performance to revolutionising event logistics, AI promises to reshape the landscape of sport. However, this transformation must be carefully managed to uphold the core values of Olympism.

In this context, two critical areas emerge: the role of Olympic education in guiding AI's usage and the International Olympic Committee's (IOC) responsibility in safeguarding its ethical application. These discussions focus on ensuring that technological innovation aligns with the Movement's foundational principles of fairness, inclusion, and humanity.

The Role of Olympic Education in AI Integration

As AI becomes more prevalent in sport, Olympic education plays a vital role in steering its application to enhance, rather than detract from, the values of the Olympic Movement. While AI has the potential to optimise athletic performance, streamline operations, and enrich spectator experiences, unregulated advancements could risk shifting the focus toward a purely technocentric model. This shift might jeopardise not only the integrity of the Games but also equitable access to AI's benefits across nations.

Olympic education offers a platform to address these challenges by guiding AI usage and promoting holistic athlete development. Baron Pierre de Coubertin's vision of fostering well-rounded individuals remains central to this mission.

To ensure AI aligns with Olympism, the following actions are proposed for Olympic educators:

1. **Engage Diverse Communities:** Extend Olympic education beyond athletes and youth, reaching all demographics to preserve the cultural and historical essence of the Games.

2. **Enhance Digital Literacy:** Equip NOAs, NOCs, and communities with the skills needed to effectively use AI, addressing disparities in access and knowledge.

3. **Incorporate Innovative Delivery Methods:** Leverage AI to make educational programmes more engaging while staying true to Olympic values.

4. **Advocate for Ethical Standards:** Ensure compliance with IOC regulations by educating stakeholders about responsible AI usage.

5. **Maintain Adaptability:** Recognise AI's evolving nature and remain flexible in educational approaches, staying rooted in Olympic principles.

By fostering a technologically informed and ethically aware community, Olympic education ensures that AI serves as a tool to amplify the human spirit rather than overshadow it.

The IOC's Responsibility in Safeguarding AI's Ethical Use

The IOC's Olympic AI Agenda sets the foundation for ethical AI integration within the Movement. However, given AI's rapid evolution, this agenda must be adaptable to remain relevant and impactful. To address potential gaps, a nine-point governance framework is proposed, aligning with the IOC's roles as pioneer, catalyst, and guardian.

Table (1):
Proposed Nine-Point AI Governance Framework according to the IOC's role as laid out in the AI Agenda

	<i>Pioneer</i>	<i>Catalyst</i>	<i>Guardian</i>
<i>Organisation</i>	Develop IOC AI Code of Conduct and share with OM stakeholders	Encourage NOCs, IFs, and partners to integrate ethical AI principles.	Establish a fully independent AI ethics committee within the Olympic Movement

	<i>Pioneer</i>	<i>Catalyst</i>	<i>Guardian</i>
<i>Technology</i>	Design AI tools that promote inclusive Olympic education and equitable talent identification.	Facilitate open-sourced AI platforms for sport integrity, accessible to low-resourced countries.	Monitor systems used in officiating, scouting, or education to avoid bias and uphold transparency.
<i>People</i>	Use AI to make Olympic values accessible to more people, in diverse languages and contexts.	Train athletes, educators, and youth in AI awareness and digital ethics.	Enforce safeguards against misuse of AI (e.g. in biometric surveillance or profiling of athletes).

Embedding these principles into the Olympic Charter would ensure that all stakeholders are held accountable for ethical AI practices, reinforcing the values of Olympism.

Conclusion

The convergence of AI and the Olympic Movement represents both a challenge and an opportunity. Olympic education provides a human-centred approach to navigating this transformation, while the IOC's governance efforts lay the groundwork for ethical AI integration. Together, these initiatives ensure that technological advancements remain aligned with the spirit of Olympism, fostering a future where innovation supports fairness, inclusion, and humanity.



The participants engaged in fruitful discussions in the framework of the working groups.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 3

AI Meets Olympism – A New Era for Olympic Education

In an era where sport transcends borders and inspires unity, the Working Group 3 presentation, "AI Meets Olympism: Innovations for a New Era of Olympic Education," envisions a transformative future for Olympic education. By blending the timeless values of Olympism with the boundless potential of artificial intelligence, we aim to inspire young learners worldwide to embrace principles like fair play, respect, and inclusion. This report weaves together the insights from our three chapters, offering a roadmap for redefining Olympic education in a diverse, interconnected world.

At its core, Olympic education is about values – gender equality, respect, fair play, friendship, performance, universality, diversity, and inclusion – that shape not just athletes but entire communities. To bring these ideals to life, we propose immersive, culturally relevant experiences that resonate with young people. Imagine summer camps where children aged 6–14 discover the joy of fair play through hands-on activities, or an international camp in the sacred grounds of Olympia, where global youth forge lifelong friendships. Local sports clubs can amplify this mission by hosting events where Olympians and young athletes share stories of perseverance, igniting dreams of greatness. By weaving Olympic values into local traditions and histories, such as connecting traditional sports to Olympic disciplines, we make concepts like excellence and respect deeply personal. These efforts position Olympic education as a catalyst for social growth, empowering youth to build inclusive, value-driven communities.

The integration of artificial intelligence takes this vision to new heights, making Olympic education more accessible, engaging, and impactful. AI-powered tools streamline programme development, coordinating global teams and anticipating

challenges to ensure seamless execution. Advanced natural language processing enables real-time translation, adapting materials to reflect local cultures while preserving Olympic ideals. Students might explore a virtual Olympic village through an AI-driven augmented reality app, where interactive scenarios bring respect and friendship to life, or engage with animated videos narrating the triumphs of legends like Jesse Owens. To maximise impact, we propose key AI-driven strategies:

- **Evaluation and Refinement:** AI analyses student engagement and behavioural changes, refining teaching methods for lasting retention of Olympic principles.
- **Personalised Learning:** Virtual coaches, powered by AI, guide students through tailored lessons, simulating conversations with Olympic heroes to reinforce resilience.
- **Ethical Content Creation:** AI audits ensure educational materials promote inclusivity and diversity, reflecting the global stories of Olympians.

These innovations, grounded in ethical frameworks, ensure Olympic education reaches every corner of the world with authenticity and fairness.

In practice, thriving Olympic education projects bring these ideas to life, blending AI with community engagement. By partnering with local sports clubs, Olympians, and international collaborators, these initiatives create dynamic learning environments that inspire and empower. They show how technology and values can work in harmony, celebrating Olympism's universal appeal while honouring each community's unique identity. The result is a global movement that prepares young people to carry Olympic principles into their lives, both on and off the field.

We are here to present a real AI tool which is trained by Chat GPT and dedicated to Olympic education. In this programme, people can play different roles and be educated using different scenarios with the help of an AI tool.

The marriage of Olympism and AI heralds a bold new chapter for Olympic education. Through culturally rich programmes and innovative tools, we can create learning experiences that are inclusive, personalised, and transformative. Working Group 3 urges continued global collaboration, ethical AI adoption, and investment in education that bridges cultures and generations. Together, we can nurture not just future athletes but champions of life who embody the spirit of Olympism.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 4

Question 1: How Can Video Games and Technology Assist in Promoting Physical Exercise and Learning?

Video games and modern technology are increasingly transforming the ways people approach physical activity and education. By making these experiences more engaging, interactive, and customised to individual needs, they are reshaping traditional models of fitness and learning while fostering social interaction in schools and communities.

When it comes to promoting physical exercise, technology offers a variety of tools and platforms that encourage movement in fun and accessible ways. One of the most exciting developments is the rise of "exergaming" — a fusion of exercise and gaming. Games such as *Ring Fit Adventure* and *Just Dance* utilise motion sensors or virtual reality to turn workouts into immersive play experiences. These games help raise heart rates, burn calories, and improve balance and coordination, all while making physical activity feel less like a chore and more like entertainment. As a result, users are often more motivated to stay active consistently.

Beyond gaming consoles, technology also enables physical fitness through online platforms and wearable devices. Fitness apps, virtual gyms, and live-streamed classes on platforms like Zoom and YouTube offer diverse options for workouts, including yoga, Pilates, and dance. Smartwatches and fitness trackers further support health goals by gamifying daily movement. Features such as step counting, heart rate monitoring, and achievement badges provide users with real-time feedback and motivation. Social features like community challenges and leaderboards encourage friendly competition and promote regular exercise.

Mobile and augmented reality (AR) games also play a key role in physical

engagement. Games like *Pokémon GO* require players to move outdoors, walk, and explore their surroundings as part of gameplay. These location-based games encourage spontaneous and enjoyable physical activity, often leading to better overall fitness.

In the realm of education, video games and digital tools offer powerful ways to enhance cognitive skills such as strategic thinking, decision-making, attention control, and digital literacy. The gamification of education – through apps like *Kahoot!*, *Duolingo*, and *Prodigy* – uses elements like rewards, levels, and instant feedback to boost student engagement and memory retention. These platforms make learning feel more like a game, increasing motivation and focus in students of all ages.

Immersive technologies such as VR and simulations further enhance learning by offering realistic, interactive environments. Students can explore the human body in biology, travel through historical eras, or learn to fly an aircraft in safe, simulated conditions. This hands-on approach strengthens understanding by allowing learners to interact directly with educational content.

Additionally, AI-powered personalised learning platforms adapt to each student's pace, learning style, and knowledge gaps. These tools provide customised exercises, instant feedback, and performance tracking that benefit both learners and educators. Multiplayer educational games also promote collaboration, problem-solving, and communication – key skills in both academic and professional settings.

In conclusion, video games and technology are powerful allies in promoting physical exercise and learning. By making these experiences more interactive, enjoyable, and personalised, they offer new opportunities for holistic growth in both mind and body.

Question 2: How Can Virtual Sports Be Used as a Tool for Inclusiveness?

Traditional sports, while powerful in building community and promoting health, often face significant barriers to inclusivity. Many individuals are excluded due to physical limitations, geographic or economic challenges, gender and cultural biases, or a lack of accessible infrastructure. However, the rise of virtual sports – games that simulate real-world sports through digital technology – offers a promising

solution to these barriers, fostering greater inclusion and participation for people from all walks of life.

One of the most transformative aspects of virtual sports is their accessibility. Unlike traditional sports, which often require specific locations, expensive equipment, or trained personnel, virtual sports can be played from home using relatively simple setups. This reduces costs and geographic barriers, allowing individuals in remote or underserved areas to participate. Additionally, virtual platforms are more adaptable to different needs. Developers are increasingly creating games designed for players with disabilities, including those with reduced mobility, low vision, or cognitive impairments. These games can be tailored with features like high-contrast visuals, simplified controls, or voice navigation.

Technology also introduces tools that further promote inclusiveness. Assistive technologies such as adaptive controllers, eye-tracking systems, and motion-sensing input devices make gameplay accessible to people with varying physical abilities. AI-driven features like dynamic difficulty adjustments ensure that games remain challenging yet achievable, allowing users of all skill levels to engage meaningfully. Virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR) systems enhance immersion and provide more interactive experiences, enabling participants to feel fully integrated into virtual environments regardless of physical limitations.

Another critical factor is the ability of virtual sports to foster anonymity and global community. In online environments, players are often judged by their performance rather than by visible attributes like gender, disability, or race. This anonymity helps reduce biases and discrimination, allowing users to engage on equal footing. Online multiplayer platforms also facilitate global interaction, encouraging cross-cultural communication and social skill development. Virtual team-building games can teach cooperation, empathy, and strategic thinking, offering inclusive social experiences for people who may be marginalised in traditional settings.

Additionally, educational and social benefits arise from the shared experiences that virtual sports provide. Participants can build friendships, learn about diverse cultures, and experience team dynamics in a safe and supportive environment. These experiences help to bridge social divides and cultivate a greater sense of belonging.

Despite these advantages, there are challenges that need to be addressed. Access to high-speed internet and modern devices remains unequal, creating a digital divide. Many assistive technologies or AI-powered systems can also be

expensive, limiting their reach. Furthermore, not all users possess the digital literacy required to navigate complex interfaces. Concerns about privacy, online harassment, and inadequate legal regulations also pose significant risks. Cyberbullying and toxicity in gaming communities must be addressed through robust moderation and inclusive design practices.

In conclusion, virtual sports have immense potential to serve as tools for inclusiveness, breaking down barriers that exclude individuals from traditional athletic experiences. By leveraging adaptive technology, online platforms, and inclusive game design, we can create more equitable opportunities for participation, connection, and growth across diverse populations.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 5

1. Is AI the New Digital Solution for Olympic Values Education Programmes?

1.1. Olympic Values Developing Programmes

The core aim of Olympic Values Education Programmes is to promote principles such as respect, excellence, and friendship across all levels of society. With the emergence of artificial intelligence (AI), there is now a powerful and cost-effective tool to expand these programmes globally. AI can personalise learning experiences based on age, learning styles, and cultural backgrounds, making content more engaging and inclusive. Moreover, AI systems can instantly translate materials into multiple languages, removing barriers and increasing accessibility. Chatbot-based virtual mentors further enhance reach and scalability by offering interactive and responsive educational support. AI's adaptability also allows the creation of culturally sensitive and locally relevant content that reflects the unique values of individual communities. Additionally, gamified learning—where participants make value-based decisions in simulated scenarios—helps individuals experience and internalise Olympic values in a practical and fun way.

1.1.1. Reaching Rural Areas Through AI

AI holds significant promise for expanding the reach of Olympic education to remote and underserved regions. By integrating Olympic values education into online platforms, AI can bring high-quality learning experiences to communities that might otherwise be excluded. These platforms can deliver content at any time and pace, removing logistical barriers such as travel or limited access to

trained educators. Through digital infrastructure and mobile technology, even rural populations can be engaged with Olympic values, helping foster inclusion and equality in access to sports education.

1.2. Developing Talent in Schools Through a Personalised Approach

In school settings, AI can play a transformative role in identifying and nurturing young talent. By analysing patterns in performance and engagement, AI tools can help recognise students with athletic potential early on. Once identified, students can benefit from individualised development plans that support their unique needs – ranging from training schedules to nutrition and mental well-being. These personalised programmes contribute to a holistic “play healthy” philosophy that emphasises balance between performance and health. Ultimately, this tailored approach not only builds a stronger base of future athletes but also helps them grow into well-rounded individuals grounded in Olympic values.

1.3. Identifying Teachers Who Can Spread Olympic Values

Teachers are critical to embedding Olympic values in educational environments, and AI can support their effectiveness in multiple ways. First, AI can help identify educators who are best suited to promote these principles, based on their teaching style, experience, and engagement levels. Second, AI-powered training platforms can provide these teachers with structured learning modules and resources to enhance their understanding of Olympic values. Additionally, AI can assist in evaluating the impact of teaching by analysing classroom outcomes and student feedback, thereby ensuring continuous improvement and accountability in delivering values-based education.

1.4. Identifying Sportspeople, Coaches, and Mentors

Mentorship is a cornerstone of effective Olympic education, and AI can facilitate meaningful connections between students and role models. By matching learners with athletes, coaches, or mentors who embody Olympic values, AI can enable mentorship programmes that are both relevant and inspirational. These digital pairings allow for scalable and accessible mentorship, where students can receive guidance and support from experienced individuals who can share real-life insights and personal journeys shaped by Olympism. This human connection,

enabled by technology, reinforces the values being taught and strengthens their real-world application.

1.5. Ensuring Security and Ethical Standards in Digital Learning

As Olympic education expands into digital spaces, safeguarding young learners becomes essential. AI tools can monitor and prevent cyberbullying, helping to create safe and respectful online environments. Furthermore, content moderation systems can ensure that materials are appropriate for various age groups and in line with ethical standards. In the context of sport-specific education, AI can also help enforce compliance with anti-doping regulations and detect signs of potential manipulation or match-fixing. By embedding these protections into digital platforms, AI not only supports learning but also upholds the integrity and values at the heart of the Olympic Movement.

2. In What Ways can Esports be a Suitable Tool for Implementing Olympic Education Programmes?

2.1. School: Inclusion & Decreasing Student Absence

Digital games can transform classroom experiences through dynamic interactions. Traditional classrooms, while effective in many ways, often limit students to the role of passive listeners. Phygital methods breathe life into these settings by turning lessons into vibrant, interactive sessions. This method can also encourage students to return to school and participate wholeheartedly in their academic and physical education lessons. Certainly, it is also a positive tool to include students who are less gifted when it comes to the practical game but capable of playing the game digitally.

For example, “Phygital Education” bridges the gap between traditional and digital learning.

2.2. Teaching & Learning the Olympic Values Through the Game / Practising Values in Life

Students can be encouraged to play the game digitally according to their age, e.g. 5–7 years old, 8–10 years old, 11–12 years old, etc. Through the game, they will

learn about Olympic values. Students will eventually get a good understanding of Olympic values which they can later utilise in everyday life.

2.3. Different Skills can be Learned: Soft Skills / Techniques

Integrating esports into traditional physical education & sports programmes provides a diverse environment for students who may not excel at learning certain techniques and soft skills practically. It also offers a unique opportunity for students to engage in physical activity while also incorporating technology into their learning. Moreover, esports can promote healthy competition and teamwork among students, which can be valuable skills for their future academic and professional targets. By using video games for exercise in physical education classes, students can have fun while getting their daily dose of physical activity, and it can also promote the development of motor skills.

2.4. P.E. Lesson – Using Esports to Learn the Rules of the Game / Tactics

Every time the physical education teacher introduces a new sport discipline it is recommended that the teacher makes use of the digital platform for the students to become familiar by visualising the game. In addition, the teacher may introduce the rules and the basic tactics of the game. It is encouraged that the digital method does not exceed 10–15 minutes, and for the rest of the session the students should practice physically – transferring theory into practice.



The participants engaged in fruitful discussions in the framework of the working groups.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 6

“WHAT WOULD PIERRE DE COUBERTIN THINK?”

Questions:

1. Does AI Represent an Evolution of Coubertin’s Vision or a Deviation From it?
2. How Can We Use AI in Olympic Education Without Losing Human Contact/Influence?

Introduction

What would Pierre de Coubertin make of artificial intelligence in Olympic education? As the founder of the modern Olympic Games, Coubertin envisioned Olympic education as inherently human-centred – cultivating body and mind while emphasising direct experience and personal connection. "The important thing", he famously stated, "is not the triumph but the struggle."

Today, as AI reshapes how we learn, educate and compete, we face a profound question: Does AI represent an evolution of Coubertin’s vision or a deviation from it? This report examines how we might harness AI’s capabilities while preserving the human connections essential to Olympic education. We explore the balance between technological enhancement and human presence, considering not just what AI can do, but what it should do – not merely how it can make Olympic education more efficient, but how it can make it more profound. Our challenge is to integrate AI in ways that amplify rather than diminish the human spirit at the heart of the Olympic Movement.

The key focus areas that we have identified are the following:

1. AI as Supportive Technology

2. Ethical Framework Considerations
3. Generational Challenges
4. Human Element Preservation

AI as Supportive Technology

It has been reiterated that we have to recognise AI as a supporting tool to complement our existing human expertise, not as a replacement. We recognise the value of AI's existence in the future of sport and everyday life but it is to be strictly used as a tool and not be abused as we also recognise that it can be a threat to the integrity of new works. We as educators need to embrace the inevitability of technology while establishing clear boundaries.

Ethical Framework Considerations

To mitigate the threat of AI to the integrity of what is being shared in the future regarding Olympic education, we have established that there needs to be strict and specific AI guidelines. We have also established that it is critical to integrate this framework into the IOC AI Agenda and have key input from NOA and NOC members to ensure the integrity of the Olympic ideals. From the information that has been shared with us this week, we would like to emphasise that safeguarding individual rights, ensuring good governance and maintaining sustainability are crucial in the creation of this framework. Overall, it is an exciting endeavour in the new world of technology when it is approached with caution and the right care.

Generational Challenges

Another key focus point is the obvious generational gap in knowledge around AI technologies, especially for our older generations. The generation “BC” (Before Computers) need a different approach to learning about this new world of technology than the “Digital Natives” who have rapidly adapted to this new way of life. Although it is an amazing phenomenon that we have a generation of youth that have grasped these new concepts, we also can catch sight of the potential harm this can do if our youth choose to misuse it without the older

generation knowing that they are. The need for AI literacy across all generations is crucial for the future of AI, especially within the Olympic Movement.

Human Element Preservation

There are plenty of benefits to using AI within our education and athletic programmes. However, there lies a challenge which only can be solved through human thinking and perception. That is the lack of human contact and influence when using AI for educational and athletic development purposes. The opportunity to use AI technologies for these types of programmes is transformational and efficient; however, AI technologies can only do so much besides removing human bias. AI cannot judge character or human inspiration, or see character development, and therefore we risk reducing our athletes and students to data points rather than whole individuals. The final line needs to go through human inspection before the final decision is made to make sure that assessments of intangible qualities are carefully taken into consideration.

A. Group Recommendations

1. Develop a Structured Olympic AI Framework

- Create clear ethical boundaries and usage guidelines specific to Olympic education
- Involve stakeholders in framework development to ensure broad representation
- Distinguish between appropriate AI instruction and human-led education

2. Implement "Human-in-the-Loop" Systems

- Design AI tools that require human oversight and final decision-making
- Ensure technology enhances rather than replaces human coaching relationships
- Maintain focus on physical activity and embodied learning

3. Create Age-Appropriate AI Literacy Programmes

- Develop tailored education on responsible AI use for different age groups
- Support older coaches and educators in understanding and utilising AI tools
- Teach critical evaluation of AI-generated content

4. Establish Olympic-Verified AI Resources

- Develop an IOC/IOA-approved AI platform with vetted Olympic information
- Ensure data quality and ethical collection practices
- Focus on supporting physical activity rather than replacing it

5. Balance Innovation with Olympic Values

- Use AI to promote accessibility while preserving core human connections
- Regularly evaluate AI implementation against Olympic educational goals
- Remember that AI provides instruction, while humans provide true education

Concluding statement

If Pierre de Coubertin were with us today, he would say to take the opportunity that artificial intelligence presents. It is a challenge, yes, but an opportunity to transform the world in profound ways. The Olympic Movement has always embraced innovation while preserving its core values of excellence, respect and friendship. With this tool, if used positively, we can make the world a better place by democratising access to Olympic education, preserving cultural heritage, and fostering deeper international understanding. The responsibility lies with us to use the technology for the good of humankind – to enhance rather than replace the human connections that give the Olympic Movement its power and meaning. As Coubertin himself proclaimed, "The Olympic Games were created for the exaltation of the individual athlete [...] but also to allow him to serve as an ambassador of his nation to the youth of the world." Let us ensure that, in this digital age, we remain ambassadors of these timeless human values, using technology to build bridges rather than barriers between the peoples of our global Olympic community.

ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORKING GROUP 7

Introduction

As artificial intelligence (AI) rapidly transforms industries and societal norms, its potential to reshape the future of sports and human competition raises critical questions for the Olympic Movement. On one hand, the pervasive influence of AI challenges the preservation of core Olympic Values—excellence, respect, and friendship—in a world increasingly inundated by algorithms and machine dominance. On the other, the rising cultural phenomenon of esports compels the Olympics to confront unique considerations, from redefining athleticism to balancing technological integration with tradition.

Our discussion below explores how the Olympic spirit can endure amidst AI's ascendancy and examines the complexities of incorporating esports into the Games, navigating both innovation and the timeless ideals that unite humanity.

Key Areas Where AI can Contribute to the Olympic Ecosystem

Technical (Coaches, athlete, referees, medical)	Operational (Federation, NOC, IOC, IOA, etc.)	MEDIA & Communication	Regulation By-Laws	Values By Education
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Q1) How do we Ensure Olympic Values (i.e. the human element) Still Exist in a World Where Artificial Intelligence (AI) Could Reign Supreme?

- We should always bear in mind that AI should be used as a complimentary/ supporting tool and not to replace the actual human being.
- Instilling mandatory training on how to use AI tools is a must and should be

made available for all stakeholders in the sports ecosystem, such as athletes, parents, and coaches (non-exhaustive list).

- Safety and security are a must, and therefore we recommend that safety of data, especially personal data, must be secured through encryption and other methods.
- We suggest that Olympic values and the propagation of healthy lifestyle/ideals when “training” are embedded in AI tools.
- It is critical to maintain the human element alongside AI to further maintain and develop the critical social and inter-personal skills required for any human being to succeed in the future, especially for future leaders. This can further be maintained by sustaining physical interaction between instructors and employees receiving training (balancing between the two).

Key Considerations

- Quality of data is key: remember the saying → “*Rubbish in, rubbish out.*”
- An acceptable margin must be defined at the forefront as it is a new technology and is still not perfect (we must be confident and okay in accepting the shortfalls that may exist today).
- We also recommend that internal controls are set in place to ensure authenticity and accuracy of data and information are in place.
- Measures of success for evaluating and refining any outputs of AI tools should be clearly defined to ensure that desired goals are achieved.

Q2) What are the Unique Considerations for Esports to be Part of the Olympic Programme?

Esports presents a unique set of considerations for inclusion in the Olympic programme, distinct from traditional sports. While it shares core values such as competition, excellence, and global appeal, esports operates within a rapidly evolving digital ecosystem shaped by private game publishers, diverse game genres, and virtual platforms. This raises complex issues around governance, standardisation, and the alignment of game content with Olympic values such as non-violence and inclusivity. Additionally, questions about physicality, athlete recognition, and audience engagement within the Olympic framework must be addressed to ensure

esports' potential integration respects both the tradition of the Games and the dynamic nature of digital sport.

Key points

- The physical element must be present (i.e. rowing activity, augmented reality)
- Clearly defining how much it needs to be physical (calories, duration of movement)
- A clear qualification process needs to be present and conducted by an independent committee that reviews proposals
- Proper procedure: prior to submitting a qualification, any sport or group of sports/disciplines (digital games) must first move through Sports Accord, then get on the observer list of the IOC prior to qualifying as be part of the Olympic programme.

Qualification Process

- Esports-related federations and disciplines through their governing bodies must comply with WHO in areas related to physical & mental health
- Screen time, physical movement (age group dependent) and nutrition as examples (non-exhaustive list)
- Ratings of sports and games should be a decider in the qualification process (i.e. violence ratings of games)

Governance

- Safeguarding policies to be implemented and rolled out as a requirement to be a part of the programme, while expanding to embrace unique requirements of esports that may not have been previously considered in physical sports (protecting children, women of all ages and groups).
- All national esports federations must adhere to the bylaws of esports international federations that are recognised by the IOC.
- We also suggest that ethical standards be extended and expanded to esports-related entities that would have a direct or indirect relationship with the Olympic ecosystem.

- We strongly recommend that the IOC and the International Federation in conjunction work closely with the legislative bodies to ensure existing laws are updated and reflect newly identified risks and concerns as esports is constantly evolving and growing. The standards and regulations agreed upon must present a strict global standard in unison with specific country requirements.
- Higher collaboration with physical sport federations & higher conversion rate.

Compliance

- **Safety** This is a major theme that must be considered as there are a multitude of risks. Policies and measures addressing the following elements (non-exhaustive list) must be carefully curated:
 - Cyber security – to protect information (personal)
 - Cyber bullying
 - Protection from criminal activity
 - Gender based violence
 - Racism
 - Ratings and classification of games (age ratings and violence)
- **Health** Those federations that wish to be a part of the Olympic programme must comply with and instil WHO guidelines, and report on their activities frequently

Monitoring & Evaluation

- It is crucial to clearly define measures of success in order to evaluate the achievement of the desired benefit.
- These “measures of success”, including evaluation processes, must be communicated from the start to all related federations and entities covering the key areas relating to all compliance elements mentioned previously, such as:
 - Number of esports players and athletes engaging in physical activity
 - The number of minutes per week the gamers and athletes are engaging in physical activity
 - Compliance level of all related entities
 - Reports on compliance with WHO regulations, as well as safety, health and security requirements.



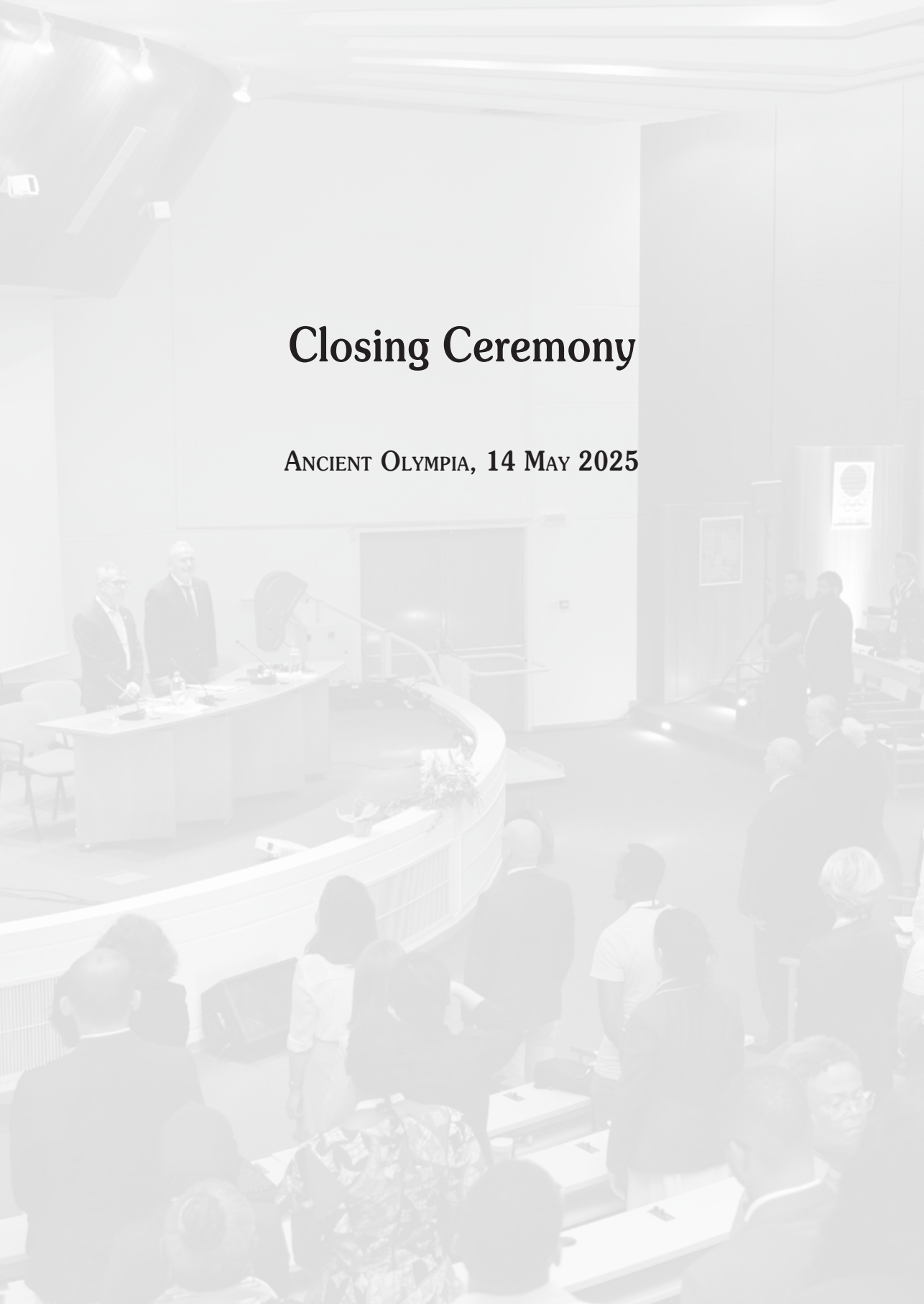
Presenting the conclusions emerged from the working groups.





Closing Ceremony

ANCIENT OLYMPIA, 14 MAY 2025





The participants received their participation diplomas during the Session's Closing Ceremony.

ADDRESS
on behalf of the Session Participants
by Professor Silvia DALOTTO (ARG)

Dr Charilaos Tsolakis, President of the International Olympic Academy,
Professor Konstantinos Georgiadis, Dean of the IOA,
Dr Makis Asimakopoulos, Director of the IOA,
Distinguished Professors, guests, colleagues, and friends,

Today marks the end of a significant chapter. More than closing a Session, we are sharing the conclusion of an experience that leaves a deep and lasting impression, both personally and professionally.

Olympia is much more than the birthplace of the Olympic Games. It is a place where the energy feels different, where history comes alive, where symbols gain meaning, and where the roots of the Olympic Movement find their deepest ground. Here we connect with history – but also with the future we want to build.

The International Olympic Academy is much more than a centre of study. It is a space for meetings, and above all, it is like a lighthouse, casting its light to guide and inspire Olympic Academies across the world – a light that reminds us who we are and why we do what we do and inspires us to move forward even when the path becomes challenging.

We are living in complex times.

Society is changing, and so is sport.

Artificial intelligence, esports, social tensions, global conflicts... All of this calls us. It demands that we be more attentive, more prepared, more committed.

But there is one thing we know for sure: we are not alone.

We are together.

Just a few months ago, here in Greece, Kirsty Coventry was elected President of the International Olympic Committee. In her first message, she shared a powerful phrase: "I am because we are."



Prof. Silvia Dalotto, Zaher Bin Wahab and Prof. Hassan Khachfe made the closing addresses representing the participants, the working groups' coordinators and the lecturers respectively.



An expression of African origin that holds a profound truth: our identity, our actions, our impact... only make sense in relation to others.

We are a global network committed to values.

A united team dedicated to sharing the Olympic ideal.

A community determined to transform realities through sport.

Because in the end, we are — and in that collective being, each one of us finds our purpose.

Thank you to those who made this possible:

To the IOA and Olympic Solidarity for their support.

To the staff, for their outstanding dedication.

To the Red Cross, for caring for us every moment.

To the interpreters, for building bridges between our languages and cultures.

And thank you, from the heart — the true protagonists of this experience.

Thank you for arriving with open minds and willing hearts.

This is not a goodbye.

It's a see you soon.

Because those who share a mission like ours always meet again — in future Sessions, in new projects, or in the daily work that unites us from different corners of the world.

May your return home be just the beginning of new ideas, new actions, new challenges — and, of course, new friendships.

May the Olympic flame remain lit in your hearts, driving you to turn each step into an opportunity.

ADDRESS
on behalf of the Working Group Coordinators
by Zaher BIN WAHAB (SGP)

Distinguished guests, fellow participants,
My Olympic Family,
Kalimera, Good morning!

Introduction

My name is Zaher and as a boy growing up in Singapore I remember reading many stories about Greek mythology: Zeus, Hades, Hercules and famous Olympia. Therefore, I must say that it is truly an honour to be here on the sacred ground of Olympia to deliver a speech on behalf of all the coordinators.

In the last few days, we explored how artificial intelligence (AI) is reshaping the future of sport, how it can elevate Olympic values and how it can democratise access to education and training.

Just as the Ancient Greeks saw sport as a celebration of human potential, we now stand at a crossroads where AI can amplify that potential in ways once unimaginable.

It is here where I am reminded of a tale from Greek mythology – one that echoes the very essence of what we have been discussing these few days.

It is the story of Prometheus, the Titan who defied the Gods to bring fire to humanity.

The Gift of Prometheus

Indeed, Prometheus had defied Zeus and the Gods to bring fire to humanity – a gift that symbolised not only warmth and light, but also knowledge, innovation, and progress.

His act was empowerment, lifting mortals up from ignorance to enlightenment. In many ways, he was the first educator, igniting the flame of transformation.

The Organising Staff as Modern Prometheans

Like modern-day Prometheans, those who have shared their knowledge with us these few days (our lecturers) have sought to share a different kind of fire: the fire of knowledge.

Over the last few days, we have

- discussed AI's potential to revolutionise sports, fairness, and global engagement in the Olympic Movement
- looked at ethical considerations: ensuring technology serves humanity rather than controls it

and, most importantly,

- examined the future of Olympism and decided that tradition and innovation can co-exist to inspire new generations.

Each lecture, each discussion and exchange was a spark—a piece of that fire—passed on to you, just as Prometheus passed his gifts to humanity.

As your coordinators, we hope you will always ask these 2 Questions when dealing with AI:

How do we ensure AI upholds fairness in competition?

How do we preserve the spirit of Olympism in the age of algorithms?

A Challenge for the Future

As you leave this Session, you carry with you not just knowledge, but a torch—a spark to illuminate the way for your athletes and your own communities.

The future of sport is not written in code alone; it is written by those who, like Prometheus, dare to share, dare to teach, and to inspire.

So, as we close, I ask you: How will you wield this fire?

We hope you will always remember to question, to innovate, and—when necessary—to challenge the status quo. The future isn't just something we predict—it is something we build, together.

On behalf of all the Coordinators who served during this 18th International Session, we thank you for your passion, your curiosity, and most of all, your commitment this week.

Now, go forth—and light up the world.

Thank you!

ADDRESS
on behalf of the Session Lecturers
by Professor Hassan M. KHACHFE (LBN)

“The Future of Sport – Where Tradition Meets Transformation”

A young girl in Riyadh, headphones on, eyes locked on the screen, is competing in an international esports tournament. Her parents, once sceptical, now cheer her on from the next room. Thousands of kilometres away, a teenage boy in Athens is training with a virtual coach powered by AI, learning not just how to run faster – but how to think like a champion.

Ladies and Gentlemen: These are not stories from the future. They are happening now. And they are reshaping the world of sport as we know it.

Honoured IOC and IOA officials, esteemed colleagues, *Kalimera. Sabah el Kheir.*

It is a privilege to speak on behalf of our distinguished keynote speakers, who have offered us a powerful glimpse into the future of sport – one shaped by innovation, inclusion, and intelligence. Today, we gather not just to reflect on where sport has been, but to envision where it is going – guided by Olympic values and propelled by the transformative force of artificial intelligence.

Esports on the one hand, and as seen in the lens of Saudi Arabia’s Vision 2030, is more than a national strategy – it’s a global signal. A signal that sport, in all its forms, is a powerful engine for growth, diplomacy, and innovation.

Esports, once dismissed as a niche, is now a global arena of competition. It’s where reflexes meet strategy, and where millions of young people are finding identity, purpose, and community. Such competitions are now being integrated into classrooms – not just as games, but as learning tools that teach teamwork, critical thinking, and digital literacy.

It’s not about replacing traditional sport. It’s about expanding the playing field.

Now imagine this: A young athlete in Nairobi is preparing for a regional competition. She doesn't have access to elite coaches—but she does have a smartphone. Through AI-powered Olympic education platforms, she receives personalised training, learns about sportsmanship, and even explores the history of the Games.

This is Olympic Education 2.0—where AI becomes a mentor, a translator, and a bridge.

One year into the Olympic AI Agenda put forth by the IOC and implemented in Paris 2024, we're seeing real impact. Not only is AI helping athletes optimise performance, it's also helping educators instil values—respect, excellence, and friendship—in ways that are scalable and inclusive.

But as once stated by Spiderman's Uncle Ben, "with great power comes great responsibility." What happens when AI starts making decisions about who gets selected, who gets seen, who gets sponsored? These are not just technical questions—they are ethical ones. And they demand our serious attention, and this is where most of our work as Olympic educators should be focused.

In the midst of this heated argument, let's not forget the storytellers. The broadcasters, the cameras that capture the tears, the triumphs, and the torch. Of course, I am not talking about those who read coffee grounds using ChatGPT; rather, I am talking about the real storytellers.

AI is revolutionising Olympic media coverage—from real-time translation to immersive viewing experiences. But we should always remember, the goal isn't just better tech; it's better storytelling. Stories that honour the athlete, respect the moment, and preserve the magic.

Because in the end, sport is not just about performance. It's about meaning. So where do we go from here?

We definitely go forward—boldly and thoughtfully—we go higher, faster, together. We embrace AI not as a threat to tradition, but as a tool to elevate it. We ensure that every innovation is grounded in the values that make sport a force for good.

Ladies and Gentlemen,

The future of Olympic sport is not just digital. It has been, and will always be, human, ethical, and inclusive.

And it starts with all of us here and back home; it starts with YOU.

Thank you.

CLOSING ADDRESS
by the President of the International Olympic Academy
Professor Charilaos TSOLAKIS

Dear Friends,

It is with great satisfaction and a deep sense of pride in the outcomes of this year's 18th International Session for NOA and NOC Delegates that I address you today, as you conclude your work on a topic of immense relevance and sensitivity for the future of sport, Olympic education, and the entire Olympic Movement.

Although prior commitments kept me in Athens and regrettably prevented my physical presence at the Session, I have been thoroughly informed – through detailed briefings from the IOA staff and careful reading of the presentations – about the depth, richness, and thought-provoking nature of the discussions that took place. I am also well aware of the lively exchanges that occurred during the working groups and the dynamic conversations sparked by the lectures.

As an educator, I have long been aware of the increasing role of new digital communication forms in shaping the lives of young people globally. Yet, I must admit that the intersection of artificial intelligence (AI) and Olympic education, particularly in the field of esports, was a topic filled with unknown dimensions – even for many experienced educators. This Session has illuminated many of these complexities through the expertise of distinguished speakers, shedding light not only on the mechanics of AI but also on its broader implications for teaching, learning, and the transmission of Olympic values.

On the opening day, a captivating panel discussion featuring HRH Prince Faisal bin Bandar bin Sultan Al Saud and IOA Director Makis Asimakopoulou introduced delegates to the scope and impact of esports – a global phenomenon that now captivates millions of young people. Their insights were further expanded by Mr Karagrounas, whose analytical presentation demonstrated how gamified



From the Closing Ceremony of the Session. The IOA President, Prof. Charilaos Tsolakis, and the IOA Dean, Prof. Konstantinos Georgiadis.

learning environments can motivate students, turning them into protagonists of their own educational journey through immersive and rewarding experiences.

Professor Hassan M. Khachfe contributed a compelling vision, asserting that as AI continues to evolve, so too must Olympic education – striking a balance between embracing innovation and safeguarding the humanistic values at the heart of Olympism. His perspective reinforced the idea that tradition and innovation can coexist meaningfully.

Equally inspiring was the presentation by Cécile Faye, an alumna of the IOA and University of the Peloponnese Master's Degree Programme. She showcased the impressive strides made by the Senegalese Olympic Committee and the Ministry of Education in embedding Olympic education across national curricula, and in preparing communities for Dakar 2026. We eagerly look forward to the IOA's presence at this Youth Olympic Games edition – a legacy project envisioned by the late IOC President Jacques Rogge, who sought to merge sport, culture, and education in a truly global celebration.

Dr Sotiris Salamouris introduced the delegates to the ever-evolving world of

sports broadcasting and communication. Through his insights into the work of OBS and OCS, he illustrated how AI now enables real-time analytics, customised storytelling, and broader global engagement, ultimately revolutionising the Olympic viewing experience.

On a more philosophical and cautionary note, Professor Alberto Carrio Sampedro addressed the ethical challenges of AI in the educational and sporting context. His five key recommendations, grounded in the Fundamental Principles of Olympism, offered a thoughtful and necessary framework for the responsible use of AI, focusing on individual rights, governance, and sustainability.

Finally, Dr Hilla Davidov, in her lecture titled *AI: Opportunities and Challenges for Olympic Education – Bridging Tradition with Innovation*, delivered an optimistic yet grounded message. She reminded us that AI should not be seen as a threat to human-centered learning, but rather as a tool that can enhance personalisation, accessibility, and meaningful engagement with youth across the globe – always in service of the values of respect, excellence, and solidarity.

A particularly valuable addition to this year's Session were the video presentations submitted by National Olympic Academies, showcasing their national activities, innovative approaches, and educational outreach efforts. These videos not only sparked conversation but also revealed the incredible diversity and vitality of the global Olympic education network.

Dear Delegates,

As you bring this remarkable Session to a close, I trust that you return home enriched with new perspectives, practical insights, and renewed motivation. The topic of AI and Olympic education – so full of ethical nuance and real-world consequences – will undoubtedly continue to occupy your thoughts and shape your work in the years ahead.

The IOA remains committed to promoting and supporting such essential discussions annually, helping you fulfill your vital mission of spreading Olympic values across your communities, in alignment with both the IOC's priorities and the shifting realities of our technological era.

Yesterday, the IOA Director, Dr Makis Asimakopoulos, introduced a new IOA initiative designed to strengthen your work at a national level, offering tools and resources to deepen your engagement with young people at critical stages of their development. We recognise your tireless efforts and are sincerely grateful for the passion, resilience, and creativity you bring to Olympic education.

Allow me, as I close, to extend my heartfelt thanks:



Closing of the Session works on the sound of the Olympic anthem.

- To the exceptional lecturers who generously shared their expertise and brought clarity to a complex and rapidly evolving field
- To each and every one of you who participated actively in the discussions and working groups, contributing your own experiences and perspectives to this vibrant exchange
- To Dr Makis Asimakopoulou, IOA Director; Prof. Kostas Georgiadis, IOA Dean; and Alexandra Karaïskou, Head of the NOAs Department, for their leadership and dedication
- To our entire IOA staff – Roula, Antonia, Tolis, Nikos, Giannis, Konstantinos, Christos, and Vangelis, responsible for the IOA premises – for their outstanding work and hospitality
- To the Hellenic Red Cross volunteers for their generous support
- To the technicians, photographers, and the always excellent interpreters whose professionalism made this Session a success.

I wish each of you a safe journey home, carrying with you the spirit of Olympia and the shared commitment to shaping the future through education.

Until we meet again in 2026 – thank you.

An aerial photograph of a large, circular stone monument or well in a dense forest. The monument is a light-colored, circular structure with a central pillar. It is surrounded by a low stone wall and a circular path. The forest is composed of tall, thin trees, and the ground is covered in grass and small plants. The title "List of Participants" is centered over the image in a black, serif font.

List of Participants

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IOA President

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ISBN: 978-960-9454-75-9
ISSN: 2732-6284